

Of Domestical Duties

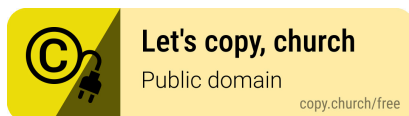
*Volume I — The First Treatise: An Exposition of That
Part of Scripture Out of Which Domestical Duties Are
Raised*



William Gouge

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This is volume 1 of four. The complete work is in eight treatises: I, an
exposition of Ephesians 5:21–6:9; II, of husband and wife; III, of wives; IV, of
husbands; V, of children; VI, of parents; VII, of servants; VIII, of masters.

Submitting your selves one to another in the fear of God.

— Ephesians 5:21

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The Epistle Dedicatory

TO THE RIGHT HONOURABLE, RIGHT Worshipful,
and other my *beloved Parishioners, Inhabitants of the*
Precinct of Black-friers LONDON, such *sufficiency of*
Grace as may bring them to *fulness of Glory*.

If noble Birth, high honour, great estate, true Piety, bountiful Charity, good Esteem of Gods word and Ministers, and in particular, entire love of the Author, be inducements to choose a Patron for his work, I, for my part, need not go far for a Patron. In mine own parish are all these. To you therefore (right Honourable, right Worshipful, and other my beloved Parishioners, most worthy of all due respect) do I dedicate these my poor pains about *Domestical duties*. To testify the equal duty which I owe, and the impartial respect which I bear to you all, I make you all as one Patron. You were the first over whom I ever had any ministerial charge. To this charge by your free choice was I called. Among you have I spent¹ almost two full apprenticeships. You have always so accepted my pains, and respected my person, as I never had any cause to repent my acceptance of this place, and calling: but rather to thank God for the same. My desire is (if so it may seem good to the divine providence) to spend all my days among you: and, while I am among you, to help forward your spiritual edification. This is the main end of my calling, and the mark, which, as in the ordinary course of my Ministry, so in the publishing of these *Eight Treatises of Domestical duties*, and dedicating them to you, I have aimed at. As in testimony of love and duty I have preached in your hearing, and published in your name these duties, so do you manifest your kind acceptance of my former, and latter pains, by a conscionable observing of them, so far forth as they are agreeable to Gods word: that all who know you, may know by that evident demonstration, how well you have relished and approved them. Thus shall you gain much profit, and my self much

¹Since Midsommer. 1608.

comfort by my pains. Oh if the head and several members of a family would be persuaded every of them to be conscionable in performing their own particular duties, what a sweet society, and happy harmony would there be in houses? What excellent seminaries would families be to Church and commonwealth?² Necessary it is that good order be first set in families: for as they were before other polities, so they are somewhat the more necessary: and good members of a family are like to make good members of Church and common-wealth. The subject matter therefore of these Treatises is worth the handling, if I were able according to the worth thereof to handle it. I have endeavoured to do what I could therein, though I have not attained to what I would. Be you like unto God, who, if there be first a willing mind, accepteth according to that a man hath, and not according to that he hath not. Though for such a matter as is handled in these Treatises, the work may seem at first sight to be too copious, yet I hope the observant Reader will not find it too tedious. It is the variety of many,³ not the prolixity of few points which hath made this book to swell to that bigness which it hath. The first Treatise (which is a fourth part of the book) containeth a Commentary on that part of Scripture out of which *Domesticall duties* are raised: wherein the Apostle setting forth Christ and the Church as patterns to husbands and wives, lively declareth the great love of Christ to his Church, and the near union betwixt them, together with other deep mysteries, the unfolding whereof hath a little the longer detained me. But as I have a while insisted on main matters of much moment, so have I very briefly passed over other points. The other Treatises, wherein the duties themselves are handled, are every of them much shorter then the first. In them I have barely propounded and briefly proved the truth and equity of the several duties, except some choice points which are of especial use, or at least through disuse much questioned: and them I have more largely handled. And because contraries laid together⁴ do much set forth each other in their lively colours, I have to every duty annexed the contrary fault, and aberration from it. For many that hear the duties think all well enough, till they hear also the contrary vices, whereby in their consciences they are most convinced. Concerning the

²Arist. *Eth. lib. 8. cap. 12.*

³M. Ammon. *Multum loqui est rem superfluis agere verbis. Aug. Epist. 121. ad Prob.*

⁴Arist. *Rhet. lib. 3. cap. 2.*

many faults and vices of bad husbands, wives, parents, children, masters and servants, taxed in these Treatises, let me entreat you, not to apply them too generally to all husbands, wives, parents, children, masters and servants. Hath not wise *Solomon* much taxed the lightness, shrewishness, pride, flattery, and other vices of women? And shall sober, meek, humble, honest women think themselves taxed thereby? By like reason might unchaste strumpets, untrusty gossips, unquiet shrews, and proud dames think themselves commended by those excellent commendations which be giveth of good women. Let every one, as their conscience (an impartial Judge) shall bear them witness, make a right application of every thing to themselves. Thus shall we Ministers be freed from many evil surmises. I remember that when these *Domestical duties* were first uttered out of the pulpit, much exception was taken against the application of a wives subjection to the restraining of her from disposing the common goods of the family without, or against her husbands consent. But surely they that made those exceptions did not well think of the *Cautions* and *Limitations* which were then delivered, and are now again expressly noted: which are, that the foresaid restraint be not extended to the⁵ *proper goods of a wife*, no nor overstrictly to such⁶ *goods as are set apart for the use of the family*, nor to⁷ *extraordinary cases*, nor always to an⁸ *express consent*, nor to the⁹ *consent of such husbands as are impotent, or far and long absent*. If any other warrantable caution shall be showed me, I will be as willing to admit it, as any of these. Now that my meaning may not still be perverted, I pray you, in reading the restraint of wives power in disposing the goods of the family, ever bear in mind those Cautions. Other exceptions were made against some other particular duties of wives. For many that can patiently enough hear their duties declared in general terms, cannot endure to hear those generals exemplified in their particular branches. This cometh too near to the quick, and pierceth too deep. But (to interpret all, according to the rule of love, in the better part) I take the main reason of the many exceptions which were taken, to be this, that wives duties (according to the Apostles method) being in the first place handled, there was taught (as

⁵*Paraphernalia*. Treat. 3. §. 21.

⁶*Ibid*.

⁷Treat. 3. §. 22.

⁸Treat. 3. §. 19.

⁹Treat. 3. §. 18.

must have been taught, except the truth should have been betrayed) what a wife, in the uttermost extent of that subjection under which God hath put her, is bound unto, in case her husband will stand upon the uttermost of his authority: which was so taken, as if I had taught that an husband might, and ought to exact the uttermost, and that a wife was bound in that uttermost extent to do all that was delivered as duty, whether her husband exact it or no. But when I came to deliver husbands duties,¹⁰ I showed, that he ought not to exact whatsoever his wife was bound unto (in case it were exacted by him) but that he ought to make her a joint Governor of the family with himself, and refer the ordering of many things to her discretion, and with all honourable and kind respect to carry himself towards her. In a word, I so set down an husbands duties, as if he be wise and conscionable in observing them, his wife can have no just cause to complain of her subjection. That which maketh a wives yoke heavy and hard, is an husbands abuse of his authority: and more pressing his wives duty, then performing his own: which is directly contrary to the¹¹ Apostles rule. This just Apology I have been forced to make, that I might not ever be judged (as some have censured me)¹² *an hater of women*. Now that in all those places where a wives yoke may seem most to pinch, I might give some ease, I have to every head of wives duties made a reference, in the margin over against it, to the duties of husbands answerable thereunto, and noted the reference with this mark *, that it might the more readily be turned unto. Yea I have further parallel'd, and laid even one against another in one view, the heads of husbands and wives duties, as they answer each other: and in like manner the contrary aberrations: with a reference made unto the particular sections where they are handled: that so on the one side it may appear, that if both of them be conscionable and careful to perform their own duty, the matrimonial yoke will so equally lie on both their necks, as the wife will be no more pinched therewith then the husband, but that it will be like Christs spiritual yoke, *light* and *easy*: and that on the¹³ other side it may be manifest that there is commonly as much failing by husbands in their duties, as by wives in theirs. This parallel and

¹⁰Treat. 4. §. 18.

¹¹*Ephes.* 5. 33. See Treat. 1. §. 95.

¹²Athen.

¹³*Mat.* 11. 30.

even-setting out of each of their duties, and of the contrary aberrations, I have annexed next to this epistle. And further I have added thereto a table of the several heads of those points that are handled in the eight following Treatises, that by this help you may the more readily find out such particular points as you desire most especially to read. To show that the duties prescribed to husbands, wives, parents, children, masters, and servants, are such as in conscience they are bound unto, I have endeavoured to show how they are grounded on the word of God, and gathered from thence. To avoid prolixity, I have referred most of the quotations to the margin. If your leisure will serve you, you may do well to search them out. Two things have been especial helps to me for finding out the many duties noted in these Treatises, & vices contrary thereunto: *Observation* and *Disposition*. *Observation* both of such duties as the Scripture commendeth and contrary vices as it condemneth: and also of such commendable virtues as I well liked in those husbands, wives, parents, children, masters, and servants, that I came among, and such unseemly vices as I disliked in them: and *Disposition* of one point after another in the best order that I could. My method and manner of proceeding brought many things to my mind, which otherwise might have slipped by. For by method sundry and several points appertaining to one matter are drawn forth, as in a chain one link draweth up another. There is no better way to find out many observations in a text, then by a methodical resolution thereof. As method is an help to *Invention*, so also to *retention*. It is as the thread or wiew whereon pearls are put, which keepeth them from scattering. And if a man by abundance of matter be cast into a labyrinth, by the help of method he may easily and readily find out the way again. In which respects *method* is fitly styled the¹⁴ *mother of the Mind*, and *mistress of Memory*. If you well mark the order and dependance of points one upon another, you will find as great an help in conceiving and remembering¹⁵ them, as I did in inventing and disposing them.

Because there is not one word to comprise under it both masters and mistresses, as fathers and mothers are comprised under *parents*, and sons and daughters under *children*, I have according to the Scripture phrase comprised mistresses under masters: so as the duties enjoined to *them*

¹⁴Methodus intelligentiae parens est, & magistra memoriae.

¹⁵Ordo memoriae maximè, lumen affert. Cic. 2. de Orat.

belong to *these*, so far as may stand with their sex. To conclude, in recompense of all my pains I heartily pray you all to pray heartily for him who daily praieth for you, even¹⁶

The Watch-man of your souls, WILLIAM GOUGE.

¹⁶Church-court in Black-Fryers London. 2. Febr. 1621.

Serving Each Other in the Fear of the Lord

EPHES. 5. 21.

Submit your selves one to another in the fear of God.

§. 1. *Of the Apostles transition from general duties to particulars.*

As there are two vocations whereunto it hath pleased God to call every one; *one general*, by virtue whereof certain common duties which are to be performed of all men, are required, (as knowledge, faith, obedience, repentance, love, mercy, justice, truth, etc.) *the other particular*, by virtue whereof certain peculiar duties are required of several persons, according to those distinct places wherein the Divine Providence hath set them in common-wealth, Church, or family; so ought Gods Ministers to be careful in instructing Gods people in both kinds of duties; both those which concern their *general*, and those also which concern their *particular* calling. Accordingly *S. Paul* (who, as¹⁷ *Moses*, was *faithful in all the house of God*) after he had sufficiently instructed Gods Church in such *general* duties, as belong to all Christians, of what sex, state, degree, or condition soever they be, proceedeth to lay down certain *particular* duties, which appertain to particular callings and conditions: among which, he maketh choice of those which God hath established in a family. With excellent Art doth he pass from those *generals*, to these *particulars*: laying down a *transition* betwixt them, in these words, *Submitting your selves one to another in the fear of God*; which words have reference both to that which goeth before, and also to that which followeth after. The form and manner of setting down this verse, with a participle thus, *submitting*, sheweth that

¹⁷*Num.* 12. 7.

it dependeth on that which went before, and so hath reference thereunto. Again, the word it self being the very same which is used¹⁸ in the next verse following, sheweth, that this verse containeth the *sum* of that which followeth, and so hath reference thereunto, as a general unto particulars. This manner of passing from one point to another, by a *perfect transition* which looketh both ways, both to that which is past, and to that which cometh on, as it is very elegant, so is it frequent with this our Apostle. Whereby he teacheth us,¹⁹ so to give heed to that which followeth, as we forget not that which is past: as we must give diligent attention to that which remaineth, so we must well retain that which we have heard, and not let it slip: otherwise, if (as one nail driveth out another) one precept maketh another to be forgotten, it will be altogether in vain to add line unto line, or precept unto precept.

§. 2. Of joining service to men with our praising of God.

As this verse hath reference to that which was delivered before, concerning our duty to God, it teacheth us this lesson:

It is the duty of Christians as to set forth the praise of God, so to be serviceable one to another. For this purpose in the²⁰ Decalogue to the first table, which prescribeth that duty which we owe to God, is added the second table, which declareth the service that we owe one to another: and he that said,²¹ *The first and great Commandment is this, Thou shalt love the Lord*, etc. Said also, *The second is like to this, Thou shalt love thy neighbour*, etc. Whereupon the²² Apostle declaring what those sacrifices be wherewith God is well pleased, joyneth these two together, *to give thanks to God, and to do good to man*. The service which in the fear of God we perform one to another, is an evident and real demonstration of the respect we bear unto God.²³ *To God our goodness extendeth not.*²⁴ He is so high above us, so perfect and complete in himself, that neither can

¹⁸submitting., submit.

¹⁹Note.

²⁰Doct.

²¹*Matt.* 22. 38, 39.

²²*Heb.* 13. 15, 16.

²³*Psal.* 16. 2.

²⁴*Iob* 22. 3. & 35. 7.

we give to him, nor he receive of us. But in his own stead he hath placed our brother like to our selves; to whom,²⁵ as we may do hurt, so by our faithful service we may do much²⁶ good: in doing whereof God is much honoured.

This discovereth their hypocrisy, who make great pretence²⁷ of praising God, and yet are scornful, and disdainful to their brethren, and slothful to do any service to man: *These mens religion is vain*. By this note did the Prophets²⁸ in their time, and Christ and his Apostles in their time also, discover the hypocrisy of those among whom they lived: and so may we also in our times. For many there be, who frequently in their houses, and in the midst of the Congregation sing praise unto God, and perform other parts of Gods outward worship, but towards one another, are proud, stout, envious, unmerciful, unjust, slanderous, and very backward to do any good service. Surely, that outward service which they pretend to perform to God, doth not so much wipe out the spot of profaneness, as their neglect of duty unto man brandeth their foreheads with the stamp of hypocrisy.²⁹

For our parts, let us not upon pretext of one duty, though it may seem to be the waigtier, think to shift off another; lest that fearful woe which Christ denounced against the *Scribes* and *Pharisees* fall upon our pates. As God is careful to instruct us how to carry our selves both to his own Majesty, and also one to another, so let us in both approve our selves to him: remembering what Christ said to the Pharisees, *These ought ye to have done, and not to leave the other undone*. The same Lord that requireth praise to his own Majesty, inioyneth mutual service one to another; the neglect of this, as well as of that, sheweth too light respect of his will and pleasure: *What therefore God*³⁰ *hath joined together, let not man put asunder*.

§. 3. *Of every ones submitting himself to another.*

²⁵*Iob* 35. 8.

²⁶*Psal.* 16. 3.

²⁷1. *Use*. A note of hypocrisy.

²⁸*Iam.* 1. 26. *Isa.* 58. 3 etc. *Mic.* 6. 6. etc. *Matt.* 23. 14. 1 *Ioh.* 4. 20.

²⁹2. *Use*. Put not off one duty with another. *Matt.* 23. 23.

³⁰*Matth.* 19. 6.

Again, as this verse hath reference to that which followeth, it declareth the general sum of all, which is mutually to submit our selves one to another in the fear of God. The parts hereof are two:

- 1. An Exhortation.
- 2. A Direction.

In the exhortation is noted, both the *duty* it self in this word *submit*, and also the *parties* to whom it is to be performed, *one to another*.

Both branches of the exhortation, viz. The *duty*, and the *parties* joined together, afford this doctrine, that

*It is a general mutual duty appertaining to all Christians,*³¹ *to submit themselves one to another:* For this precept is as general as any of the former, belonging to all sorts and degrees whatsoever: and so much doth this word *one another* imply: in which extent the Apostle in another place exhorteth to *serve one another:* and again, *every man to seek*³² *another's wealth.*

Concerning *inferiors*, it is without question clear, that³³ they ought to submit themselves to their superiors: yea, concerning *equals* no great question can be made, but they *in giving honour must go one before another*, and so submit³⁴ themselves: but concerning *superiors*, just question may be made, whether it be a duty required of them to submit themselves to their inferiors.

To resolve this doubt, we must first distinguish betwixt³⁵ subjection of *reverence*, and subjection of *service*.

Subjection of reverence is that whereby one testifieth an eminency and superiority in them whom he reverenceth, and that in speech, by giving them titles of honour; or in gesture, by some kind of obeisance; or in action, by a ready obeying of their commandment. This is proper to inferiors.

Subjection of service is that whereby one in his place is³⁶ ready to do what good he can to another. This is common to all Christians: a duty which even superiors owe to inferiors, according to the fore-named extent

³¹2. *Doct.*

³²*Gal. 5. 13. 1 Cor. 10. 24.*

³³*Quest.*

³⁴*Rom. 12. 10.* How superiors ought to subject themselves.

³⁵*Answ.*

³⁶Difference betwixt subjection of *Reverence* and *Service*.

of this word *one another*: in which respect even the highest governor on earth is called a *minister*, for the good of such as³⁷ are under him.

Secondly, we must put difference betwixt the *work* it³⁸ self, and the *manner* of doing it. That work which in it self is a work of superiority and authority, in the manner of doing it may be a work of submission, viz. If it be done in humility and meekness of mind. The Magistrate by ruling with meekness and humility, submiteth himself to his subject. In this respect the Apostle exhorteth that *nothing* (no not the highest and greatest works that³⁹ can be) *be done in vain-glory, but in meekness*.

Thirdly, we must distinguish betwixt the several places wherein men are: for even they who are superiors to some,⁴⁰ are inferiors to others: as he that said, *I have under me, and am under authority*. The master that hath servants under him, may be under the authority of a Magistrate. Yea, God hath so disposed every ones several place, as there is not any one, but in some respect is under another. The wife, though a mother of children, is under her husband. The husband, though head of a family, is under public Magistrates. Public Magistrates one under another, and all under the King. The King himself under God and his word delivered by his Ambassadors, whereunto the highest are to submit themselves. And Ministers of the word, as subjects, are under their Kings and Governors. He that saith, *Let every soul be subject to the higher powers*,⁴¹ excepteth not Ministers of the word: and he that saith, *obey them that have the oversight of you, and submit your selves*,⁴² excepteth not kings: only the difference is in this, that the authority of the king is in himself, and in his own name he may command obedience to be performed to himself: but the authority of a Minister is in Christ, and in Christs name only may he require obedience to be performed to Christ.

The reason why all are bound to submit themselves one⁴³ to another is, because every one is set in his place by God, not so much for himself, as for the good of others: whereupon the Apostle exhorteth, that *none seek*

³⁷Rom. 13. 4.

³⁸Difference betwixt the *work* and *manner* of doing it.

³⁹Phil. 2. 3.

⁴⁰Every one under some authority. *Matth.* 8. 9.

⁴¹Rom. 13. 1.

⁴²Heb. 13. 17. Difference betwixt Magistrates and Ministers authority.

⁴³Reason. Every ones Office for the good of another.

his own, but every man anothers wealth. Even Governors are advanced⁴⁴ to places of dignity and authority, rather for the good of their subjects than for their own honour. Their callings are in truth offices of service, yea burdens under which they must willingly put their shoulders, being called of God, and of which they are to give an account concerning the good which they have done to others: for the effecting whereof, it is needful that they submit themselves.

Let every one therefore high and low, rich and poor,⁴⁵ superior and inferior, Magistrate and subject, Minister and people, husband and wife, parent and child, master and servant, neighbours and fellows, all of all sorts in their several places take notice of their duty in this point of submission, and make conscience to put it in practice: *Magistrates*, by procuring the wealth and peace of their people, as *Mordecai: Ministers*, by making themselves servants⁴⁶ unto their people, not seeking their own profit, but the⁴⁷ profit of many, that they may be saved, as *Paul: fathers*, by well educating their children, and taking heed that they *provoke them not to wrath*, as *David: husbands*,⁴⁸ by dwelling with their wives according to knowledge; giving honour to the wife as to the weaker vessel, as *Abraham*:⁴⁹ *masters*, by doing that which is just and equal to their servants, as the *Centurion*: Every one, by being of like⁵⁰ affection one towards another, and by serving one another in love, according to the Apostles rule. Let this duty of⁵¹ submission be first well learned, and then all other duties will better be performed.

Be not high minded, nor swell one against another.⁵² Though in outward estate some may be higher than other, yet *in Christ all are one whether bond or free: all members of one and the same body*. Now consider the mutual affection (as I may so speak) of the members of a natural body one towards another: not any one of them will puff it self up,⁵³ and rise

⁴⁴1 Cor. 10. 24.

⁴⁵1. Use. Exhortation unto all to do service.

⁴⁶Est. 10. 3.

⁴⁷1 Cor. 9. 19. & 10. 33.

⁴⁸Prou. 4. 3, 4.

⁴⁹Gen. 16. 6.

⁵⁰Luke 7. 2.

⁵¹Rom. 12. 16. Gal. 5. 13.

⁵²2. Use. Dehortation from swelling one against another.

⁵³Gal. 3. 28.

against the other: the head which is the highest⁵⁴ and of greatest honour will submit it self to the feet in performing the duty of an head, as well as the feet to the head in performing their duty; so all other parts. Neither is it hereby implied that they which are in place of dignity and authority should forget or relinquish their place, dignity, or authority, and become as inferiors under authority, no more than the head doth: for the head in submitting it self doth not go upon the ground and bear the body, as the feet; but it submiteth it self by directing and governing the other parts, and that with all the humility, meekness, and gentleness that it can. So must all superiors: much more must equals and inferiors learn with humility, and meekness, without scorn or disdain, to perform their duty: this is that which was before by the Apostle⁵⁵ expressly mentioned, and is here again intimated; none are exempted and privileged from it. We know that it is unnatural, and unbecoming the head to scorn the feet, and to swell against them, but more than monstrous for one hand to scorn another: what shall we then say if the feet swel against the head? Surely such scorn and disdain among the members, would cause not only great disturbance, but also utter ruin to the body. And can it be otherwise in a politic body? But on the contrary, when all of all sorts shall (as hath been before showed) willingly submit themselves one to another, the whole body, and every member thereof will reap good thereby: yea, by this mutual submission, as we do good, so we shall receive good.

§. 4. *Of the fear of God.*

Hitherto of the *exhortation*. The *direction* followeth. *In the fear of the Lord*. This clause is added, to declare partly the *means*, how men may be brought to submit themselves readily one to another: and partly the *manner*, how they ought to submit themselves. *The fear of the Lord* is both the *efficient cause* that moveth a true Christian willingly to perform all duty to man, and also the *end* whereunto he refereth every thing that he doth. For the better conceiving whereof, I will briefly declare

- 1. What this fear of the Lord is.
- 2. How the Lord is the proper object of it.

⁵⁴1 Cor. 12. 27.

⁵⁵Ephes. 4. 2.

- 3. What is the extent thereof.
- 4. Why it is so much urged.

First, fear of God is an awful respect of the divine Majesty.⁵⁶ Sometimes it ariseth from faith in the mercy and goodness of God: for when the heart of man hath once felt a sweet taste of Gods goodness, and found that in his favour only all happiness consisteth, it is stricken with such an inward awe and reverence, as it would not for any thing displease⁵⁷ his Majesty, but rather do whatsoever it may know to be pleasing and acceptable unto him. For these are two effects which arise from this kind of fear of God:

1. *A careful endeavour to please God*, in which respect⁵⁸ good king *Jehosaphat* having exhorted his Judges to execute the judgment of the Lord aright, addeth this clause as a motive thereunto, *Let the fear of the Lord be upon you*: implying thereby that Gods fear would make them endeavour to approve themselves to God.
2. *A careful avoiding of such things as offend the Majesty of God*, and grieve his spirit: in which respect the Wiseman⁵⁹ saith, *The fear of the Lord is to hate evil*: and of *Iob* it is⁶⁰ said that he *fearing God departed from evil*.⁶¹

Sometimes again, awe and dread of the divine Majesty ariseth from diffidence: For when a mans heart doubteth of Gods mercy, and expecteth nothing but vengeance, the very thought of God striketh an awe or rather dread into him, and so maketh him fear God.

From this double cause of fear, whereof one is contrary⁶² to another, hath arisen that usual distinction of a *filial* or son-like fear, and a *servile* or slavish fear: which distinction is grounded on these words of the Apostle, *ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear* (this is⁶³ a servile fear) *but ye have received the spirit of adoption*⁶⁴ *whereby we cry, Abba, father*: this causeth a filial fear. The *filial* fear is such a fear as dutiful

⁵⁶1. What the fear of God is. The causes of it.

⁵⁷Two effects of a filial fear of God.

⁵⁸*Deum timere est nulla mala facere, & nulla bona quae faci enda sunt praeterire.* Bernard. de modo bene viuen. ser. 4.

⁵⁹2 Chro. 19. 6, 7.

⁶⁰Prou. 8. 13.

⁶¹Job. 1. 1.

⁶²Difference betwixt filial and servile fear.

⁶³Bernard. loc. citat.

⁶⁴Rom. 8. 15.

children bear to their fathers. But the *servile* fear is such an one as bond-slaves bear to their masters. A son feareth simply to offend or displease his father: so as⁶⁵ it is accompanied with love. A bonds slave feareth nothing but the punishment of his offence; so as it is joined with hatred: and such an one feareth not to sin, but to burn in hell for sin. Faithful *Abraham* like a gracious child feared God (as Gods Angell beareth witness, *Gen.* 22. 12.) when he was ready rather to sacrifice his only son, then offend God by refusing to⁶⁶ obey his commandment. But faithless *Adam* like a servile bonds slave feared God (as he himself testifieth against himself *Gen.* 3 10.) when after he had broken Gods commandment, he hid himself from the presence of God. This slavish fear is a plain diabolical fear (for *the devils*⁶⁷ so fear as they *tremble*;) It maketh men wish there were no hell, no day of *Judgment*, no Judge, yea no God. This is that fear *without which* we must serve the Lord. In this⁶⁸ fear to submit ones self is nothing acceptable to God: It is therefore the *filial fear* which is here meant.

Secondly, of this fear God is the proper *object*, as by⁶⁹ this and many more testimonies of Scripture is evident, where the fear of *God* and of *the Lord* is mentioned. This fear hath so proper a relation unto God, as the Scripture styleth God by a kind of propriety, with this title *Fear*: for where *Jacob* mentioneth *the fear of Isaac*, he meaneth⁷⁰ the Lord whom *Isaac* feared.

It is then unlawful to fear any but God?⁷¹

No: men also may be feared, as Princes, parents, masters,⁷² and other superiors; For the Apostle exhorting to give every one their due, giveth this instance, *fear*,⁷³ *to whom fear is due*. But yet may God notwithstanding be said to be the proper object of fear, because all the fear that any way is due to any creature, is due to him in and for the Lord whose image he carrieth: so as in truth it is not so much the person of a man, as the image of God

⁶⁵*Est timor ne amittatur gratia beneficij. Hic timor cast us est, non eum charitas eijcit, sed asciscit. August. epist. 120.*

⁶⁶*Qui gehennas metuit, non peccare metuit sed ardere. Aug. epist. 144.*

⁶⁷*Jam. 2. 19.*

⁶⁸*Luke 1. 74.*

⁶⁹2. How God is the proper object of fear.

⁷⁰*Gen. 31. 42, 53.*

⁷¹Quest.

⁷²*Ans.* How men are to be feared.

⁷³*Rom. 13. 7.*

placed in him, by virtue of some authority or dignity appertaining to him, which is to be feared. If there should fall out any such opposition betwixt God and man, as in fearing man our fear would be withdrawn from God, then the rule of Christ is to take place, which is this, *fear not them which⁷⁴ kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul: but rather fear him which is able to destroy both soul and body in hell.*

Thirdly, the extent of this true filial fear of God is⁷⁵ very large. No one point throughout the whole Scripture is more urged than this *fear of the Lord*. It is oft added to other duties, as that whereby they are seasoned, and without which they cannot well be performed: wherefore we are commanded to *serve the Lord in fear, to perfect holiness⁷⁶ in the fear of God, to work out our salvation with fear:* and⁷⁷ the Churches are commended for *walking in the fear of the⁷⁸⁷⁹ Lord*: so likewise particular men as⁸⁰ Abram,⁸¹ Joseph,⁸² Iob, and many other: yea the whole worship of God is oft comprised under this branch of *fear*: whereupon our Saviour Christ alleaging this text, *thou shalt fear the Lord thy God,*⁸³ thus expresseth it, *thou shalt worship the Lord thy God.* And⁸⁴ again where the Lord by his Prophet Isay saith, *Their fear⁸⁵ toward me is taught by the precept of men,* Christ thus quoteth that text, *In vain do they worship me, teaching for doctrines⁸⁶ the commandments of men:* out of which places compared together, it is evident, that under the *fear* of God, is comprised the *worship* of God. Yea, all that duty which we owe to God and man is comprised under this title, *the fear of God*: for David when he would in one word declare the sum and substance of all that which a Minister ought to teach his people, saith, *I will teach you the fear of⁸⁷ the Lord.*⁸⁸

⁷⁴Matth. 10. 28.

⁷⁵3. Every duty to be seasoned with a fear of God.

⁷⁶Psal. 2. 11.

⁷⁷2 Cor. 7. 1.

⁷⁸Phil. 2. 12.

⁷⁹Acts 9. 31.

⁸⁰a Gen. 22. 12.

⁸¹b & 42. 18.

⁸²c Iob 1. 1.

⁸³Deut. 6. 13.

⁸⁴Matth. 4. 10.

⁸⁵Isa. 29. 13.

⁸⁶Matth. 15. 9.

⁸⁷Psal. 34. 11.

Fourthly, The reason why the Holy Ghost so much urgeth *the fear of God*, and that in so large an extent as hath been showed, I take to be this; to show a difference betwixt that integrity and perfection of Gods image which was at mans creation first planted in him, and the renovation thereof while here he liveth in this world. So complete and perfect was then Gods image in man, as he needed no other motive to provoke him to any duty but *love*. Wherefore when the Holy Ghost would set forth that perfection of Gods image first planted in man, he addeth this title *love* unto other duties, whether they concern God or man. Concerning God, *Moses* exhorteth Israel to *love the⁸⁹ Lord and serve him*: and again, *to love the Lord, to walk in⁹⁰ his ways, to keep his commandments, etc.* Concerning man, the Apostle exhorteth to *serve one another by love*: and to *do⁹¹ all things in love*. Yea, sometimes the Holy Ghost is pleased⁹² to comprise all duties under *love*: In which respect Christ calleth this commandment (*Thou shalt love the Lord*) the⁹³ *great commandment*, which compriseth all the commandments of the first table under it: and for the second table, *S. Paul* saith, that *love is the fulfilling of the law*. But by *Adam's⁹⁴ fall*, and the corruption which thereby infected mans nature, the love of God hath waxed cold in man, and though the Saints be created again according to that image of God, yet while in this world they live, that image is not so perfect as it was, the flesh remaineth in the best: in which respect God hath fast fixed this affection of *fear* in mans heart, and thereby both restraineth him from sin, and also provoketh him unto every good duty.

§. 5. *Of the fear of God moving us to do service to men.*

Having briefly declared the *nature, object, extent, and use* of fear, I return to the point in hand, *viz.* to show 1. How it is here laid down as a motive to stir up men to perform the duty here required: for by this clause, *in the fear of the Lord*, the Apostle implieth that

⁸⁸4. Why a fear of God is so much urged.

⁸⁹*Deut.* 11. 13.

⁹⁰*Deut.* 30. 16.

⁹¹*Gal.* 5. 13.

⁹²*1 Cor.* 16. 14.

⁹³*Matth.* 22. 38.

⁹⁴*Rom.* 13. 10.

It is the fear of God which moveth men conscionably to submit⁹⁵ themselves one to another. This made⁹⁶ *David* so well to rule the people of God: and⁹⁷ *Joseph* to deal so well with his brethren: yea,⁹⁸ this is noted to be the cause of the righteous regiment of Christ himself. Well did that good King *Jehosaphat* know this, and therefore when he appointed Judges over his people, as a motive to stir them up to execute the judgments of the Lord aright, he saith unto them, *Let the fear of the Lord be upon you.* So also *S. Peter*,⁹⁹ to move subjects to honour their King, prefixeth this exhortation, *Fear God.*¹⁰⁰

By fear of man, may one be brought to submit himself¹⁰¹ to another: as a magistrate may be moved to deal justly and mildly with his people through fear of insurrections and rebellions: subjects may by severe lawes and tyranny be brought to submit themselves: and so other inferiors also by threats, by hard usage, and other by-respects.

1. Though fear of man be a motive, yet it followeth¹⁰² not, that therefore fear of God should be no motive: it may be another motive, and a better motive.
 2. The submission which is performed through fear of¹⁰³ man is a forced and a slavish submission, nothing acceptable to God: but that which is performed through a true filial fear of God, is a free, willing, ready, cheerful, conscionable submission: such a submission as will stir us up to do the best good we can thereby unto them, to whom we submit our selves, and so is more acceptable to God, by reason of the cause thereof, and more profitable unto man, by reason of the effect and fruit thereof.
- For a true fear of God maketh us more respect what¹⁰⁴ God requireth and commandeth, than what our corrupt heart desireth and suggesteth: It subdueth our unruly passions, and bringeth them within compass of duty: It maketh us deny our selves and our own desires: and though through

⁹⁵Doct.

⁹⁶2. *Sam.* 23. 3.

⁹⁷*Gen.* 42. 18.

⁹⁸*Isa.* 11. 2, 3.

⁹⁹2 *Chron.* 19. 7.

¹⁰⁰1 *Pet.* 2. 17.

¹⁰¹Object.

¹⁰²Answ.

¹⁰³Difference betwixt doing a thing for fear of God and fear of man.

¹⁰⁴*Reason.* The power of a fear of God.

the corruption of our nature and inborn pride we be loth to submit, yet will Gods fear bring down that proud mind, and make us humble and gentle. It will keep those who are in authority from tyranny, cruelty, and over-much severity: and it will keep those who are under subjection from dissimulation, deceit, and privy conspiracies.

Behold how necessary it is, that a true fear of the Lord¹⁰⁵ be planted in mens hearts, in the hearts of Kings and all Governors, in the hearts of subjects and all people, whether superiors or inferiors. Where no fear of God is, there will be no good submission unto man. *Abraham*¹⁰⁶ thought that the men of Gerar would have no respect to him or his wife, nor make conscience of common honesty, nor abstain from innocent blood, because *he saw no fear of God in that place*: and the Apostle having reckoned up¹⁰⁷ many notorious effects of mans natural corruption, concludeth all with this, as the cause of all, *There is no fear of God before their eyes*. Wherefore let Magistrates, parents, masters, and all in authority, have especial care that their subjects, children, servants, and all under them may be taught and brought to fear the Lord. I dare avouch it, that such inferiors which are taught to fear God, will do better seruiee to their superiors, than such as fear their superiors only as men, and fear not God. Let Ministers especially urge and press upon the consciences of men a fear of God. Let all inferiors pray that the fear of the Lord may be planted in the hearts of their superiors, that so they may live a quiet and peaceable life in all godliness and honesty under them. Happy is that kingdom where Magistrates and subjects fear the Lord. Happy is that Church where Ministers and people fear the Lord. Happy is that family where husband and wife, parents and children, master and servants fear the Lord. In such a Kingdom, Church, and family, will every one, to the mutual good one of another, submit themselves one to another. But if such as fear not God submit themselves, whether they be superiors or inferiors, it is for their own ends and advantages, and not for their good to whom they submit themselves.

¹⁰⁵ *Use*. The necessity of a fear of God.

¹⁰⁶ *Gen.* 20. 11.

¹⁰⁷ *Rom.* 3. 11, etc.

§. 6. *Of limiting all duty to man, within the compass of the fear of God.*

Again, as this clause (*In the fear of the Lord*) declareth the manner of submission, it sheweth, that

*No submission is to be performed unto man, but that which*¹⁰⁸ *may stand with the fear of God.* Whereby we show that we have respect to God, and labour above all to approve our selves to him. Thus *David* is commanded to *rule in the*¹⁰⁹ *fear of God:* and other Magistrates to perform their duty¹¹⁰ *in the fear of the Lord:* which *Nehemiah* that good Governor¹¹¹ was careful to do. So also subjects are to obey in the *fear of the Lord*, which the Apostle implieth by prefixing¹¹² this precept, *Fear God*, before that, *honour the King*; as if he had said, so honour the King, as in and thereby you may manifest your fear of God: let not this latter cross the former. Servants likewise are commanded to be obedient unto their masters with this proviso, *fearing the Lord*. Such¹¹³ phrases as these, *For the Lords sake*, *As unto the Lord*, *In the*¹¹⁴ *Lord*, *As servants of Christ*, with the like, being annexed to¹¹⁵ the duties of inferiors, do imply as much.

Great reason there is that all service should be limited¹¹⁶ with the *fear of God*: for God is the highest Lord to whom all service primarily and principally is due: whatsoever service is due to any man, high or low, is due in and for the Lord. The Lord hath set superiors in the places of eminency, wherein they bear the image of God. The Lord also hath set inferiors in their places, and commended them as his charge to the government of those who are over them. He that obeyeth not those who are over him *in the fear of God*, sheweth no respect of Gods image: and he who governeth not those who are under him *in the fear of God*, sheweth no respect of Gods charge.

¹⁰⁸Doct.

¹⁰⁹2 *Sam.* 23. 3.

¹¹⁰2 *Chro.* 19. 9.

¹¹¹*Neh.* 5. 15.

¹¹²1 *Pet.* 2. 17.

¹¹³*Coloss.* 3. 22.

¹¹⁴1 *Pet.* 2. 13.

¹¹⁵*Eph.* 5. 22. & 6. 1, 6.

¹¹⁶1. *Reason.* God the highest Lord.

Besides, God is that great Judge to whom all of all sorts,¹¹⁷ superiors and inferiors are to give an account of their service. Though by our service we have never so well approved our selves to men, yet if we have not therein had respect unto God, and approved our selves to him, with what face may we appear before his dreadful judgment seat?¹¹⁸ Can the favour of those whom we have pleased in this world, protect and shelter us from the fury of Gods displeasure?

Behold the folly of such Governors as wholly apply themselves to the fancy of their people, yea though it be against the Lord and his word. This was *Adam's* folly, who¹¹⁹ at his wives motion did eat of the forbidden fruit. This was *Aarons* folly, who to please the people, erected an¹²⁰ Idol. And this was *Sauls* folly, who against Gods express¹²¹ prohibition suffered his people to take some of the spoil of the Amalekites. The like may be said of *Joash*, who¹²² hearkned to his Princes to set up Idols: and of *Pilate*, who¹²³ to please the people, against his conscience, delivered Christ to be crucified. The fearful issue of this their submission, not seasoned with a fear of God, but contrary thereunto, may be a warning to all superiors, to take heed how they seek to please them that are under them, more than God who is above them. The issue of *Adam's*, *Aarons*, *Sauls*, and *Joash* his base submission, is noted by the Holy Ghost in their several histories. Of *Pilate* it is recorded, that being¹²⁴ brought into extreme necessity, he laid violent hands upon himself.

Neither is it to be accounted folly only in superiors to submit themselves to their inferiors against the Lord, but also in inferiors to their superiors: for thereby they show that they fear man more than God, which Christ expressly¹²⁵ forbiddeth his friends to do. The captains which went¹²⁶ to fetch *Elijah*, obeyed their king therein; but what got they thereby? Was the king able to save them from the fire which God

¹¹⁷2. *Reason*. God the Judge of all.

¹¹⁸1. *Use*. The folly of all those who fear man more than God.

¹¹⁹*Gen.* 3. 6.

¹²⁰*Exod.* 32. 1.

¹²¹1 *Sam.* 15. 21.

¹²²2 *Chro.* 24 7.

¹²³*Mark* 15. 15.

¹²⁴*Euscb. hist. Eccl. lib* 2. *cap.* 7.

¹²⁵*Luke* 12. 4, 5.

¹²⁶2 *King.* 1. 9, etc.

sent down from heaven upon them? The women¹²⁷ reprov'd for offering incense to the Queen of heaven, did it not without their husbands, yet were they not excused thereby. The children and others in the family¹²⁸ submitted themselves to *Dathan* and *Abiram* in standing in the door of their tents at defiance against *Moses*; but because it was not in the Lord, but against him, they were not exempted from the judgment. Wherefore let all of all sorts set the *fear of God* as a mark before them to aim at in all their actions. Let superiors¹²⁹ neither do any thing to give content to their inferiors:¹³⁰ nor suffer any thing to be done for their sakes by their inferiors, which cannot stand with the *fear of God*. And let inferiors¹³¹ nor do,¹³²¹³³ nor forbear to do at the will of their superiors any thing swerving from the fear of God: but *every one submit themselves one to another in the fear of God*.

¹²⁷*Ier.* 44. 19.

¹²⁸*Numb.* 16. 32.

¹²⁹*Numb.* 11. 29.

¹³⁰1 *Sam.* 24. 8. & 26. 9.

¹³¹*Gen.* 39. 10.

¹³²1 *Sam.* 22. 17.

¹³³*Act.* 4. 19.

Particular Callings and the Wife's Submission

§. 7. *Of performing the duties of particular callings.*

EPHES. 5. 22.

Wives submit your selves unto your own husbands, as unto
the Lord.

From that general direction concerning mutual submission, the Apostle cometh to certain particulars, by which he exemplifieth the same: and teacheth us, that

It is not sufficient to perform general duties of Christianity,¹³⁴ unless also we be conscionable in performing the particular duties of our several callings. A conscionable performance of those particular duties is one part of our¹³⁵ *walking worthy of the vocation wherewith we are called:* and therefore the Apostle, for illustration and exemplification thereof, doth reckon up sundry particulars, both in this and¹³⁶ other Epistles: and so do¹³⁷ other Apostles. And¹³⁸ *Titus* is charged to teach them. God himself hath given a pattern hereof in his Law: for the main scope of the fifth Commandment¹³⁹ tendeth to instruct us in the particular duties of our several callings.

Hereby much credit is brought to our profession, and the¹⁴⁰ *doctrine of God our Saviour is adorned.* And much good is hereby both mutually communicated one to another, and received one from another: for our

¹³⁴Doct.

¹³⁵*Eph.* 4. 1.

¹³⁶*Col.* 3. 18, etc. *1 Cor.* 7. 1 *Tim.* 3.

¹³⁷*1 Pet.* 2. & 3.

¹³⁸*Tit.* 2.

¹³⁹See more of this point in *The whole armour of God*, Treat. 2. part 1. §. 4.

¹⁴⁰*Tit.* 2. 10. *1 Pet.* 3. 1, 2.

particular places and callings are those bonds whereby persons are firmly and fitly knit together, as the members of a natural body by nerves, arteries, sinews, veins, and the like, by which life, sense and motion is communicated from one to another.

Let therefore notice be taken of the particular callings¹⁴¹ wherein God hath set us, and of the several duties of those callings, and conscience be used in the practise of them. He is no good Christian that is careless herein. A bad husband, wife, parent, child, master, servant, magistrate or minister, is no good Christian.

§. 8. Of the lawfulness of private functions in a family.

Among other particular callings the Apostle maketh choice of those which God hath settled in private families, and is accurat in reciting the several and distinct orders thereof, (for a family consisteth of these three orders, *husbands, wives, parents, children, masters, servants*, all which he reckoneth up) yea he is also copious, and earnest in urging the duties which appertain to them. Whence we may well infer, that

The private vocations of a family, and functions appertaining¹⁴² thereto, are such as Christians are called unto by God, and in the exercising whereof, they may and must employ some part of their time. For can we think that the Holy Ghost (who, as the Philosophers speak of nature, *doth nothing in vain*) would so distinctly set down these private duties, & so forcibly urge them, if they did not well become, and nearly concern Christians? All the places in Scripture which require family-duties, are proofs of the truth of this doctrine.

The reasons of this doctrine are clear; for the family is¹⁴³ a seminary of the Church and common-wealth. It is as a Be-hive, in which is the stock, and out of which are sent many swarms of Bees: for in families are all sorts of people bred and brought up: and out of families are they sent into the Church and common-wealth. The first beginning of mankind, and of his increase, was out of a family. For first did God join in marriage *Adam* and *Eve*, made them husband and wife, and then gave them children:

¹⁴¹ Use.

¹⁴² 2 *Doctr.* Private duties of the family well beseem any Christian.. *Arist. Polit. lib. 1*

¹⁴³ *Reason.* The family a seminary.

so as husband and wife, parent and child, (which are parts of a family) were before magistrate and subject, minister and people, which are the parts of a common-wealth, and a Church. When by the general deluge all public societies were destroyed, a family, even the family of *Noah*, was preserved, and out of it kingdoms and nations again raised. That great people of the Jews which could not be numbered for multitude, was raised out of the family of *Abram*. Yea even to this day have all sorts of people come from families, and so shall to the end of the world. Whence it followeth, that a conscionable performance of domestical and household duties, tend to the good ordering of Church and common-wealth, as being means to fit and prepare men thereunto.

Besides, a family is a little Church, and a little commonwealth,¹⁴⁴ at least a lively representation thereof, whereby trial may be made of such as are fit for any place of authority, or of subjection in Church or common-wealth. Or rather it is as a school wherein the first principles and grounds of government and subjection are learned: whereby men are fitted to greater matters in Church or commonwealth. Wherupon the¹⁴⁵ Apostle declareth, that a Bishop that cannot rule his own house, is not fit to govern the Church. So we may say of inferiors that cannot be subject in a family; they will hardly be brought to yield such subjection as they ought in Church or common-wealth: instance *Absalom*, and *Adoniah*, *David's* sons.

This is to be noted for satisfaction of certain weak¹⁴⁶ consciences, who think that if they have no public calling, they have no calling at all; and thereupon gather that all their time is spent without a calling. Which consequence if it were good and sound, what comfort in spending their time should most women have, who are not admitted to any public function in Church or commonwealth? Or servants, children, and others who are wholly employed in private affairs of the family? But the fore-named doctrine sheweth the unsoundness of that consequence. Besides, who knoweth not that the preservation of families tendeth to the good of Church and common-wealth? So as a conscionable performance of household duties, in regard of the end and fruit thereof, may be accounted a public work. Yea, if domestical duties be well and thoroughly performed,

¹⁴⁴2 *Reason*. A family is a representation of Church and commonwealth.

¹⁴⁵1. *Tim.* 3. 5.

¹⁴⁶1 *Use*. Privat callings in a family sufficient callings.

they will be even enough to take up a mans whole time. If a master of a family be also an husband of a wife, and a father of children, he shall find work enough: as by those particular duties, which we shall afterwards show to belong unto masters, husbands, and parents, may easily be proved. So a wife likewise, if she also be a mother and a mistris, and faithfully endeavour to do what by virtue of those callings she is bound to do, shall find enough to do. As for children under the government of their parents, and servants in a family, their whole calling is to be obedient to their parents and masters, and to do what they command them in the Lord. Wherefore if they who have no public calling, be so much the more diligent in the functions of their private callings, they shall be as well accepted of the Lord, as if they had public offices.

Yet many therebe, who having no public employment, think they may spend their time as they list, either in idleness,¹⁴⁷ or in following their vain pleasures and delights day after day, and so cast themselves out of all calling. Such are many masters of families who commit all the care of their house either to their wives, or to some servant, and mispend their whole time in idleness, riotousness, and voluptuousness. Such are many mistresses, who spend their time in lying a bed, attiring themselves, and goshipping. Such are many young gentlemen living in their fathers houses, who partly through the too-much-indulgency and negligence of their parents, and partly through their own headstrong affections, and rebellious will, run without restraint whither their corrupt lusts lead them. These, and such other like to these, though by Gods providence they be placed in callings, in warrantable callings, and in such callings as minister unto them matter enough of employment, yet make themselves to be of no calling. Now what blessing can they look for from the Lord? The Lord useth¹⁴⁸ to give his blessing to men, while they are busied in their callings.¹⁴⁹ *Jaacobs* faithful service to his uncle *Laban* moved God to bless him.¹⁵⁰ *Josephs* faithfulness to his master *Potiphar* was had in remembrance with God, who advanced him to be ruler in Egypt.¹⁵¹ *Moses* was keeping his father

¹⁴⁷2 Use. Reproof of such as having no public office, think themselves freed from all duty.

¹⁴⁸ Gods blessing on men diligent in their calling.

¹⁴⁹*Gen.* 31. 42.

¹⁵⁰*Gen.* 39. 2.

¹⁵¹*Exo.* 3. 1, 2.

in lawes sheep when God appeared to him in the bush, and appointed him a Prince over his people.¹⁵² *David* was sent for from the field, where he was keeping his fathers sheep, when he was anointed to be king over Israel.¹⁵³ *Elisha* was plowing when he was anointed to be a Prophet.¹⁵⁴ The shepherds were watching their sheep, when that gladsome tidings was brought to them, that the Saviour of the world was borne. Not to insist on any more particulars, the promise of Gods protection is restrained to our callings: for¹⁵⁵ the charge which God hath given to the Angels concerning man is, to keep him *in all his ways*.

As for those who have public offices in Church or¹⁵⁶ common-wealth, they may not thereupon think themselves exempted from all family-duties. These private duties are necessary duties. Though a man be a magistrate or a minister, yet if he be an husband, or a father, or a master, he may not neglect his wife, children, and servants. Indeed they who are freed from public functions, are bound to attend so much the more upon the private duties of their families, because they have more leisure thereunto. But none ought wholly to neglect them.¹⁵⁷ *Joshua*, who was a Captain and Prince of his people, and very much employed in public affairs, yet neglected not his family: for he professeth that he and *his house* would serve the Lord. It seemeth that¹⁵⁸ *Eli* was negligent in performing the duty of a father, and¹⁵⁹ *David* also. But what followed thereupon? Two of *Elis* sons proved sacrilegious, and lewd Priests. Two of *David's* sons proved very ill commonwealths-men, even plain traitors.

§. 9. Of the Apostles order in laying down the duties of husbands and wives in the first place.

¹⁵² 1 *Sam.* 16. 11

¹⁵³ 1 *King.* 19. 19.

¹⁵⁴ *Luk.* 2. 8.

¹⁵⁵ *Psal.* 91. 11.

¹⁵⁶ 3. *Use.* Public callings may not hinder private duties.

¹⁵⁷ *Ios.* 24. 15.

¹⁵⁸ 1 *Sam.* 2. 29. & 3. 13.

¹⁵⁹ 1 *King.* 1. 6.

There being three especial degrees, or orders in a family,¹⁶⁰ (as we heard before) the Apostle placeth husband and wife in the first rank, and first declareth their duties, and that not without good reason: for

First, The husband and wife were the first couple that¹⁶¹ ever were in the world. *Adam* and *Eve* were joined in marriage, and made man and wife before they had children, or servants. So falleth it out for the most part even to this day in erecting, or bringing together a family: the first couple is ordinarily an husband and a wife.

Secondly, most usually the husband and his wife are the¹⁶² chiefest in a family, all under them single persons: they governors of all the rest in the house. Therefore most meet it is, that they should first know their duty, and learn to practise it, that so they may be an example to all the rest. If they fail in their duty one to another, they give occasion to all the rest under them to be careless, and negligent in theirs. Let an husband be churlish to his wife, and despise her, he ministreth an occasion to children and servants to contemn her likewise, and to be disobedient unto her: yea, to be churlish and froward one to another, especially to their underlings. Let a wife be untrusty and unfaithful to her husband, let her filch and purloin from him, children and servants will soon take courage, or rather boldness from her example privily to steal what they can from their father, and master. Thus is their breach of¹⁶³ duty a double fault: one in respect of the party whom they wrong, and to whom they deny duty: the other in respect of those to whom they give occasion of sinning.

Know therefore, O husbands and wives, that ye, above¹⁶⁴ all other in the family, are most bound unto a conscionable performance of your duty. Greater will your condemnation be, if you fail therein. Look to it above the rest: and by your example draw on your children and servants (if you have any) to perform their duties: which surely they will more readily do, when they shall behold you as guides going before them, and making conscience of your joint and several duties.

¹⁶⁰ Why duties of man and wife first delivered.

¹⁶¹ 1. Man and wife were the first couple.

¹⁶² 2. Man and wife are commonly the chiefest in a family.

¹⁶³ *Bis peccat qui exemplo peccat.*

¹⁶⁴ Use.

§. 10. *Of the Apostles order in setting down inferiors duties in the first place.*¹⁶⁵

In handling the duties of the first forenamed couple, the Apostle begineth with wives, and layeth down their particular duties in the first place. The reason of this order I take to be the *inferiority* of the wife to her husband. I do the rather take it so to be, because I observe this to be his usual method and order, first to declare the duties of inferiors, and then of superiors: For in handling the duties of¹⁶⁶ children and parents, and of¹⁶⁷ servants and masters, he begineth with the inferiors, both in this, and¹⁶⁸ in other Epistles; which order also¹⁶⁹ *S. Peter* obserueth: yea,¹⁷⁰ the law it self doth in the first place, and that expressly, mention the inferiors duty, only implying the superiors to follow as a just consequence, which is this, *If the inferior must give honour, and by virtue thereof perform such duties as appertain thereto, then must the superior carry himself worthy of honour, and by virtue thereof perform answerable duties.*

Quest. Why should inferiors duties be more fully¹⁷¹ expressed, and placed in the first rank?

Answ. Surely because for the most part inferiors are most unwilling to undergo the duties of their place. Who is not more ready to rule, than to be subject?

I deny not but that it is a far more difficult and hard matter to govern well than to obey well. For to rule and¹⁷² govern requireth more knowledge, experience, wisdom, care, watchfulness, diligence, and other like virtues, than to obey and be subject. He that obeyeth hath his rule laid before him, which is the will and command of his¹⁷³ superior in things lawful, and not against Gods will. But the superior who commandeth, is to consider not only what is lawful, but also what is most fit, meet,

¹⁶⁵Wives particular duties first laid down, because they are inferiors.

¹⁶⁶*Eph.* 6. 1.

¹⁶⁷*Ephes.* 6. 5.

¹⁶⁸*Col.* 3. 18, 20, 22.

¹⁶⁹*1 Pet.* 3. 1.

¹⁷⁰*Exod.* 20. 12.

¹⁷¹Inferiors duties first taught, because they are most backward and loth to perform them.

¹⁷²Greater difficulty in ruling well, than in obeying.

¹⁷³*Ducem velim qui à fronte pariter, & tergo sit oculatus.* *Timoth.* apud *Plutarch.*

convenient, and every way the best: yea also he must forecast for the time to come, and so far as he can observe whether that which is now for the present meet enough, may not be dangerous for the time to come, and in that respect unmeet to be urged. Whence it followeth, that the *superior in authority* may sin in commanding that which the *inferior in subjection* may upon his command do without sin. Who can justly charge *Joab* with sin in numbering the¹⁷⁴ people, when *David* urged him by virtue of his authority¹⁷⁵ so to do? Yet did *David* sin in commanding it. Without all question *Saul* did sin in charging the people by an oath, to eat no food the day that they pursued their enemies (a time when they had most need to be refreshed with food, as *Jonathans* words imply) and yet did not the people¹⁷⁶ sin in forbearing: witness the event that followed on *Jonathans* eating, though he knew not his fathers charge. Who seeth not hereby, that it is a matter of much more difficulty to rule well, than to obey? Which is yet further evident by Gods wise disposing providence in ordering who should govern, who obey. Commonly the younger¹⁷⁷ for age, the weaker for sex, the meaner for estate, the more ignorant for understanding, with the like, are in places of subjection: but the elder, stronger, wealthier, wiser, and such like persons, are for the most part, or at least should be in place of authority. *Woe to thee ô land* (¹⁷⁸ saith *Solomon*) *when thy king is a child*. And¹⁷⁹ *Isaiah* denounceth it as a curse to *Israel*, that *children shall be their Princes, and babes shall rule over them*, and complaineth¹⁸⁰ that *women had rule over the people*.

Now to return to the point, though it be so that governors have the heaviest burden laid on their shoulders, yet inferiors that are under subjection think their burden the heaviest, and are lothest to bear it, and most willing to cast it away. For naturally there is in every one much¹⁸¹ pride and ambition, which as dust cast on the eyes of their understanding, putteth out the sight thereof, and so maketh them affect superiority, and authority

¹⁷⁴ 2 Sam. 24. 2, etc.

¹⁷⁵ See Treat. 7. §. 37.

¹⁷⁶ 1 Sam. 14. 24. etc.

¹⁷⁷ *Seniores & inter eos optimos, & prudentes & potentes oportet imperare. Iuniores vero parere. Plat. de rep. lib 3.*

¹⁷⁸ Eccl. 10. 16.

¹⁷⁹ Isa. 3. 4.

¹⁸⁰ Isa. 3. 12.

¹⁸¹ Ambition is it which maketh inferiors loth to be subject.

over others, and to be stubborn under the yoke of subjection: which is the cause that in all ages, both by divine, and also by humane lawes, penalties and punishments of divers kinds have been ordained, to keep inferiors in compass of their duty: and yet (such is the pride of mans heart) all will not serve. What age, what place ever was there, which hath¹⁸² not just cause to complain of subjects rebellion, servants stubbornness, childrens disobedience, wives presumption? Not without cause therefore doth the Apostle first declare the duties of inferiors.

Besides, the Apostle would hereby teach those who are under authority, how to move them that are in authority over them, to deal equally and kindly, not hardly and cruelly with them, namely, by endeavouring to perform their own duty first. For what is it that provoketh wrath, rage, and fury in governors? What maketh them that have authority, to deal roughly, and rigorously? Is it not for the most part disobedience, and stoutness in those that are under government? Though some in authority be so proud, so savage, and inhumane, as no honour done to them, no performance of duty can satisfy and content them, but they will (as¹⁸³ *David's* enemies) reward evil for goodness, yet the best general direction that can be prescribed to inferiors, to provoke their governors to deal well with them, is, that inferiors themselves be careful and conscionable in doing their duty first. If their governors on earth be nothing moved therewith, yet will the highest Lord in heaven graciously accept it.

Lastly, men must first learn to obey well, before they¹⁸⁴ can rule well: for they who scorn to be subject to their governors while they are under authority, are like to prove intolerably insolent when they are in authority.

Learn all that are under authority, how to win your governors favour: how to make your yoke easy, and your burden light: how to prevent many mischiefs which by reason of the power of your superiors over you may otherwise fall upon you: First do ye your duty.

There are many weighty reasons to move governors¹⁸⁵ first to begin to do their duty. For,

¹⁸²2. Inferiors duties first delivered, to teach them how to win their governors favour.

¹⁸³*Psal.* 38. 20.

¹⁸⁴3. By obeying, men learn to rule well. *Parendo discas imperare. Arist. Polit. lib.* 3. c. 3. *Use.*

¹⁸⁵Reasons why governors ought first to perform their duties.

First, by virtue of their authority they bear Gods image, therefore in doing their duty they honour that image.

Secondly, by reason of their place they ought to go before such as are under them.

Thirdly, a faithful performance of their duty, is an especial means to keep their inferiors in compass of theirs.

Fourthly, their failing in duty is exemplary: it causeth others under them to fail in theirs, and so it is a double sin.

Fifthly, their reckoning shall be the greater: for of them who have received more, more shall be required.

It were therefore to be wished that superiors and inferiors would strive who should begin first, and who should¹⁸⁶ perform their own part best, and in this kind strive to excel, as runners in a race strive in running to out-strip one another.

But if question be made who shall begin, I advise inferiors not to stand out in this strife, but to think the Apostle¹⁸⁷ first inciteth them: and that it is the safest for them to begin: for in this contention inferiors are like to fare the worst, by reason of the power which superiors have over them. And though it be more against our corrupt, proud, and stout nature, to be subject and obey, yet let us so much the more endeavour to yield duty in this kind. For it is an especial part of spiritual prudence, to observe what our corrupt nature is most prone unto, and wherein it most swelleth up, that therein we may most strive to beat it down: nature is contrary to grace, and the¹⁸⁸ *wisdom of the flesh is enmity against God.*

§. 11. *Of the reasons why wives duties are first taught.*

Quest. Why among other inferiors are wives first brought into the school of Christ to learn their duty?

Answ. Many good reasons may be given of the Apostles order even in this point.

First, of all other inferiors in a family, wives are far the most excellent, and therefore to be placed in the first rank.

¹⁸⁶ *Vterque suum praeoccupet officium. Chrys. hom. 26. in 1 Cor. 11.*

¹⁸⁷ Reasons why inferiors ought first to perform their duties.

¹⁸⁸ *Rom. 8. 7.*

Secondly, wives were the first to whom subjection was enjoined: before there was child or servant in the world, it was said to her, *thy desire shall be subject to thine husband*.¹⁸⁹

Thirdly, wives are the fountain from whence all other degrees spring: and therefore ought first to be cleansed.

Fourthly, this subjection is a good pattern unto children and servants: and a great means to move them to be subject.

Fifthly, I may further add as a truth, which is too manifest by experience in all places, that among all other parties of whom the Holy Ghost requireth subjection, wives for the most part are¹⁹⁰ most back ward in yielding subjection to their husbands. But ye wives that fear God, be careful of your duty: and though it may seem somewhat contrary to¹⁹¹ the common course and practise of wives, yet *follow not a multitude to do evil*. Though it be harsh to corrupt nature,¹⁹² yet beat down that corruption: yea though your husbands be backward in their duties, yet be ye forward, and strive to go before them in yours: remembering what the Lord saith (Mat. 5. 46, 47.) *If you love them which love you, what singular thing do ye?* Yea remembering also what the Apostle saith, (1 Tim. 2. 14.) *The woman was first in the transgression*,¹⁹³ and first had her duty given unto her, and¹⁹⁴ *was made for the man, and not man for the woman*.

Thus shall ye deserve that commendation of good wives,¹⁹⁵ *Many have done vertuously, but ye excel them all*.

Having hitherto handled the forenamed general instructions, I will proceed to a more distinct opening of the words; and collect such observations as thence arise, and then particularly declare the several duties which the three orders in a family owe each to other.

§. 12. Of wives subjection.

EPHES. 5. 22.

¹⁸⁹ Gen. 3. 16.

¹⁹⁰ See Treat. 3. §. 4.

¹⁹¹ Exod. 23. 2.

¹⁹² *Si propter Deum viro parueris, noli proponere quae ab eo fieri deceant, sed ea quibus te legislator secit obnoxiam diligenter exequere.* Chrys. hom. 26. in 1. Cor. 11.

¹⁹³ Gen. 3. 16.

¹⁹⁴ 1 Cor. 11. 9.

¹⁹⁵ Prou. 31. 29.

*Wives submit your selves unto your own husbands, as unto
the Lord.*

The word by which the Apostle hath noted out the duties of wives, is of the middle voice, and may be translated passively as¹⁹⁶ many have done, or¹⁹⁷ actively as our English doth (*submit your selves*) and that most fitly: for there is a double subjection.

1. A *necessary* subjection: which is the subjection of *order*.
2. A *Voluntary* subjection: which is the subjection of *duty*. The necessary subjection is that degree of inferiority, wherein God hath placed all inferiors, and whereby he hath subjected them to their superiors, that is, set them in a lower rank. By virtue thereof, though inferiors seek to exalt themselves above their superiors, yet are they subject unto them, their ambition doth not take away that order which God hath established. A wife is in an inferior degree, though she domineer never so much over her husband.

The *Voluntary* subjection, is that dutiful respect which inferiors carry towards those whom God hath set over them: whereby they manifest a willingness to yield to that order which God hath established. Because God hath placed them under their superiors, they will in all duty manifest that subjection which their place requireth.

Because it is a duty which is here required, the *Voluntary subjection* must needs be here meant: and to express so much, it is thus set down, *submit your selves*.

Though the same word be here used that was in the former verse, yet it is restrained to a narrower compass, namely to¹⁹⁸ *subjection of reverence*.

Here learn that to *necessary subjection*, must *voluntary subjection*¹⁹⁹ be added: that is, duty must be performed according to that order and degree wherein God hath set us. This is to make a virtue of necessity.

Under this phrase (*submit your selves*) all the duties which a wife oweth to her husband are comprised, as I shall²⁰⁰ afterwards more distinctly show.

¹⁹⁶ Subditæ sint. Hieron. Vet. Trans. Erasm.

¹⁹⁷ Subjicite vos. Beza.

¹⁹⁸ See §. 3.

¹⁹⁹ 1. *Obser.*

²⁰⁰ *Treat.* 3. §. 2.

§. 13. *Of the persons to whom wives must be subject.*

In setting down the parties to whom wives owe subjection, the Apostle noteth a particle of restraint (*own*) and that to show that a wife ought to have but one husband, which is more plainly expressed in another place by the same phrase, *let every woman have her own husband*: that²⁰¹ is, only one proper to her self: so as

It is unlawful for a wife to have more than one husband at once.

A wife must submit her self only to that one, proper²⁰² husband, and to no other man (as she is a wife and yieldeth the duty of a wife) so as the subjection of adulteresses is here excluded: and the duty required is, that

A wife must yield a chaste, faithful, matrimonial subjection²⁰³ to her husband.

Here by the way note the foolish²⁰⁴ collection of Adamites, Familists, and such like licentious libertines, who from the general words which the Apostle useth (*men and women*) infer that all women are as wives to all men, and that there needeth not any such near conjunction of one man with one woman. Which beastly opinion as it is contrary to the current of Scripture, and to the ancient law of marriage (*two shall be one flesh*) so also to this clause (*their own husbands.*) The Apostle, in using those general words, followed the Greek phrase, which putteth those two words (*men women*) for husbands and wives: so also do other tongues, yea and our English. The particular relation, which is betwixt the persons who are meant by those two words, doth plainly show how they are to be taken, and when they are to be restrained to man and wife. To take away that ambiguity, our English hath well translated them, *husband and wife*.

To direct and provoke wives unto their duty, the Apostle addeth this clause (*as unto the Lord*) which is both a *rule* and a *reason* of wives subjection. It directeth wives by noting the *restraint* of their obedience, and the manner thereof.

²⁰¹ 1 Cor. 7. 2.. See §. 82, 83.

²⁰² 2. *Obser.*

²⁰³ 3. *Obser.*

²⁰⁴ *Adamiani ex Adam dicti, cuius imitantur in paradiso nuditatem. Nuptias auersantur. Nudi itaque mares foeminaeque conueniunt, etc. August. de Haeres. distinct. 31. Promiscuè inter se viri & foeminae, Veneri operam dabant. Philast.*

The restraint in that *wives ought so to obey their husbands*²⁰⁵ *as withal they obey the Lord*; but no further: they may not be subject in any thing to their husbands, that cannot stand with their subjection to the Lord.

The *manner* in that *wives ought to yield such a kind of subjection*²⁰⁶ *to their husbands, as may be approved of the Lord*.

Thus the Apostle himself expoundeth this phrase, chap. 5. Vers. 5, 6.

It provoketh wives to submit themselves to their husbands, by noting the place of an husband, which is, to be in the Lords stead, bearing his image, and in that respect having a fellowship and partnership with the Lord, so as

Wives in subjecting themselves aright to their husbands are subject to the Lord. And on the contrary side,²⁰⁷

Wives in refusing to be subject to their husbands, refuse to be subject to the Lord.²⁰⁸

²⁰⁵ 4. *Obser.* See *Treat.* 3. §. 51.

²⁰⁶ 5. *Obser.* See *Treat.* 3. §. 54.

²⁰⁷ 6. *Obser.*

²⁰⁸ 7. *Obser.* See *Treat.* 3. §. 70.

Headship in Marriage and the Church

§. 14. *How an husband is his wives head.*

EPHES. 5. 23.

For the husband is the head of the wife, even as Christ is the head of the Church: and he is the Saviour of the body.

The place of an husband intimated in the last clause of the former verse, is more plainly expressed, and fully explained in this verse. His place is expressed under the metaphor of an *head*: and amplified by his resemblance therein unto *Christ*.

The particle of connection (FOR) sheweth that this verse is added as a reason: which may fitly be referred both to the duty it self: and to the manner of performing it.

The metaphor of an *head* enforceth the *duty*.

The amplification thereof by the resemblance that is made to Christ, enforceth the *manner* of performing the *duty*.

A wife must submit her self to an husband, because he is her *head*: and she must do it *as to the Lord*, because her husband is to her, as Christ is to the Church.

The metaphor of an head declareth two points:

1. The dignity
 2. The duty
of an husband.
1. As an head is more eminent and excellent than the body, and placed above it, so is an husband to his wife.
 2. As an head, by the understanding which is in it, governeth, protecteth, preserueth, provideth for the body, so doth the husband his wife: at least he ought so to do: for this is his office and duty: this is here noted

to show the benefit which a wife receiveth by her husband: so as two motives are included under this metaphor.

The first is taken from the husbands prerogative, whence note that

Subjection must be yielded to such as are over us. For this is a main end of the difference between party and party.²⁰⁹ To what end is the head set above the body, if the body be not subject to it?

The second is taken from the benefit which a wife reapeth by her husbands superiority: and it sheweth that

*They who will not submit themselves to their superiors are*²¹⁰ *injurious to themselves:* as the body were injurious to it self, if it would not be subject to the head.

§. 15. Of the resemblance of an husband to Christ.

The more to enforce the forenamed reason, the Apostle addeth the resemblance that is betwixt an husband and Christ, as this note of comparison (*even as*) sheweth: whence it followeth that

*It is as meet for a wife to submit her self to her husband, as*²¹¹ *for the Church to submit it self to Christ.* This amplification is especially added for Christians. Heathens may be moved to subject themselves to their governors, by the resemblance taken from a natural body. How much more ought Christians to be moved by the resemblance taken from the mystical body of Christ?

These words (*and he is the Saviour of the body*) as they do declare the office of Christ, and the benefit which the Church reapeth, so they note the end why an husband is appointed to be the head of his wife, namely that by his provident care he may be as a saviour to her. It is here noted rather to show the benefit which a wife reapeth by her husband, then the duty which he oweth: for that the Apostle declareth afterwards, vers. 25, etc. The meaning then is, That as Christ was given to be an head of the Church which is his body, that he might protect it, and provide all needful things for it, and so be a Saviour to it, even so²¹² for that very end are husbands appointed to be the head of their wives.

²⁰⁹ Obser.

²¹⁰ *Obser.* See *Treat.* 3. §. 73.

²¹¹ Obser.

²¹² How an husband is a Saviour to his wife See *Treat.* 3. §. 73.

Upon this ground the Apostle infereth the conclusion in the next verse.

§. 16. *Of the resemblance betwixt The Church to Christ. A wife to her husband.*

EPHES. 5. 24

Therefore as the Church is subject to Christ, so let wives be to their own husbands in every thing.

This conclusion setteth forth not only the duty it self, but also another *reason*, and another *rule* to provoke and direct wives to perform their duty: and that under the pattern of the Church.

The *reason* may be thus framed, *That which the Church doth to Christ, a wife must do to her husband. But the Church is subject to Christ. Therefore a wife must be subject to her husband.*

The proposition is grounded on that resemblance which is betwixt the Church in relation to Christ, and a wife in relation to her husband: for an husband is that to his wife, which Christ is to the Church; therefore a wife must be so to her husband, as the Church is to Christ.

The *rule* noteth both the *Manner* (*as*) and also the *Extent* of a wives subjection (*in every thing.*)²¹³

Quest. Is mortal and sinful man to be obeyed as the Lord Christ the eternal Son of God?

Answ. This extent is to be restrained to the generality of the things in question. As in other places, where the Apostle saith, *all things are lawful for me*, he meaneth all²¹⁴ indifferent things, for of them his speech was in that place. And where again he saith, *Whatsoever is set before you, eat,*²¹⁵ he meaneth, whatsoever good and wholesome meat: for of that he spake.

Thus much of the main drift of the Apostle in setting before wives the example of Christ, to whom husbands are like in dignity, and the example of the Church, to whom wives ought to be like in duty.

I will further consider these examples of Christ and the Church more distinctly by themselves, without any relation to man and wife: and out of them note such general instructions as concern all Christians.

²¹³ See more of the *manner* and *extent* of a wives obedience, *Treat.* 3. §. 51. & 63.

²¹⁴ 1 *Cor.* 10. 23.

²¹⁵ *Vers.* 27.

§. 17. *Of the relation betwixt Christ and the Church.*

EPHES. 5. 23, 24.

23. Christ is the head of the Church: and he is the Saviour of the body.

Behold here the mutual relation betwixt

1. Christ.
2. The Church.

Wherein note concerning Christ,

1. His preeminence over the Church, (*he is her head.*)
2. His goodness to her, (*he is her Saviour.*)

Note also concerning the Church,

1. Her prerogative, (*she is the body of Christ.*)
2. Her duty. In laying down whereof there is noted,
3. Wherein it consisteth (*The Church is subject to Christ*)
4. How far it extendeth, (*in every thing.*)

The title *Head*, is given to Christ in two respects.

1. In regard of his²¹⁶ dignity and dominion over the Church.
2. In regard of the²¹⁷ near union betwixt him and the Church.

This union is more fully expressed afterwards, vers. 30.

The dignity of Christ is here principally intended: so as *Christ is the highest in authority over the Church*: the titles²¹⁸²¹⁹ *Lord*,²²⁰ *father*, *master*, *Doctor*,²²¹ *Prophet*,²²² *First-borne*, with the like, being by a kind of excellency and propriety attributed to him, prove as much.

The causes hereof are

1. The good pleasure of God his father.
2. The dignity of his person being God-man.
3. The merit of his sacrifice whereby he hath redeemed and purchased his Church unto himself.

²¹⁶*Col.* 1. 18.

²¹⁷*Ephes.* 4. 15, 16.

²¹⁸*Doctr.*

²¹⁹*1 Cor.* 8. 6.

²²⁰*Mat.* 23. 7, 8, 9.

²²¹*Deut.* 18. 15.

²²²*Col.* 1. 18.

4. The omnipotency of his power whereby he is able to protect it.
5. The all-sufficiency of spirit, whereby he is able to give to every member all needful grace.

Till the Pope of Rome can show so good reason for this²²³ title (*Supreme head of the whole Church*) we will account him a blasphemous usurper thereof.

Object. He is not accounted an *Imperial* head as Christ is,²²⁴ but only a *Ministerial* head.

Answ.

1. This distinction is without all ground or warrant of Scripture.
2. It implieth plain contradiction. For to be a ministerial head, is to be an *head* and a *minister*, which is all one as an *head* and a *member* in relation to the same thing.
3. Though in these two words (*Imperial*, *Ministerial*) they may seem to advance Christ above the Pope, yet in their own interpretation of these words they make the Pope equal²²⁵ to Christ, if not advance him above Christ. For they say that Christ is an *imperial* head to quicken the Church inwardly: and the Pope a *ministerial* head to govern it outwardly. First let it be noted, how little congruity this exposition hath with the words expounded. Doth this word (*imperial*) intimate a quickening virtue? Doth this word (*ministerial*) imply a governing power? Nay, is there not great incongruity in this, that Christ should be the *Imperial* head, and yet the Pope an head to govern? Besides, doth not this rend asunder two of Christs offices, and leaving one to Christ, give another to the Pope, and so make him equal with Christ? If the particular branches of this government which is given by papists unto the Pope by virtue of his headship be observed, we shall find that to be verified in him, which the Apostle hath foretold concerning Antichrist, that *as God he sitteth in the temple of*²²⁶ *God, showing himself that he is God.* For they give to him the keys of heaven and hell, to shut or open the one or other as²²⁷ pleaseth him: they give him power to dispense with Gods lawes, to coin articles of faith, to make lawes to bind mens

²²³ 1 Use.

²²⁴ The distinction betwixt imperial and ministerial head discussed.

²²⁵ *Staplet. lib. 6. cap. 16. de princip. doct.*

²²⁶ 2 *Thess.* 2. 4.

²²⁷ In Decretal.

consciences directly and immediately, to give pardon for sin, to free subjects from allegiance to their Sovereignes, to canonize Saints, and what not? But to let these impious blasphemies pass, beside that this prerogative of Christ (to be *head of*²²⁸ *the Church*) is incommunicable (for thereby the Apostle proveth Christ to be advanced *far above all principality, and power, and might, and dominion, and every name, etc.*) Christ needeth not for the execution of his office therein any Vicar, or Deputy: for as head he *fillet* *all in all things*: and by his eternal spirit is he in heaven, earth, and every place where any of his members are, according to his²²⁹ promises made unto his Church.

Much comfort and great confidence must this needs minister²³⁰ to all such as have assurance that they are of this body: for having so mighty, so wise, so merciful an head, an head so sufficient every way, who can instruct, direct, guide, govern, protect, and help them in all their needs whatsoever, what need they fear? When we are assaulted by Satan, or any way set upon by any of his instruments, or are in any distress or need, let us lift up the eyes of our faith higher then we can the eyes of our body, and in heaven behold this our head, who is invisible, and we cannot but receive from thence much comfort, and encouragement.

§. 18. *Of the benefit of Christs headship.*

The *Goodness* of Christ is set down in these words (*and he is the Saviour of the body*) Every word almost hath his emphasis.

1. The copulative particle (AND) sheweth that

*The goodness which Christ doth for his Church, he doth because*²³¹ *he is the head thereof.*

O how happy a thing is it for the Church that it hath such an head! An head that doth not tyrannize over it, nor trample it under foot: an head that doth not pole, or peepe the Church: but procureth peace and safety to it. When *Naomi* sought to make a match betwixt *Boaz* and *Ruth*, that he might be her²³² head, what saith she? *Shall I not seek rest for thee that it*

²²⁸ Eph. 1. 21, 22, 23

²²⁹ Mat. 18. 20. & 28. 20.

²³⁰ Use.

²³¹ 1. *Obser.*

²³² Ruth 3. 1.

may be well with thee? It is therefore the office of an head to be a Saviour, to procure rest and prosperity to the body whose head it is.

Happy were it for Kingdoms, common-wealths, Cities, Churches, families, wives, and all that have heads, if they were such heads: that, because they are heads, they would endeavour to be Saviours.

§. 19. *Of Christ a sufficient Saviour.*

In laying forth the goodness of Christ three things are noted.

- 1. The *Kind* of goodness, which is Salvation (*the Saviour*)
 - 2. The person that performeth it (*he himself.*)
 - 3. The parties for whom he performeth it (*the body.*)
1. The Greek word translated²³³ *Saviour* is so emphaticall that other tongues can hardly find a fit word to express the emphasis thereof: it being attributed to Christ, implieth that

Christ is a most absolute and perfect Saviour, he is every way a sufficient Saviour:²³⁴ *able perfectly to save even to the very uttermost.* He saveth Soul and Body: he saveth from all manner of misery: which is intimated by that particular from²³⁵ which he saveth, namely *sin: he shall save his people from their sins.* Sin is the greatest, and most grievous evil; yea, the cause of all misery: they who are saved from it, are saved from all evil: for there is nothing hurtful to man, but that which is caused by sin, or poisoned by it.

Before sin seized on man he was most happy, free from all misery: and so shall he be after the contagion, guilt, punishment, dominion, and remainder of sin is removed. But he that remaineth in the bondage of sin is in a most woful plight. In that Christ saveth from sin, he saveth from the wrath of God, the curse of the law, the venom of all outward crosses, the tyranny of Satan, the sting of Death, the power of the grave, the torments of hell, and what not?

The purity of Christs nature, and excellency of his person²³⁶ is it that maketh him so sufficient a Saviour: which reason the Apostle himself

²³³*Sotera instrip tum vidi Syracusis. hoc quantum est? Ita magnum, vt Latino vno verbo exprimi non possit. Is est nimirum soter, qui salutem dedit. Cicer. in Ver. act 4.*

²³⁴*Heb. 7. 25.. Mat. 1. 21.*

²³⁵Doct.

²³⁶Reason.

noteth: for where he saith that *Christ is able to save to the uttermost*, he addeth, for proof thereof, that he²³⁷ is *Holy, harmless, undefiled, separate from sinners, and made higher then the heavens.*

Great matter of *rejoicing*, and of *confidence* doth this minister²³⁸ unto us. When the Angell first brought this news, *To you is borne a Saviour*, he saith, *Behold I bring you good tidings of great joy.* This made the Virgin Mary say, *My spirit hath rejoiced in God my Saviour*, and for this did Zacharias bless God that *redeemed his people, and raised up an horne of salvation.*²³⁹ When the eyes of old Simeon had seen this *Salvation*, he desired no longer to live, but said, *Lord now lettest thou thy servant*²⁴⁰ *depart in peace.*

They who believe in this *Saviour* will be of like mind: and as they rejoice in him, so they will trust unto him, and say with the Apostle, we are *more then conquerors through him*²⁴¹ *that loved us, etc.*

This being so, to what end serueth the supposed *treasure of*²⁴² *the Church*, wherein are said to be stored up *indulgences, pardons, merits, works of supererogation*, and I know not what trash, to add to the satisfaction of this Saviour? Either Christ is not a sufficient Saviour, or these are (to speak the least) vain. But vain they are: & an empty, filthy, detestable treasure that is, which God will destroy with all that trust therein.

§. 20. Of Christ the only Saviour.

This relative particle (HE) hath also his emphasis; for as it pointeth out *Christ the head of the Church*, so it restraineth this great work to him: it may thus be translated, *he himself*: that is, he in his own person, he by himself, he and none but he. So as to speak properly,

Christ is the only Saviour of men: in which respect he is²⁴³ called²⁴⁴ *the horne of salvation*, yea²⁴⁵ *Salvation* it self: which titles are given to him

²³⁷ *Heb.* 7. 25, 26.

²³⁸ *Uses.* Consolation. *Luk.* 2. 10, 11. *Luk* 1. 47.

²³⁹ *Vers.* 68, 69.

²⁴⁰ *Luk.* 2. 29, 30.

²⁴¹ *Rom.* 8. 37.

²⁴² *Refut.*

²⁴³ *Doct.*

²⁴⁴ *Luk.* 1. 69.

²⁴⁵ & 2. 30.

by an *excellency and propriety*: and in the same respect the name²⁴⁶ *Jesus* was given unto him.

Here by the way note the blasphemous arrogancy of those great sectaries among the Papists, who stile themselves *Jesuits*: assuming that name which is proper to this great office of Jesus Christ.

Object. Why is this name more blasphemous, then the title *Christians*?

Ans. One of their own religion doth thus resolve that Objection: *We are called Christians of Christ, not Jesuits of Jesus, because we partake of the thing signified by the name Christ, that is anointing: for (as the Apostle saith) we all receive of his fulness. But he hath not communicated to us the thing signified by the name Jesus; for it belongeth to him alone to save, as saith the scripture, he shall save his people: as if he should say, he alone, and no other. A Christo dicimur²⁴⁷ Christiani, non autem à Iesu Iesuani, seu Iesuitae: quia rem signatam nomine Christus, scil. vnctionem nobis communicauit. Nam, ut ait Apostolus, omnes nos de plenitudine eius accepimus: sed rem significatam nomine Jesus²⁴⁸ non communicauit: nam saluare ipsi soli conuenit: ipse enim (vt dicitur in scriptura) saluum faciet²⁴⁹ populum suum: ac si diceret, ipse solus, & non alius. Guil. Lindwood in Prouinc. siue Constitut. Angl. lib. de Consuetud.*

But to return to our matter, Saint *Peter* doth most plainly and fully prove the forenamed doctrine in these words spoken of Jesus Christ,²⁵⁰ *There is not salvation in any other: for there is none other name under heaven given among men whereby we must be saved.* None is able,²⁵¹ none is worthy to work so great²⁵² a work: he must do it, or it can not be done. But²⁵³ he is so²⁵⁴ able, and so worthy as he can do it of himself, and needeth none to assist him.

²⁴⁶ *Mat.* 1. 21.

²⁴⁷ Jesuit a blasphemous title.

²⁴⁸ Why we may be called Christians and not Jesuits.

²⁴⁹ *Christus commune dignitatis est nomen. Iesus proprium vocabulum saluatoris. Hier. in Mat.* 16.

²⁵⁰ *Act.* 4. 12.

²⁵¹ *Reu.* 5. 4, 5.

²⁵² 1. *Use.*

²⁵³ *Isa.* 63. 3.

²⁵⁴ See *The whole Armour of God*, Treat. 1. part 1 §. 5.

What a dotage is it to trust to other Saviours? Legions of²⁵⁵ Saviours have Papists to whom they fly in their need. All the Angels in heaven, and all, whom at any time their Popes have canonized for Saints (which are many millions) are made Saviours by them.²⁵⁶ *Be astonished, O ye heavens, at this: for they have committed two evils: they have forsaken Christ the fountain of living waters, and hewed them out cisterns, broken cisterns that can hold no water.*

Let us for our parts fly unto this Saviour only, and wholly²⁵⁷ rely upon him, as we desire to be saved. Thus shall we honour him by preferring him before all: yea by rejecting all but him: and thus shall we be sure to bring help, ease and comfort to our own souls.

§. 21. *Of the Church the body of Christ.*

The persons who receive any benefit by this *Saviour*, are all comprised under this metaphor *the body*: whereby the samething is meant that was meant before by the *Church*.

Church according to the notation of the Greek word signifieth²⁵⁸ an assembly called together. It is in Scripture by a propriety attributed to them who are called to God.

This calling is twofold:

1. *Outward*, which is common to all that make profession²⁵⁹ of the Gospel: in this respect it is said, *many are called and few chosen*.
2. *Inward*, which is proper to the elect, none but they, and all they in their time shall both outwardly be called by the word to a profession of Christ, and also inwardly and effectually by the spirit to believe in Christ, and obey his Gospel. This is styled²⁶⁰ *an heavenly calling*, which is²⁶¹ proper to the Saints. These make that Church, whereof Christ is properly the head: and therefore in relation to that metaphor of an head, they are called the *Body*: and that in these respects;

²⁵⁵ *Virum multi salutares dici possint non facile audendum est. Solus enim ipse saluator corporis est. Aug. in Ios. lib. 6. quaest. 23.*

²⁵⁶ *Ier. 2. 12, 13.*

²⁵⁷ *2. Use.*

²⁵⁸ *Ecclesia ex vocation appellata est. Aug. in Epist. ad Rom.*

²⁵⁹ *Mat. 20. 16.*

²⁶⁰ *Heb. 3. 1.*

²⁶¹ *1 Cor. 1. 2.*

- 1. They are under Christ, as a body under the head.
- 2. They receive spiritual life and grace from Christ, as a body natural receiveth sense, and vigour from the head.
- 3. Christ governeth them, as an head the body.
- 4. They are subject to Christ, as a body to the head.

§. 22. *Of the extent of Christs goodness to all his body.*

This metaphor, by which the persons that reap the benefit of Christs office are set forth, noteth two points.

1. *All that are once incorporated into Christ shall be saved.* The body compriseth all the parts and members under it: not only arms, shoulders, breast, back, and such like: but also hands, fingers, feet, toes, and all. Christ their head being their *Saviour*, who can doubt of their salvation?
2. *None but those that are incorporated into Christ shall be saved.* For this privilege is appropriated to the *body*.

The former point is clearly set forth by a resemblance, which the Apostle maketh betwixt *Adam* and *Christ*, thus: *As by the offence of one, judgment came on all men to condemnation,*²⁶² *even so by the righteousness of one, the free gift came on all men unto justification of life.* Here are noted two roots, one is *Adam*, the other is *Christ*: both of them have their number of branches, to all which they convey that which is in them, as the root conveyeth the sap that is in it, into all the branches that sprout from it. The first root, which is *Adam*, conveyeth sin and death to all that come from him: and the other root, which is *Christ*, conveyeth grace and life to every one that is given to him: for saith he, *All that the father*²⁶³ *giveth me, shall come to me: and him that cometh to me, I will in no wise cast out:* and a little after, he rendreth this reason, *This is the fathers will, that of all which he hath given me*²⁶⁴ *I should lose nothing, but should raise it up again at the last day.*

Object. Christ himself maketh exception of one, where he saith, *none is lost but the son of perdition.*²⁶⁵

²⁶² *Rom.* 5. 18.

²⁶³ *Ioh.* 6. 37.

²⁶⁴ *Vers.* 39.

²⁶⁵ *Ioh.* 17. 12.

Answ. That phrase *son of perdition*, sheweth that *Judas* was never of this body: for can we imagine that Christ is a Saviour of a son of perdition?

Object. Why is he then excepted?

Answ. By reason of his office and calling he seemed to be of this body, and till he was made known, none could otherwise judge of him, in which respect Saint *Peter* saith, *he was*²⁶⁶ *numbered with us*.

2. *Answ.* Christ there speaketh in particular of the twelve Apostles, and to be an Apostle of Christ was in it self but an outward calling.

This is a point of admirable comfort to such as have assurance²⁶⁷ of their incorporation into Christ, they may rest upon the benefit of this office of Christ, that he is a *Saviour*. We need not think of climbing up to heaven, and searching Gods records to see if our names be written in the book of Life. Let us only make trial whether we be of this body or no.²⁶⁸ For our help herein, know we that this metaphor of *a body* implieth two things.

- 1. A mystical union with Christ.
- 2. A spiritual communion with the Saints.
- 1. By virtue of that union they who are of Christs body,
 - 1.²⁶⁹ Receive grace, and life from him.
 - 2.²⁷⁰ Are guided and governed according to his will.
 - 3.²⁷¹ Seek to honour him in all things they do.
 - 4.²⁷² Are offended and grieved when he is dishonoured by others.
- 2. By reason of their communion with the Saints being fellow members,
 - 1.²⁷³ They love the brethren.
 - 2.²⁷⁴ They are ready to succour such as are in distress.
 - 3.²⁷⁵ They will edify one another.
 - 4.²⁷⁶ They retain a mutual sympathy: rejoicing, and mourning one with another.

²⁶⁶ *Act.* 1. 17.

²⁶⁷ *Use*.

²⁶⁸ How we may know whethe we be of Christs body or no.

²⁶⁹ *Eph.* 4. 15, 16.

²⁷⁰ *Ioh.* 17. 6.

²⁷¹ *Joh.* 17. 10

²⁷² *Gal.* 3. 1. *Psal.* 116. 136.

²⁷³ 1 *Ioh.* 4. 11.

²⁷⁴ *Mat.* 25. 40.

²⁷⁵ *Eph.* 4. 16.

²⁷⁶ 1 *Cor.* 12. 26.

§. 23. *Of the restraint of the benefit of Christs headship to them only that are of his body.*

That none but those who are of Christs body, shall partake of the benefit of his office, is clear by other like titles of restraint, as²⁷⁷ *his people*, and²⁷⁸ *his sheep*: but especially by denying to the *world* the benefit of his intercession.²⁷⁹ *I pray not for the world*, saith he. In this respect this position (*out of the Church no salvation*) is without exception true: for *the body* is the true, Catholic, invisible Church: he that is not a member of this Church, but is out of it, hath not Christ to be his head²⁸⁰ and Saviour, whence then can he have salvation?

The former point is not more comfortable to those that have assurance that they are members of this body, then this is terrible to those that give too great evidence they are no members thereof; as all they do that have not the spirit of Christ ruling in them, but rather rebel against him: and bear no love to the Saints, but rather hate them, and do them all the spight they can.

§. 24. *Of the Churches subjection to Christ.*

EPHES. 5. 24.

The Church is subject unto Christ in every thing.

The duty which the Church in way of thankfulness performeth to Christ her head for this great benefit, that *he is her Saviour*, is *subjection*: Under which word is comprised all that obedience and duty, which in any kind Christ requireth of the Church, in and by the word.

Quest. Is it possible for that part of the Church which is here on earth, to yield such obedience?

Ans. It will faithfully endeavour to do what it can: and that honest and utmost endeavour Christ graciously accepteth for a perfect performance of all.

²⁷⁷ *Mat.* 1. 21.

²⁷⁸ *Ioh.* 10. 15.

²⁷⁹ *Ioh.* 17. 9.

²⁸⁰ *Ecclesia corpus Christi est: unde manifestum est, eum qui non est in membris Christi Christianam salutem habere non posse. Aug. de Unit. Ec l. c. 2.*

In that it is here taken for grant, that *the Church is subject to Christ*; I may, as from a general to particular, infer that

*Whosoever is of the true Catholic Church is subject to Christ, and yieldeth obedience to his word. We will run after thee,*²⁸¹ saith the Church to Christ. *My sheep hear my voice and follow*²⁸² *me,* saith Christ of that flock, which is his Church.²⁸³

For Christ conveyeth his own spirit into his mystical body the Church, and into every member thereof: which spirit is²⁸⁴ much more operative, and lively then the soul of man. If therefore mans soul quickening every part of the natural body, make them subject to the head, much more will the spirit of Christ bring the members of his mystical body in subjection to himself. *If the spirit of him that raised up Jesus from the dead dwell in you, he that raised up Christ from the dead,*²⁸⁵ *shall also quicken your mortal bodies, by the spirit that dwelleth in you.*

Hereby let trial be made of particular visible Churches and of particular persons, whether they are in deed of this true Catholic²⁸⁶ Church or no. Those visible Churches which refuse to be governed by Christs word, and are wholly governed by humane traditions, which rise against Christ and play the adulteresses by committing Idolatry, are not of this Catholic Church which is *subject to Christ*. No more are Infidels that defy Christ, Heretics that deny him, ignorant persons that know not his will, profane persons that despise him, wordlings that lightly esteem him, nor any that persecute or scorn him in his members. By this we may see that many have a name that they are of the Church, who in deed are not.

Object. Many such persons may belong to Gods election, and so be of that body whereof Christ is a Saviour.

Answ. Election in deed giveth them a title to Christ, but they cannot reap any benefit by that title till they have a possession of Christ by virtue of their spiritual union with him. Neither can they have any assurance of their election, till they find by the quickening virtue of the spirit, that they are united unto Christ. Wherefore so long as men remain destitute of the

²⁸¹ Doctr.

²⁸² *Cant.* 1. 3.

²⁸³ *John* 10. 27.

²⁸⁴ Reason.

²⁸⁵ *Rom.* 8. 11.

²⁸⁶ *Use.* Trial of true Churches.

Spirit of Christ, and are possessed with a contrary spirit, they may well be judged for the present to be none of this body, nor to have any part in Christ, their future estate being referred to him who only knoweth what it shall be.

§. 25. *Of the extent of the Churches subjection.*

The extent of the Churches subjection to Christ is without any restraint at all, *in every thing*. For there is nothing which Christ requireth of her, but she may with a good conscience, and must in obedience yield unto. Just, and pure, and perfect are all his commandments, there is no error in any of them: no mischief or inconvenience can follow upon the keeping of them. This extent being here taken for grant, I may further infer that

They who are of the true Catholic Church will yield universal²⁸⁷ obedience to Christ: they will obey him in all and every of his commandments. David turned not aside from any thing that²⁸⁸ the Lord commanded him. Josiah turned to the Lord with all his²⁸⁹ heart according to all the law: and Zacharias, and Elizabeth, walked in all the commandments of God. All these were of this Church: and of their mind are all others that are of this Church.

For the spirit of Christ which is in them worketh a thorough²⁹⁰ reformation: even as the flesh leadeth a natural man on to every sin, so the spirit of Christ stireth him up to every good duty. In which respect it is said, that *whosoever is borne of God²⁹¹ doth not commit sin.*

Object. The best Saints in all ages have transgressed in many²⁹² things.

Answ. Their sins though grievous, have not wilfully in open rebellion against Christ been committed, but they have slipped from them partly through their own weakness, and partly through the violence of some temptation. So as that which the Apostle saith of himself, may be applied

²⁸⁷ Doctr.

²⁸⁸ 1 Kings 15. 5.

²⁸⁹ 2 Kings 23. 25. Luke 1. 6.

²⁹⁰ Reason.

²⁹¹ 1 John 3. 9.

²⁹² 1am. 3. 2.

to all that are of the body of Christ, *That which I do I allow not: Now then*²⁹³ *is it no more I that do it, but the sin that dwelleth in me.*

This extent is a good proof of the truth of subjection, for²⁹⁴ herein lieth a main difference betwixt the upright, and the hypocrite; yea betwixt restraining and renewing grace. That restraining grace which is in many hypocrites stireth them to do *many* things which Christ commandeth, if at least they cross not their honour, profit, ease, and the like. *Herod* that notorious hypocrite *did many things*. None that beareth the²⁹⁵ name of the Church, but will be subject in somethings. But none but the upright, who are indeed renewed by the sanctifying spirit of Christ, will in all things make Christs will their rule, and in every thing hold close to it, preferring it before their pleasure, profit, preferment, or any other outward allurements. They who so do, give good evidence that they are of the body of Christ, and may rest upon it, that Christ is their *Saviour*.

²⁹³ *Rom.* 7. 15. 17.

²⁹⁴ *Use.* Trial of integrity.

²⁹⁵ *Mark.* 6. 20.

Husbands and the Love of Christ

§. 26. *Of the sum of Husbands duties.*

EPHES. 5. 25.

25. Husbands love your wives, even as Christ also loved the Church, and gave himself for it.

From wives duties the Apostle proceedeth to press husbands duties. And as he propounded to wives for a pattern, the example of the Church, so to husbands he propoundeth the example of Christ: and²⁹⁶ addeth thereunto the pattern of a mans self, in regard of that natural affection which he beareth to his body. Thus he addeth pattern to pattern,²⁹⁷ and doth the more largely and earnestly press them, because husbands having a more honourable place, their failing in duty is the more heinous, scandalous, and dangerous.

The Apostle restraineth the duties of husbands to their *own* wives, as he did the duties of wives to their *own* husbands. For though the same word be not here used which was before, yet a word of like emphasis is used: and as good reason there is that our English translators should have put in this particle (*own*) in this verse, as in the 22. Verse, for proof whereof read 1 Cor. 7. 2. Where²⁹⁸ these two words are used, and both of them translated *own*.

This I have the rather noted, because many who hold that a wife must have but one husband, conceit that a husband may have more wives than one: which conceit this particle (*own*) wipeth away. All the duties of an

²⁹⁶ *Uers.* 28, 29.

²⁹⁷ Husbands duties most pressed.

²⁹⁸ See §. 82.

husband are comprised under this one word²⁹⁹ *love*. Wherein that an husband might be the better directed, and whereto that he might be the rather provoked, the forenamed example of Christ, and of his love to the Church, is very lively set forth: first generally in these words, *even as Christ loved the Church*: and then more particularly in the words following.

§. 27. *Of the example of Christs love.*

The note of comparison (*Even as*) requireth no *equality*, as if it were possible for an husband in that *measure* to love his wife, as Christ loved his Church; (for as Christ in excellency and greatness exceedeth man, so in love and tenderness) But it noteth an *equity*, and *like quality*.

An *equity*, because there is as great reason that husbands by virtue of their place should love their wives, as that Christ by virtue of his place should love the Church.

A *like quality*, because the love which Christ beareth to the Church is every way without exception: and a love which turneth to the good and benefit of the Church. Hence note two points.

1. *Husbands must come as near as they can to Christ in loving their wives.*

In which respect, because they can never love so much as Christ did, they must never think they have loved enough.

2. Though their love in *measure* cannot equal Christs love, yet in the *manner* thereof it must be like Christs, a *preventing, true, free, pure, exceeding, constant love*.

The measure and manner of Christs love is distinctly noted, Treat. 4. §. 61. etc. And the love which an husband oweth his wife paralleld & applied therto, which application may be also made of that Christian mutual love which we owe one to another.

The love of Christ to the Church is amplified,

- 1. By an *Effect* thereof, in these words, *He gave himself for it.*
- 2. By the *End* of that effect, largely set down, verse 26, 27.

The *effect* is noted partly as a

1. Confirmation of the truth
2. Declaration of the measure of Christs love.

²⁹⁹See the reasons hereof *Treat. 4. §. 2.*

The *Act* (*he gave*) sheweth that his love was in deed and truth: not only in show and pretence.

The *Object* (*himself*) sheweth that he loved his Church more then his own life. A greater evidence of love could not be given: for *greater love hath no man then this, that a man*³⁰⁰ *lay down his life for his friend.*

The *end* of Christs love (set forth vers. 26, 27.) is noted to show that he so loved his Church for her good and happiness, rather then for any advantage to himself.

As this example of Christs love to his Church is set before husbands: so it may and ought also to be applied to all Christians: and that in a double respect.

1. As a motive to stir them up to love both Christ himself, and also their brethren.
2. As a pattern to teach them how to love.

A motive it is to love Christ, because love deserueth love: especially such a love, of such a person as the love of Christ is. Yea, our love of Christ is an evidence that we are loved of Christ, as smoke is a sign of fire. Wherefore both in thankfulness to Christ, for his love to us, and for assurance to our own souls of Christs love to us, we ought in all things that we can to testify our love to Christ.

A motive it is also to love our brethren, because Christ being in heaven, our³⁰¹ *goodness extendeth not to him:* but our brethren on earth stand in his stead, and the love we show to them, we show to him; and he accepteth it as done to him:³⁰² *Ye fed me, ye visited me,* saith Christ to them that fed and visited his brethren. This love also, even the³⁰³ love of our brethren, is an evidence that we are loved of God. Wherefore³⁰⁴ *if Christ so loved us, we ought also to love one another.*

How the love of Christ is a pattern, I will³⁰⁵ afterwards show.

§. 28. Of Christs giving himself.

³⁰⁰ *John* 15. 13.

³⁰¹ *Psal.* 16. 2.

³⁰² *Matth.* 25. 35, 40.

³⁰³ *1 Joh.* 4. 20.

³⁰⁴ & vers. 11.

³⁰⁵ *Treat* 4 §. 61. etc.

EPHES. 5. 25.*And gave himself for it.*

This fruit and effect of Christs love extendeth it self to all³⁰⁶ the things that Christ did or suffered for our redemption: as, that he descended from heaven, took upon him our nature, and became a man; that he subjected himself to the law, and perfectly fulfilled it; that he made himself subject to many temptations of the devil and his instruments; that he took upon him our infirmities; that he became a King to govern us, a Prophet to instruct us, a Priest to make an attonement for us: that he subjected himself to death, the cursed death of the cross, and so made himself an oblation & sacrifice for our sins; that he was buried; that he rose again; that he ascended into heaven, and there sitteth at Gods right hand to make intercession for us. For after that Christ had taken upon him to be our *head* and *Saviour*, he wholly set himself apart for our use, and our benefit: so as his person, his offices, his actions, his sufferings, his humiliation, his exaltation, the dignity, the purity, the efficacy of all is the Churches, and to her good do they all tend. This in general is the extent of this fruit of Christs love, *he gave himself for it.*

More particularly, we may note these three points:

- 1. The *action*, what he did, (*he gave.*)
- 2. The *object*, what he gave, (*himself.*)
- 3. The *end*, why he gave himself, (*for it*) for the Churches good.

The *action* having relation to the *object*, most especially pointeth at the death of Christ. The Greek word is a compound word, and signifieth to *give up*. It implieth two things,

1. *That Christ willingly died*: the simple word (*gave*) intimateth so much.
2. *That his death was an oblation*: that is, a price of redemption, or a satisfaction: the compound word (*gave up*) intimateth so much.

§. 29. Of the willingness of Christ to die.

That Christ willingly died is evident by the circumstances noted about his death: when *Peter* counselled him to spare himself, and not to go to Jerusalem (where he was to be put to death)³⁰⁷ he called him Satan, and

³⁰⁶ Christ himself, and all that he did and suffered, are ours.

³⁰⁷ *Mat.* 16. 32, 23

said, *he was an offence to him*: when *Judas* went out to betray him,³⁰⁸ he said unto him, *That thou doest, do quickly*:³⁰⁹ When *Judas* was gone out to get company to apprehend him, he went to the place where he was wont, so as *Judas* might readily find him; yea, he met them in the mid-way that came to take him; and he asked them whom they sought, though he knew whom they sought: and when they said, *Jesus of Nazaret*, he answered, *I am he*: When they came to him, he drove them all backward with a word of his mouth, and yet would not escape from them:³¹⁰ He could have prayed to the father to have had more then twelve legions of Angels for his safeguard against those that apprehended him, but would not:³¹¹ when by his adversaries he was provoked to have come down from the Cross, and could have done so, he would not.³¹² At the instant of giving up the ghost, he cried with a loud voice: which sheweth that his life was not then spent, he might have retained it longer if he would: and thereupon the Centurion gathered that he was the son of God.³¹³ When he was actually dead, and laid in a grave, he rose again. These & other like circumstances verify that which Christ said of himself,³¹⁴ *No man taketh my life from me, but I lay it down of my self*. It was therefore no necessity that compelled him to die, but his voluntary obedience.

Christ is³¹⁵ *the Lord, Prince and Author of life*, and hath an absolute power as over the life of others, so over his own life.

Thus then we see that his sacrifice was a voluntary and free gift: the cause thereof was his own will and good pleasure.

Exceedingly doth this commend the love of Christ: and assureth us that it is the more acceptable to God, who *loveth a cheerful giver*.³¹⁶

³⁰⁸ *John* 13. 27.

³⁰⁹ & 18. 2. etc. *Audiui, Domine, auditum tuum et expani, dum quaeris à quaerentibus quid quaerant, cum noueris quod te quaerant: & dixisti te esse lesu Nazarenu. Cypr. de Pass. Christi.*

³¹⁰ *Matth.* 26. 53.

³¹¹ & 27. 42.

³¹² *Mark.* 15. 39.

³¹³ *John* 2. 19. *Matth.* 28. 6.

³¹⁴ *John* 10. 18. *Indicia dedit nullase necessita e, sed obedientia vrgeri ad mortem. Cypr. de coen. Dom. Reason.*

³¹⁵ *Acts* 3. 15..

³¹⁶ 1. *Use.*

Let us in imitation of our head, do the things whereunto³¹⁷ we are called willingly and cheerfully, though they seem never³¹⁸ so disgraceful to the world, or grievous to our weak flesh.

§. 30. *Of the kind of Christs death, an oblation.*

That *Christs death was an oblation*, and a price of redemption, is evident by the death of those beasts which were offered up for a sacrifice, and therein were a type of Christs death. But expressly is this noted by this Apostle, where he saith,³¹⁹ *Christ hath given himself for us, an offering and sacrifice to God for a sweet smelling savour:* and again,³²⁰ *Christ gave himself a ransom.* The phrases of³²¹ *redeeming*,³²² *purchaesing*,³²³ *buying*, with the like, attributed to Christ and his blood, do further confirm the same.

Learn hereby to consider Christs death, not as the death of³²⁴ a private man, but of a public person, of a suerty, of a pledge, that in our room and stead³²⁵ *was made sin*, and³²⁶ *was made a curse* to redeem us from our sins, and from the curse which by sin was fallen upon us. The comfort and benefit of Christs death is lost, if this be not known and believed. In this consisteth a main difference betwixt the death of Christ, and all other men, not the most righteous Martyrs excepted. Their death was but a duty, and debt: no satisfactory oblation, no price, no ransom, as Christs was.

§. 31. *Of the infinite value of the prince of our redemption.*

³¹⁷ 2 Cor. 9. 7.

³¹⁸ 2. Use.

³¹⁹ Ephes. 5. 2.

³²⁰ 1 Tim. 2. 6.

³²¹ 1 Pet. 1. 18, 19

³²² Acts 20. 28.

³²³ 2 Pet. 2. 1.

³²⁴ Use.

³²⁵ 2 Cor. 5. 21.

³²⁶ Gal. 3. 13.

The Object, or thing which Christ gave for a ransom was *himself*, not his body alone, nor his body and soul only, but his person consisting of his two natures, humane, and divine.

Quest. How could his divine nature be given up? could it³²⁷ suffer? could it die?

Answ. 1. The Deity simply considered in and by it self, could not die: but that person which was God, both could and did die. For the son of God assuming an humane nature into the unity of his divine nature, and uniting them together³²⁸ *without confusion, alteration, distraction, separation*, in one person, that which is done by one nature is done by the person, and in that respect the Scripture oft attributeth it to the other nature: as where it is said,³²⁹ *They crucified the Lord of glory:* and³³⁰ *God purchased the Church with his own blood.*

2. Though the divine nature of Christ suffered not, yet did it support the humane nature, and add dignity, worth and efficacy to the sufferings of that nature.
3. Christs divine nature had proper and peculiar works in the work of redemption, as to sanctify his humane nature, to take away our sins, to reconcile us to God, and the like.

Thus then in three respects the whole person of Christ was given unto us.

1. In regard of the inseparable union of both natures.
2. In regard of the assistance of the Deity in those things which the humane nature of Christ did.
3. In regard of some proper actions appertaining to the Deity.³³¹

In that the person of Christ God-man was given up, I gather that³³²

The price of our Redemption is of infinite value. Nor Christ,³³³ nor God himself could give a greater. Heaven and earth and all things in them are not of like worth. Well therefore might Saint *Peter* call it *precious blood*: and prefer it before silver, gold, and all other things of price.

³²⁷ How the person of Christ being Godman, was given for us.

³²⁸ *Symbol. Calced.*

³²⁹ 1 Cor. 2. 8.

³³⁰ Act. 20. 28.

³³¹ Doctr.

³³² 1 Pet. 1. 19. *Uses.*

³³³ *Quanta se fiducia spes credentium consolatur considerans quantus quanta pro nondum credentibus passus sit? Aug. de Doctr. Chr. l. 1. c. 15.*

1. What place can be left for despair in those that know and believe the worth of this ransom?
2. What can be held too dear for him, that notwithstanding the infinite excellency of his person gave himself for us? Can goods, can friends, can children, can liberty, can life, can any thing else?
3. What just cause have we to *give up our selves a living sacrifice*,³³⁴ *holy and acceptable* to him that gave himself for us?
4. How ungrateful, how unworthy of Christ are they, that for his sake will not forsake their unstable honours, fading wealth, vain pleasures, garish attire, and such like trash?

§. 32. *Of Christs seeking the good of the Church.*

The *End* why Christ gave himself was, *for the Church*: so³³⁵ *as Christ in his death aimed at our good.*³³⁶ He was made sin *for us, that we might be made the righteousness of God in him:*³³⁷ he was made a curse *for us, and hath redeemed us from the curse of the Law:*³³⁸ he gave himself *for our sins, that he might deliver us:*³³⁹ he laid down his life *for the sheep.*

This proves Christs giving of himself to be a fruit of his love: for³⁴⁰ *love seeketh not her own.*

Learn we hereby to apply all that Christ did to our selves. If *for us* he gave himself, he, and³⁴¹ all appertaining to him is ours.

Learn we also hereby how to manifest love: namely by seeking, and procuring the good of others. *Let no man seek his*³⁴² *own, but every man anothers wealth.* If this were practised, would there be such oppressing, such undermining, such deceiving, such wronging of one another as there is? Too truly is the Apostles complaint verified in our days, *All seek*

³³⁴ *Rom.* 12. 1.

³³⁵ *Doctr.*

³³⁶ *2 Cor.* 5. 21.

³³⁷ *Gal.* 3. 13.

³³⁸ *Gal.* 1. 4.

³³⁹ *Ioh.* 10. 15.

³⁴⁰ *1. Cor.* 13. 5. 1. *Use.*

³⁴¹ See §. 28. 2. *Use.*

³⁴² *1 Cor.* 10. 24.

³⁴³ *Phil.* 2. 21.

*their*³⁴³ own. But let that mind be in us which was in Christ Jesus, and thus manifest our love, as we desire to partake of this fruit of Christs love.

From hence by just consequence it followeth that *Christ merited*³⁴⁴ *not for himself*. Was there any need that Christ should come down from heaven on earth, to purchase any thing for himself? When he was going out of the world, thus he prayed, *Now, O father, glorify thou me with the glory which I had*³⁴⁵ *with thee before the world was*. Did Christ by any thing which he did on earth merit that glory which he had before the world was? All the exaltation whereunto he was advanced even in his human nature, was due to the dignity of his person.

1. Object. He endured the cross, for the joy which was set³⁴⁶ **before him.**

Answ. He used that joy which of right was due to him as an help to support him in the weakness of his humane nature, not as a recompense which he should deserve.

2. Object. He became obedient to the death of the Cross,³⁴⁷ **WHEREFORE God also hath highly exalted him.**

Answ. That particle (*wherefore*) doth not declare the cause, but the order of his exaltation: nothing a consequence that followed after his death. After he had humbled himself so low, he was most highly advanced.

3. Object. Christ being man was bound to the Law: and therefore for himself he ought to fulfill it.

Answ. If he had been mere man, that were true. But he uniting his humane nature unto his divine, and making of both one person, which person was God as well as man, he was bound to nothing further then it pleased him voluntarily to subject himself unto for our sakes.

2. If Christ were bound to the Law, of duty he must have fulfilled it: and if of duty he was to fulfill it, how could he thereby merit so high a degree of honour as he is advanced unto?

This conceit of Christs meriting for himself, doth much extenuate the glory of Christs grace and goodness in giving himself.

³⁴⁴ Christ merited not for himself.

³⁴⁵ *Ioh.* 17. 5.

³⁴⁶ *Heb.* 12. 2.

³⁴⁷ *Phil.* 2. 9..

§. 33. *Of the particular ends, why Christ gave himself, and of the condition of the Church before Christ took her.*

EPHES. 5. 26.

That he might sanctify it, and cleanse it with the washing of water by the word.

The general *End* of Christs giving himself being before intimated in this phrase (*for us*) is in this and the next verse particularly exemplified: and that in two branches.

One respecteth the estate of the Church in this world, v. 26.

The other respecteth her estate in the world to come, v. 27.

The latter of these two is the most principal.

The former is subordinate to the latter, an end for the accomplishing of the other end, for the Church is here made pure, that hereafter it may be made glorious.

In laying down the former he noteth

- 1. The *end* whereat Christ aimed.
- 2. The *means*, whereby he effected that which he aimed at.

That *end* is set forth in these words, *that he might sanctify it*,³⁴⁸ *having cleansed it* (thus may they word for word be translated) so as that which for order of words is in the latter place, for order of matter is in the first place.

The word (*cleansing*) pointeth out our *instification*.

The word (*sanctifying*) expresseth our *sanctification*.

The means of effecting these, are two.

- 1. *Baptism* comprised under this phrase, *washing of water*.
- 2. The *word*.

The two branches of the former *end*, namely *Cleansing* and *Sanctifying* do in general imply two things.

- 1. The *Condition* of the Church in it self.
- 2. The *Alteration* thereof by Christ.

The *condition* is presupposed, which is, that she was impure, polluted, in the common estate of corrupt man. Things in themselves pure, are not cleansed, but things foul and impure: persons of themselves freed, and exempted from a common misery, need not anothers help to free and

³⁴⁸See §. 39.

exempt them. Seeing then that the Church stood in need to be cleansed, and sanctified, surely

The Church in herself was, as the world, polluted. Very lively is³⁴⁹ this set forth by the Prophet *Ezekiel* under the similitude of a³⁵⁰ *wretched infant borne of a cursed parentage, whose navel was not cut, who was not washed, salted, nor swaddled, but cast out in the open field, polluted with blood.* Oft doth the Apostle, setting forth³⁵¹ the wretched estate of the world, note of the true members³⁵² of the Church, that³⁵³ *we our selves also were such.*³⁵⁴

The Church consisteth of none other then of such as came out of *Adam's* loins. Now as all the brood which cometh from vipers, adders, toads, spiders, and other like venomous dams, are infected with poison, so all the sons of *Adam* are polluted with sin. *That which is borne of the flesh* (as is every mothers child, not the members of the Church excepted: for they have fathers and mothers of their flesh) *is flesh*; that is, polluted and corrupt. Therefore when we are taken into the Church, we are *borne again.*³⁵⁵

This our former estate by nature is oft and seriously³⁵⁶ to be thought of, and that in respect of

1. Christ.
 2. Our selves.
 3. Others.
1. In regard of Christ, the more to magnify his love. Our former estate, before he cast the wings of his mercy upon us, sheweth our unworthiness, our vileness, and wretchedness, and in that respect it openeth our heart and mouth to think and say,³⁵⁷ *O Lord our Lord, what is man that thou art mindful of him, and the son of man that thou visitest him!*
³⁵⁸ *Lord, how is it that thou wilt manifest thy self unto us, and not*

³⁴⁹ Doctr.

³⁵⁰ The Church in her self polluted.

³⁵¹ *Ezek.* 16. 3. etc.

³⁵² *Eph.* 2. 3.

³⁵³ *Tit.* 3. 3.

³⁵⁴ *1 Cor.* 6. 11.

³⁵⁵ *Ioh.* 3. 3, 5.

³⁵⁶ Our natural condition oft to be thought of.

³⁵⁷ *Psal.* 8. 1, 4.

³⁵⁸ *Ioh.* 14. 22.

unto the world! The right knowledge of our former estate, and a due consideration thereof, maketh us ascribe all the glory of our present dignity, and happiness, to Christ that altered our estate, as Saint *Paul*,³⁵⁹ *I thank Christ Jesus our Lord who hath enabled me, who was before a blasphemers, etc.* yea it maketh us the more to prize and esteem the present estate, as³⁶⁰ *David*.

2. In regard of our selves this is to be thought of, to humble us, and to keep us from insolent boasting in those privileges whereof through Christ we are made partakers. To this purpose doth the Apostle thus press this point, *Who maketh*³⁶¹ *thee to differ from another? And what hast thou that thou diddest not receive? Now if thou diddest receive it, why dost thou glory as if thou hadst not received it?* When a man is exalted from a mean, to a great place, and thereupon waxeth proud and insolent, we say, *he hath forgotten from whence he came*. So as remembrance of our former condition is a means to preserve humility, and to suppress insolency.
3. In regard of others it is to be thought of, to move us the more to commiserate their woful estate, who yet remain as we once were; to conceive hope that their estate may be altered as well as ours was; to pray and use what means we can that it may be altered. To provoke Christians to show all meekness to them which were without, the Apostle renders this reason, *for we our selves also in times past were foolish*,³⁶² *etc.*.. read how forcibly this is urged, *Rom. 11. 18, 19, etc.*

³⁵⁹ 1 *Tim.* 1. 12. *etc.*

³⁶⁰ 2 *Sam.* 7. 18, *etc.*

³⁶¹ 1 *Cor.* 4. 7.

³⁶² *Tit.* 3 3, *etc.*

Love That Purifies the Unclean

§. 34. *Of Christs preventing Grace.*

In setting down the alteration of the forenamed condition note

- 1. The *manner* of laying it forth.
- 2. The *matter* or substance thereof.

The *manner* is implied in this conjunction THAT (*That he might sanctify it*) Christ loved the Church, and gave himself for it, not because it was sanctified, but *that he might sanctify it*: so as

*The Grace which Christ showeth to the Church, is a preventing*³⁶³ *Grace*. Sanctification is no cause, but an effect of Christs³⁶⁴ love: and followeth in order after his love. His love arose only and wholly from himself: in the parties loved, there was nothing but matter of hatred before they were loved. *Moses* thus saith of the love of God to Israel, *The Lord did not set his love upon you because ye were more in number, but because the Lord loved you*. This at first sight may seem to be (as³⁶⁵ we say)³⁶⁶ *a womans reason*, that the Lord should set his love on them because he loved them, but it being duly observed, we shall find excellently set forth the ground of Gods love to rest altogether in himself, and in his own good pleasure.³⁶⁷ Yea this being noted as the *end* of Christs love, *that he might sanctify it*, it further showeth that it was not any *foresight* of holiness in the Church that moved him to love it: first he loved it, and then sought how to make it amiable, and worthy to be loved.

Herein differeth Christs love from the love of all men towards³⁶⁸ their spouses: for they must see something in them, to move them to love.

³⁶³ Doct.

³⁶⁴ *Ipse nos gratis saluos fecit, ipse nos non eum quaerentes quaesiuit, inuenit, etc. Aug. in Psal. 78.*

³⁶⁵ *Non est inuenire Domino sed praeuenire. Bern. serm. 78. in Cant.*

³⁶⁶ Idem per idem.

³⁶⁷ *Deut. 7. 7, 8.*

³⁶⁸ Difference betwixt Christs love and Mans. *Est. 2 12, etc.*

When *Ahash-verosh* was to choose a wife, the maidens out of whom he was to take one, were first purified, and then he took her in whom he most delighted: But Christ first loveth his spouse, and then sanctifieth it. Before he loved it, he saw nothing in it why he should prefer it before the world.

Seeing of him, and through him, and to him is all the beauty³⁶⁹ and dignity of the Church, *the glory be to him for ever*,³⁷⁰ Amen.

§. 35. Of Christs seeking to make his Church pure.

The *Matter* or substance of that subordinate *end* which Christ aimed at in giving himself for the Church, is in these words (*that he might sanctify it having cleansed it*) which in general show that

Christ seeketh the purity of his Church. For this end hath he³⁷¹ shed his own most pure and precious blood (*for*³⁷² *his blood cleanseth us from all sin*) and conveyed his holy Spirit into his body the Church, which is called the³⁷³ *Spirit of Sanctification*, because it reneweth and sanctifieth those in whom it is.

This Christ aimeth at, that he might make his spouse like to³⁷⁴ himself, pure, as he is pure.

That end which Christ aimed at, we that profess our selves³⁷⁵ to be of this Church, must endeavour after: for *every man that hath this hope in him purgeth himself as he is pure*. Let us therefore use all good means to cleanse our selves from all filthiness of flesh, and spirit.

This being the end which Christ aimeth at for the good³⁷⁶ of his Church to *cleanse it*, they who find themselves cleansed have a good evidence that they are of this Church: they who are not cleansed can have no assurance thereof.

How unworthy are they of this benefit, that live as the³⁷⁷ world, and like swine upon every occasion wallow in the mire, being drawn by every

³⁶⁹ Use.

³⁷⁰ *Rom.* 11. 36.

³⁷¹ Doctr.

³⁷² 1 *Ioh.* 1. 7.

³⁷³ *Rom.* 1. 4.

³⁷⁴ Reason.

³⁷⁵ 1 Use. Exhortation. 1 *Ioh.* 3. 3.

³⁷⁶ 2 Use. Trial.

³⁷⁷ 3 Use. Reproof.

temptation into sin? Do they not, as much as in them lieth, make the death of Christ to be in vain, and pervert that main end, which Christ aimed at in giving himself?

But what may be thought of such as *Ismael*-like mock and scoff at those that labour to be cleansed?

§. 36. *Of the Churches Justification.*

The two particular parts of the forenamed end, which are *Cleansing*, and *sanctifying*, do more distinctly set forth the purity of the Church even in this world. *Cleansing* hath relation to the blood of Christ, and so pointeth out our *Justification*.

Sanctifying hath relation to the Spirit of Christ, which worketh our Sanctification.

From this cleansing of the Church here meant, I gather, that *No sin lieth upon the Church: for the blood of Christ purgeth³⁷⁸ from all sin*. This is to be taken of the guilt of sin, which³⁷⁹ by Christs death is clean taken away: so as that sin which is in us, is as not in us, because it is not imputed unto us.

Behold here the blessed estate of the Church, for, *Blessed is³⁸⁰ he whose transgression is forgiven, whose sin is covered. Blessed³⁸¹ is the man unto whom the Lord imputeth not sin*.

§. 37. *Of the Churches Sanctification.*

From the sanctifying of the Church here mentioned, I further gather, that

The Church is made holy and righteous: This is here meant of³⁸² that inherent righteousness which the Spirit of Christ worketh in all the members of his body. In which respect they are called *Saints*: so as not only the guilt of sin is taken away,³⁸³ but also the very *body of sin* is so

³⁷⁸Doctr.

³⁷⁹1 *Ioh.* 1. 7.

³⁸⁰Use.

³⁸¹*Psal.* 32. 1, 2.

³⁸²Doctr.

³⁸³1 *Cor.* 1. 2.

destroyed in them, as it can³⁸⁴ no more reign in them, nor they obey it in the lusts thereof: but in stead of the dominion of sin the spirit of Christ raigneth in them, and leadeth them unto all righteousness.

Behold here the free estate of the Church: whereas the³⁸⁵ world lieth under the slavery of sin, and tyranny of Satan, the Church is *made free from sin, and a servant of righteousness*:³⁸⁶ *dead to sin, and alive to God in Jesus Christ.*

§. 38. Of the Churches purity before God and Man.

From the Connection of these two benefits of Christs death, Justification and Sanctification together, we see that *The Church is both spotless before God and blameless before men.* The blood of Christ so cleanfeth her as in Gods sight she hath no spot of sin: and the spirit of Christ so sanctifieth her, as her righteousness shineth before men: for *the Grace of God*³⁸⁷ *teacheth her to deny ungodliness, and worldly lusts, and to live soberly, righteously, and godly in this present world.* In this respect the Church is said to be *all glorious within*, and her³⁸⁸ *clothing* also to be of *wrought gold.* And *Zacharias and Elizabet*,³⁸⁹ members of this Church, are said to be *righteous before God*, and *blameless*, namely before men. There is no such purity in any, as in the Church. For true and perfect beauty³⁹⁰ is only in the body of Christ, which is the Church, whereof it is said, *Thou art all fair, and there is no spot in thee, Cant. 4. 7.*

1. *Quest.* Is it possible that neither God nor man should espy any fault in those that are of the true Church, while here they live in this world?

Answ. Seeing the flesh remaineth in the best while they remain³⁹¹ in the world, it is not possible but that both God and man must needs espy many blemishes in the best. *All things are*³⁹² *naked and opened to the eyes of*

³⁸⁴ *Rom. 6. 6.*

³⁸⁵ *Use.*

³⁸⁶ *Rom. 6. 18, 11.*

³⁸⁷ *Tit. 2. 11, 12.*

³⁸⁸ *Psal. 45. 13.*

³⁸⁹ *Luk. 1. 6.*

³⁹⁰ *Vera & perfecta pulchritudo in nullo hominum est nisi in corpore Christi quod interpretatur Ecclesia. Hier. in Ezech. 27.*

³⁹¹ *Sin is in the best.*

³⁹² *Heb. 4. 13.*

God: if therefore any remnant of sin be in the Saints (as there are exceeding many in every one; so as *if we say that we have no sin we deceive our selves*,³⁹³ *and the truth is not in us*) it is without question *manifest in his sight*. Yea such is the imperfection and weakness of the best Saints, as the flesh continually lusting in them against the Spirit, oft times prevaieth, and so sheweth it self in some evil fruit or other, as the eye of man espieth it: instance the examples of the best that ever lived in any age.

2. *Quest.* How then are they spotless before God, and³⁹⁴ blameless before men?

Answ. 1. God so fully dischargeth and acquiteth the Church of all her sins, as she is in his account as if she had no speck of sin at all. *David* in this respect useth the metaphor of *covering sin*, and explaineth his meaning by these two³⁹⁵ phrases, *forgiving, not imputing sin*.

2. The course of a mans life, not this or that particular³⁹⁶ action, is it which maketh a man blame-worthy, or blameless: as the flock of swallows, and not one here, or another there, is it which sheweth the Spring. Now because the constant carriage of those who are of the Church is before men blameless, they may justly be so accounted, notwithstanding some particular things blame-worthy do sometimes pass from them. Behold here how the true Saints may boldly lift up their faces before God and man. The soundness of their faith causeth confidence before God. The testimony of their conscience causeth courage before men. Let all that desire this boldness, join a sound faith and a good conscience together, and labour for assurance both of their cleansing by the blood of Christ, and sanctifying by the Spirit of Christ.

§. 39. *Of the order and dependance of justification and sanctification one upon another.*

The order and manner of knitting these two benefits together is worthy to be noted.

³⁹³ 1 *Job.* 1. 8.

³⁹⁴ How the Saints are spotless before God.

³⁹⁵ *Psal* 32. 1, 2.

³⁹⁶ How the Saints are blameless before men. *Vna hirundo non facit ver.*

The letter setteth sanctification in the first place: but the sense presupposeth justification: for thus he saith, *that he might sanctify it, having cleansed it*. Because the *cleansing* here spoken of is an inward invisible work, and the evidence thereof is sanctification, which is an outward and sensible work, therefore *this* is first expressed, and then *that* inferred, as a matter necessarily to be presupposed.

Hence arise these Doctrines. Our English with this participle (*having*) doth fitly and properly expound the Greek active participles of the Praeter-perfect or finite tenses, which because the Latins want, they are fain to use the passive, or a Periphrasis: as, *vt illam sanctificaret mundatam, Erasm. Postquam eam purgasset, Beza.*

1. *Justification in order goeth before*³⁹⁷ *sanctification*: I say in order, because at that very moment that Christ by his blood cleanseth his Church, he beginneth to sanctify her: but when he beginneth to sanctify her, he hath cleansed her, she is justified.

The grace then of justification is a most free grace: it is not wrought upon any righteousness of ours: for it is before it.

2. *Christ sanctifieth those whom he hath cleansed*. This the³⁹⁸ Apostle copiously proveth in the sixth chapter to the Romans. Let none therefore boast of their cleansing by Christs blood, till they find themselves renewed and sanctified by the Spirit of Christ. For note the Apostles description of those who are justified by Christ, which for more perspicuity may thus be set down by question and answer. To whom is there no condemnation?³⁹⁹ To them that are in Christ Jesus. Who are they? They *who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit*.

3. *Sanctification presupposeth justification*: they who are sanctified⁴⁰⁰ may rest upon it, that they are cleansed and justified.

For sanctification is a fruit of justification, in which respect S. James saith, that *we are justified by works*, that is, declared so⁴⁰¹ to be.

³⁹⁷ 1. *Doct. Iustificatio non accedit factoribus sed factores legis praecedat. Aug. de Spir. & lit. cap. 26.*

³⁹⁸ 2. *Doct.*

³⁹⁹ *Rom. 8. 1.*

⁴⁰⁰ 3. *Doct.*

⁴⁰¹ *Iam. 2. 24.*

⁴⁰² *Use.*

Admirable is the comfort which the Saints in this world⁴⁰² reap hereby. For their sanctification being imperfect, and the flesh abiding in them, and lusting against the Spirit: yea sin being present with them when they would do good, they are oft forced to complain and cry, *O wretched men that we are.*⁴⁰³ *who shall deliver us from this body of death!* If they had no other ground to fasten the anchor of their hope upon but their sanctification, it could not hold them fast enough against the tempests of Satans temptations. But in that their sanctification is a fruit and evidence of their justification, they take heart to themselves, and *thank God that with the mind they themselves serve the Law of God, though with the flesh the law of sin.* And thus upheld and comforted, they continue to strive against sin, till it be clean rooted out of them, as well as remitted.

§. 40. Of Sacramental washing of water.

One of the means which Christ useth for the cleansing and sanctifying of his Church, is expressed under this phrase, *with the washing of water.* Water is the outward element used in Baptism: *Washing* is the principal Sacramental rite therein. *Water* setteth forth Christs blood: *Washing* noteth out the application and efficacy thereof, which is the purging and cleansing of our souls. As water without washing maketh nothing clean: so the blood of Christ, without a right application thereof, cleanseth no mans soul.

This *washing of water* here mentioned, being applied to an inward spiritual cleansing, what can it else set forth but the Sacrament of Baptism, wherein both *water* and *washing* is used?

Object.

There is but little washing used in the Sacrament of Baptism, nothing but sprinkling a little water on the face of the party that is baptized.

Answ. That sprinkling is sufficient to show the use of water.⁴⁰⁴ The party to be baptized is not brought to the Font to have his face, or any other part of his body made clean, but to have assurance of the inward cleansing of his soul. Now that our minds may not too much dote on the outward thing done, but be wholly raised up to the mystery, the outward element

⁴⁰³ *Rom.* 7. 24.

⁴⁰⁴ Why water in baptism is but sprinkled.

is no further used, then may serve to put us in mind of the inward thing signified thereby: answerably in the Lords Supper there is not so much bread and wine given and received, as would satisfy ones appetite, or slake his hunger and quench his thirst, but only a little bit of bread, and taste of wine, to declare the use of bread and wine, and so to draw the minds of the Communicants to a consideration of their spiritual nourishment by the body and blood of Jesus Christ.

§. 41. *How Baptism is a means of cleansing and sanctifying.*

The manner of inferring this Sacramental washing upon the sanctifying and cleansing of the Church thus, *with the washing of water*, sheweth, that

Baptism is a means of sanctifying and cleansing the Church. All⁴⁰⁵ those places of Scripture that attribute⁴⁰⁶ *Regeneration*,⁴⁰⁷ *Justification*,⁴⁰⁸ *Sanctification*, or⁴⁰⁹ *Salvation* thereunto, prove as much. But that the truth thereof may more fully and distinctly be conceived, I will briefly show,

- 1. In what respect Baptism is a means of our sanctifying and cleansing.
- 2. What kind of means it is.
- 3. How necessary it is.

In four especial respects it may be said to be a means as aforesaid.

1. In that it doth most lively represent and set forth even to the outward senses the inward cleansing of our souls by the blood of Christ, and sanctifying of us by the Spirit of Christ. Apply the use of water (by the washing whereof foul things are made very clean) to the virtue of Christs blood and efficacy of his Spirit, and the truth hereof will evidently appear. For the better help in this application, read Rom. 6. 4. etc.
2. In that it doth truly propound and make tender, or offer of the grace of justification and sanctification to the party baptized. In this respect it is thus described, *Baptism of repentance*⁴¹⁰ *for remission of sins*: and

⁴⁰⁵ Doctr.

⁴⁰⁶ *Ioh. 3. 5. Tit. 3. 5.*

⁴⁰⁷ *Gal. 3. 27.*

⁴⁰⁸ *Rom. 6. 3.*

⁴⁰⁹ *1 Pet. 3. 21.*

⁴¹⁰ *Luke 3. 3.*

S. Peter to like purpose saith,⁴¹¹ Repent, and be baptized every one of you for the remission of sins.

3. In that it doth really exhibit and seal up to the conscience of him that is baptized the forenamed graces, whereby he is assured that he is made partaker thereof. Thus *Abraham received the sign of circumcision as a seal of the righteousness of⁴¹² faith.* Hence is it that the Eunuch and others when they were⁴¹³ *baptized, went away rejoicing.*
4. In that it is a particular and peculiar pledge to the party baptized, that even he himself is made partaker of the said graces: therefore every one in particular is baptized for himself: yea, though many be at once brought to the Font, yet every one by name is baptized. To this purpose faith the Apostle, *Whosoever are baptized into Christ, have put on Christ;⁴¹⁴ whosoever,* whether *Peter, John, Thomas,* or any other particular person. *Ananias said to Paul in the singular number, Be⁴¹⁵ thou baptized, and wash away thy sins.*

§. 42. Objections against the efficacy of baptism answered.

1. *Object.* Many that are baptized receive no such grace at all, they are neither cleansed nor sanctified.

Answ. They are only outwardly washed with water, they are not baptized with the Holy Ghost. The fault is not in that no grace accompanieth that Sacrament, but in that they receive not, but reject the grace which appertaineth thereto: *what if some believe not? Shall their unbeleefe make the faith of⁴¹⁶ God without effect? God forbid.*

2. *Object.* Many receive the forenamed graces before they are baptized, as *Abraham* before he was circumcized, and such⁴¹⁷ as were baptized after they believed. How then is baptism a means thereof?

⁴¹¹Acts 2. 38.

⁴¹²Rom 4. 11.

⁴¹³Acts 8. 39. & 16. 34.

⁴¹⁴Gal. 3. 27.

⁴¹⁵Acts 22. 16.

⁴¹⁶Rom. 3. 3.

⁴¹⁷Rom. 411.

Answ. Their spiritual cleansing is more lively and fully manifested thereby, and they the more assured thereof.

3. *Object.* Many who long after their baptism, have lived like swine in sin, and so have not been cleansed or sanctified, yet divers years after have been effectually called: what means hath baptism been hereof?

Answ. The use and efficacy of baptism is not as the act thereof, transient, but permanent and perpetual so long as the party baptized liveth. Whensoever a sinner unfainedly repenteth, and faithfully laith hold on the promises of God, baptism, which is the seal thereof is as powerful and effectual as it could have been when it was first administered. For the efficacy of baptism consisteth in the free offer of grace. So long therefore as God continueth to offer grace, so long may a mans baptism be effectual. On this ground we are but once for all baptized: and as the⁴¹⁸ Prophets put the people in mind of their circumcision, so the Apostles of their baptism long after it was administered. Yea, they speak of it (though the act were long before past) as if it were in doing, in the time present, *Baptism saveth*.⁴¹⁹

§. 43. *What kind of means of grace Baptism is.*

II. Baptism is no physical or natural means of working⁴²⁰ grace, as if the grace which is sealed up thereby were inherent in the water, or in the Ministers act of sprinkling it (as in medicines, salves, hearbs, meats, and the like, there is inherent that virtue which proceedeth from the use of them: and being applied, they have their operation, whether a man believe it, or no) but it is only a voluntary instrument which Christ useth, as it pleaseth him, to work what grace, or measure of⁴²¹ grace seemeth best to him: so as grace is only assistant to it, not included in it: yet in the right use thereof, Christ by his Spirit worketh that grace which is received by it, in which respect the Minister is said to *baptize with water*, but Christ *with the Holy Ghost and with fire*, Matth. 3. 11.

⁴¹⁸*Ier.* 44.

⁴¹⁹*1 Pet.* 3. 21.

⁴²⁰*Aqua exhibet forinsecus Sacramentum gratiae, & Spiritus operatur intrinsecus beneficium gratiae. Aug. Epist.* 23.

⁴²¹*In Baptismo praecipua pars est Spiritus, per quem & aqua sit efficax. Chrys. in Act. Hom.* 1.

§. 44. *Of the necessity of Baptism.*

III. A means of working a thing may be said to be necessary⁴²² two ways.

1. *Absolutely*, so as the thing cannot possibly be without it.⁴²³ Thus are the proper causes of a thing absolutely necessary, as in this case, Gods covenant, Christs blood, and the operation of the Spirit, are absolutely necessary for attaining any grace.
2. *By consequence*, so as according to that course and order which God hath set down, things cannot be without them.

Baptism is not absolutely necessary as a cause: for then should it be equal to Gods covenant, Christs blood, and the work of the Spirit. *Yea then should all that are baptized without any exception be cleansed.*

But it is *by consequence* necessary: and that in a double⁴²⁴ respect.

- 1. In regard of Gods ordinance.
 - 2. In regard of our need thereof.
1. God having ordained this a Sacrament to be used, it is necessary it should be used, if for no other end, yet for manifestation of our obedience. He that carelessly neglecteth; or wilfully contemneth any Sacrament which God shall enjoin him to use, *his soul shall be cut off*.⁴²⁵
 2. Great is the need that we have thereof, in regard of our dulness in conceiving things spiritual, and of our weakness in believing things invisible. We are carnal, and earthly: and by things sensible and earthly, do the better conceive things spiritual and heavenly: therefore hath God ordained visible elements to be Sacraments of invisible graces. Again we are slow to believe such things as are promised in the word, therefore the more to help and strengthen our faith, God hath added to his covenant in the word, his seal in and by the Sacrament: *that by two immutable things*, (Gods covenant and Gods seal) *in which it is impossible for God to lie, we might have strong consolation.* Besides, though in general we do believe the truth of Gods word, yet we are

⁴²² Things necessary two ways.

⁴²³ Ex Hypothesi.

⁴²⁴ Exhypothesi.

⁴²⁵ Gen. 17. 14.

doubtful to apply it to our selves: wherefore for better applying Gods covenant to our own soul, God hath added his Sacrament to his word.

§. 45. *Of the contrary extremes of Papists and Anabaptists about the necessity and efficacy of Baptism.*

There are two extremes contrary to the forenamed points about baptism.

One in the excess, which is of Papists that attribute too much thereunto, and make it a plain Idol.

Another in the defect, of Anabaptists and Libertines, which⁴²⁶ derogate too much from it, and make it an idle ceremony.

In two things do Papists exceed

1. In the necessity
2. In the efficacy

Of Baptism.

They make it so absolutely necessary, as if any die unbaptized he cannot be saved: which doom they pass against infants, though they be deprived thereof without any fault of their own, yea or of their parents, being still borne. A merciless sentence without any warrant of Gods word: yea against his word & against the order which he hath prescribed. He hath established⁴²⁷ his covenant, & promised to be the God of the faithful & of their seed: on which ground *S. Peter* saith, *The promise is unto*⁴²⁸ *you & unto your children:* & *S. Paul* saith, *your children are holy.*⁴²⁹ Shall all these privileges be made void by an inevitable want⁴³⁰ of baptism? If so, would God have enjoined circumcision (which to the Jews was as baptism is to Christians) to be put off to the eighth day, before which day many infants died? Or would *Moses* have suffered it to be forborne all the time that the Israelites were in the wilderness? If it be said that baptism is more necessary then circumcision, I answer, the Scripture layeth no more necessity upon it. If it were so necessary as they make it, then the virtue of Christs death were less effectual since he was actually exhibited then

⁴²⁶ Papists attribute too much to Baptism. *Bellarm. de Bapt lib. 1. cap. 4.*

⁴²⁷ *Gen. 17. 7.*

⁴²⁸ *Acts 2. 39.*

⁴²⁹ *1 Cor. 7. 14.*

⁴³⁰ *Gen. 17. 12. Jos. 5. 5.*

before. For before it was effectual for infants without a Sacrament, but belike not now. Had the ancient Churches conceived so of the absolute necessity of baptism, they would not have had set times for the administering thereof: nor suffered it to be put off so long as they did.⁴³¹ Some Churches appointed it to be administered only at Easter.⁴³² Some at Easter and Whitsuntide. And though many who gave evidence of their true faith died before they were baptized, yet⁴³³ they did not thereupon judge them to be damned. This practise and judgment of the ancients hath made⁴³⁴ many Papists somewhat to mitigate that absolute necessity, and to say that, *In this case, God which hath not bound his grace, in respect of his own freedom, to any Sacrament, may and doth accept them as baptized, which either are martyred before they could be baptized, on else depart this life with vow and desire to have that Sacrament, but by some remediless necessity could not obtain it. If remediless necessity can help the matter, what necessity so remediless, as for a child to be still borne.*

Again, they add such efficacy to baptism, as it giveth grace⁴³⁵ *of the work it self*: wherein they equal it to the very blood of Christ; and take away the peculiar work of the Spirit; and the use of faith, repentance, and such like graces. What can there be more in the water of baptism, then was in the blood of such beasts as were offered up for sacrifices? But *it is not possible that the blood of Bulls and Goats should take away sin.*⁴³⁶ They themselves attribute no such efficacy to the word preached, and yet they cannot show where the holy Ghost hath given more virtue to baptism, then to the word. This text joyneth them both together (*that he might cleanse it with*⁴³⁷ *the washing of water through the word*) What can be more said of a means then that which is said of the word? *It pleased God by preaching to save them that believe. The Gospel is the power of God to salvation, etc.*

⁴³¹ *In Thessalia mos fuit vt paschalibus tantum diebus baptismus perageretur, Niceph. hist. lib. 12. cap. 34. Socrat. hist. lib. 5. cap. 22.*

⁴³² *Ne quenquam Sacerdotes baptizent praeterquam in Pascit a & Pentecoste. L. L. Pipin. Carol. M. etc.*

⁴³³ *Iustus quacunq; morte praeuentus fuerit anima eius in refrigerio erit, dixit Ambr. Orat. de obit. Valent. Qui diem obiit antequam baptisaretur.*

⁴³⁴ *Rhem. annot. on Ioh. 3. 5.*

⁴³⁵ *Ex opere operato, Bellarm. loc. citat.*

⁴³⁶ *Heb. 10. 4.*

⁴³⁷ *1 Cor. 1. 21. Rom. 1. 16.*

On the other side, Anabaptists, and such like Libertines, too⁴³⁸ lightly esteem this holy and necessary ordinance of God, in that they make it only a badge of our profession, a note of difference betwixt the true and false Church, a sign of mutual fellowship, a bare sign of spiritual grace, a resemblance of mortification, regeneration, inscition into Christ, with the like, but no more: These indeed are some of the ends and uses of Baptism: But in that they restrain all the efficacy thereof hereunto, they take away the greatest comfort, and truest benefit which the Church reapeth thereby, as may be gathered out of the points noted⁴³⁹ before.

§. 46. *Of the inward washing by Baptism.*⁴⁴⁰

In that *with this washing of water*, Christ cleanseth his Church, I observe that

Whosoever are fully baptised are cleansed from sin.

Fully, that is, powerfully and effectually, as well inwardly by the Spirit, as outwardly by the Minister.

Cleansed, both from the guilt of sin by Christs blood, and from the power of sin by the work of his Spirit.

To this purpose tend the many emphaticall phrases attributed by the Apostles to Baptism, as that *we are baptised into Jesus Christ, baptised into his death, buried with him by baptism; that Baptism doth save us; that Baptism is the washing of regeneration*,⁴⁴¹ with the like.

Vain is the rejoicing of many, who boast of their baptism,⁴⁴² and think themselves by virtue thereof to be as good Christians as the best, and yet live and lie in their sin, being more besmeered and defiled therewith then they were, when they were first borne. *John* saith, *Christ baptiscth with the holy Ghost*⁴⁴³ *and with fire*: the Apostle saith, *Christ cleanseth with the washing of water*. If that fire of the holy Ghost burn not up the dross of sin in thee, and this water wash not away the filth of sin, thou wert never:

⁴³⁸ Anabaptists extenuate baptism too much.

⁴³⁹ §. 41.

⁴⁴⁰ *Ecce quia Christus sanctificat; ecce quia Christus ipso lauacro aquae in verbo ubi Minister videtur corporaliter operari ipse abluit, ipse mundat. Aug. contr. lit. Petil. l. 3. c. 49.*

⁴⁴¹ *Rom. 6. 3, 4. 1 Pet. 3. 21. Tit. 3 5.*

⁴⁴² Use.

⁴⁴³ *Matth. 3. 11.*

fully baptised. It may be the hand of some Minister hath sprinkled a little water on thy face, but Christs blood hath not as yet been sprinkled on the soul: all the benefit which thou reapest by thy baptism is, that another day thou shalt dearely answer for the abuse of so honourable an ordinance.

§. 47. *Of joining the word with Baptism.*

The other means of sanctifying and cleansing the Church here expressed, is the *word*. This being applied unto Baptism, and joined with it, must needs be meant of the promise of Grace sealed up in Baptism, which is Gods promise of justifying us freely and sanctifying us effectually, plainly made known and truly believed: This means being thus added to this Sacrament, we may well infer that

It is necessary that the word and Baptism go together: that⁴⁴⁴ where this Sacrament is administered, the doctrine thereof be truly, plainly, intelligibly taught, so as the nature, efficacy, end, and use thereof may be made known; and the covenant of God sealed up thereby, believed. So saith Christ,⁴⁴⁵ *Go teach all nations baptising them.* So did the⁴⁴⁶ Baptist, and the⁴⁴⁷ Apostles, they preached the Gospel to them whom they baptised.

1. A Sacrament without the word is but an idle ceremony:⁴⁴⁸ no more then a seal without a covenant: for it is the word that maketh known the covenant of God.
2. It is the word which maketh the greatest difference betwixt the sacramental washing of water, and ordinary common washing.
3. By the word the ordinary creatures which we use are sanctified, much more the holy ordinances of God, whereof Baptism is one of the principal.

Quest. Is it not then lawful to administer Baptism without⁴⁴⁹ a Sermon?

⁴⁴⁴Doct.

⁴⁴⁵Mat. 28. 19.

⁴⁴⁶Luk. 3. 3.

⁴⁴⁷Act. 2. 38. & 8. 12, 37. & 10. 47. & 16. 15, 33.

⁴⁴⁸Reasons. *Detrahe verbum & quid est aqua nisi aqua? accedat verbum ad clementum & fit sacramentum.* Aug. in Ioh. 15. tract. 80.

⁴⁴⁹1 Tim. 4. 5.

Answ. Though it be a very commendable, and honourable manner of administering that Sacrament, then to administer it when the word is preached, yet I think not a Sermon at that time to be so necessary, as it should be unlawful without one, to administer Baptism. For the joining of the word and Sacrament here spoken of is, that they who are baptised, or who present children to be baptised, and answer for them, or are present at the administering of Baptism, or live in the places where it useth to be administered, should be instructed in the Gospel, and taught the covenant which Baptism sealeth up. Besides, the liturgy and public form prescribed for the administering of Baptism both in our Church and other reformed Churches, laieth down the nature, efficacy, end, use, and other like points appertaining to that Sacrament, & plainly declareth the covenant of God sealed up thereby: so as in our and other like Churches where such forms are prescribed to be always used, the word is never separated from Baptism, though at the administering of Baptism there be no Sermon.

The Church of Rome doth directly transgress against the⁴⁵⁰ forenamed rule of joining the word and Baptism together. For though they have a public form prescribed, yet it being in an unknown tongue, not understood of the people, nor expounded to them, it is all one as if there were no form at all, no word at all: for that which is not understood is all one⁴⁵¹ as if it were not uttered.

Much more heinous is their transgression who live under the Gospel, where it is preached plainly to the understanding and capacity of the meanest, and yet are careless in coming to it, or in attending unto it, and so remain as ignorant as if they lived in places where the word is not preached at all, or in an unknown tongue. Such ignorant persons if they were not baptised are not worthy while they remain so ignorant to be baptised, nor yet to present their children to be baptised, or to be present at the baptism of others. As Ministers that baptise ought to preach the word, so ought they who are baptised to be instructed in the word.

⁴⁵⁰ Papists join not the word and seal.

⁴⁵¹ 1 Cor. 14. 9. *etc.*

Redeemed for Glory

§. 48. *Of the Inference of Glorification upon Justification and Sanctification.*

EPHES. 5. 27.

That he might present it to himself a glorious Church, etc.

The most principal end, in regard of the Churches good, which Christ aimed at when he gave himself for her, is her glorious estate in heaven: this is the end of the forenamed end. For why did Christ give himself for the Church? *That he might sanctify it, having cleansed it:* why did he cleanse, and sanctify it? *That he might present it to himself a glorious Church.* Hence note these three points.

- 1. *Justification and sanctification must go before glorification.*
 - 2. *The end why the Saints are cleansed and sanctified in this world, is that they may be presented glorious to Christ in the world to come.*
 - 3. *The only means to make us glorious before Christ our spouse is righteousness.*
1. All those places of Scripture which set our righteousness in this world before our glory in the world to come (as⁴⁵² very many places do) do prove the first point, that *Justification and Sanctification must go before Glorification.* Among⁴⁵³ other proofs note especially the order of the several links of that golden chain that reacheth from Gods eternal counsel before the world, unto our everlasting glory after this world, *Whom he did predestinate them he also called; and whom he called them he also justified; and whom he justified them he also glorified.*
 1. Heaven, the place of our glorification, is *an holy City,*⁴⁵⁴ *whereinto no unclean thing shall enter.*

⁴⁵² Tit. 2. 12, 13. 2 Tim. 4. 7, 8.

⁴⁵³ Men must be justified and sanctified before they can be glorified. Rom. 8. 30.

⁴⁵⁴ Reasons. Reu. 21. 10, 27.

2. In that place the Church is to be married unto Christ, and to be ever with him: she must therefore *be pure as he is*⁴⁵⁵ *pure*: for he will not endure the society of a foul filthy spouse.

As we desire assurance of our glorification in heaven, so⁴⁵⁶ let us get, and give evidence of our justification and sanctification on earth. The evidence of our justification is a sound and true faith. The evidence of our sanctification is a good and clear conscience.

The forenamed proofs and reasons do also confirm the⁴⁵⁷ second point, that *The end why the Saints are cleansed and sanctified in this world is, that they may be presented glorious to Christ in the world to come.*

It is therefore needful and behoveful, not only in regard of⁴⁵⁸ Christs honour, but also of our own glory and happiness, that here while we live on earth we be sanctified and cleansed. If Christ for our sakes had an eye at our future and everlasting glory, and for that end prepared means to bring us thereunto, ought not we ourselves much rather have an eye thereat, and both avoid all things which may hinder it, and use all means whereby we may be assured of it? *Moses had respect unto the recompense of the reward. Yea Christ for the joy which*⁴⁵⁹ *was set before him endured the cross, and despised the shame.*

3. That *Righteousness is the only means to make us glorious*⁴⁶⁰ *before Christ our spouse*, is evident by this, that Christ gave himself to work and effect this means for this end. Christ himself by his death, hath consecrated this, and no other means. If there be any other means then that which Christ by offering up himself hath procured, what need Christ to have been offered up? To show that this is the means to make the Church glorious before Christ, the holy Ghost resembleth the *righteousness of the Saints to fine linen, clean, and white*,⁴⁶¹ wherewith the wife of the Lamb is made ready against the day of marriage.

⁴⁵⁵1 *Ioh.* 3. 2, 3.

⁴⁵⁶Use.

⁴⁵⁷We are here cleansed that we might be hereafter glorified.

⁴⁵⁸*Ex co quod hic accipit Ecclesia ad illam gloriam quae hic non est, perfectionemque perducitur. Aug. Retract. l. 1. c 7.*

⁴⁵⁹*Heb.* 11. 26. & 12. 2.

⁴⁶⁰Righteousness the only means to make us glorious.

⁴⁶¹*Reu.* 19. 7, 8.

Christ himself *loveth righteousness and hateth wickedness*.⁴⁶² they therefore, and none but they that are arrayed with righteousness, are glorious in his eyes.

This I have the rather noted against the conceit of our adversaries,⁴⁶³ who place all the glory of the Church in outward⁴⁶⁴ pomp. Wherefore their Pope whom they make head of the Church, and after a peculiar manner the spouse of Christ, must have his triple crown, his scarlet robes, his throne advanced above kings: men must be his horses to bear him: and Kings and Nobles must be his men to wait on him. Their Priests also must be arrayed with glorious copes of the best wrought gold. Their temples must be decked with curious, carved, gilded images. Their hoast carried about in manner of a triumph. Their people all besprinkled with water. Their superstitious houses must be the fairest buildings in a kingdom, and have the greatest revenues of a kingdom belonging to them: with the like.⁴⁶⁵

Is this glory fit for Christs spouse? Belike then Christ hath carnal eyes and ears: and is delighted with those things wherewith the world is delighted. The wiser among the heathen did scoff at such base conceits which their people had of their gods. Shall Christians think more basely of Christ, then the heathen of their gods? Too much do most people dote on outward worldly glory: even so much as they neglect true righteousness.

For our parts as we desire to appear before Christ so as he⁴⁶⁶ may think us glorious, let us be arrayed with righteousness & holiness, *without which no man shall see the Lord*, Heb. 12. 14.

§. 44. Of the fruition of Christs presence in heaven.

EPHES. 5. 27.

That he might present it to himself a glorious Church, not having spot or wrinkle, or any such thing: but that it should be holy, and without blemish.

⁴⁶²Reason. Psal. 45. 7.

⁴⁶³Use.

⁴⁶⁴Papists place the glory of the Church in outward pomp.

⁴⁶⁵Dionysius Ioui Olympio aureum amiculum detraxit, laneum substituens, non sine dicitio, laneum viz. ad vtram que anni tempestatem esse aptius.

⁴⁶⁶Use.

Having noted the inference of this verse upon the former: I will now handle it distinctly by it self. In it is contained a description of the glorious estate of the Church in heaven. Of that estate must this description be here meant,⁴⁶⁷ for on earth it is not simply without spot or wrinkle: though it be prepared so to be.

This estate is

1. Generally propounded.
2. Particularly exemplified.

In the general proposition is noted

1. Her condition (she is *presented* to Christ.)
2. Her quality (*glorious*.)

The particular exemplification thereof is

1. Privative, by removing all deformity: noted in two words
2. *Spot*.
3. *Wrinkle*.
2. Positive, by adorning her with beauty: noted also in two words
3. *Holy*.
4. *Blameless*.

The word (*present*) is taken from the custom of solemnizing a marriage: first the spouse was wooed, and then set before her husband that he might take her to wife, to be with him. Thus⁴⁶⁸ *Eve* was presented by God to *Adam* that he might take her for his wife: and⁴⁶⁹ *Esther* among other virgins was presented to *Ahash-verosh*. This sheweth that⁴⁷⁰

The Church in heaven shall enjoy the presence of Christ.⁴⁷¹ Christ himself saith expressly to his disciples, *I go to prepare a place for you, that where I am, there ye may be also*. On this ground did the Apostle desire to depart, namely⁴⁷² *to be with Christ*, and⁴⁷³ *to be present with the Lord*.

In heaven is the marriage betwixt Christ and the Church solemnized, which here on earth hath been in preparing. God the father hath given

⁴⁶⁷*Ubiunque commemoravi ecclesiam non habentem maculam aut rugam, non sic accipiendum, quasi iam sit, sed quae praeparatur ut sit, quando apparebit gloriosa. Aug. Retract. l. 3. c. 18.*

⁴⁶⁸*Gen. 2. 22.*

⁴⁶⁹*Est. 2. 13.*

⁴⁷⁰*Doct.*

⁴⁷¹*Ioh. 14. 2, 3.*

⁴⁷²*Phil. 1. 23.*

⁴⁷³*2 Cor. 5. 8. Reason.*

his⁴⁷⁴ son unto the Church, and the⁴⁷⁵ Church unto his son: yea⁴⁷⁶ Christ himself hath purchased the Church unto himself by his blood, and⁴⁷⁷ promised marriage unto her, and the more to assure the Church of his love he hath⁴⁷⁸ bestowed many gifts upon her: he hath further sent⁴⁷⁹ his Ministers in his name to⁴⁸⁰ woo and⁴⁸¹ beseech the Church to give her consent, and to⁴⁸² prepare her as a pure virgin for himself: Hereupon the Church hath given her consent, for⁴⁸³ as a spouse she is subject unto Christ as unto an head. These things being so, how can it be thought that Christ will forsake her, and not receive her to be with him for ever?

Can the thought of death be terrible to such as know and⁴⁸⁴ believe the truth hereof? Will not rather the consideration⁴⁸⁵ thereof make them with the Apostle *to sigh, and desire to depart*, that they may be with the Lord? The highest degree of the Churches happiness consisteth in this fruition of the⁴⁸⁶ presence of her spouse: for so he becometh all in all unto her: not by means, as in this world, but immediately by himself: so as there shall need no Minister, no Sacrament, no ordinance to set forth Christ unto us: no Governor in family, Church, or common-wealth, to represent his person, or to keep us in subjection: no light to direct us, no food to sustain us; we shall be so assisted with Christ as we shall need nothing. If those servants were happy that stood continually before *Solomon*, what are they that always stand not as servants⁴⁸⁷ but as a wife in his presence that is infinitely greater then *Solomon*? If it were a great grace & favour, that *Moses* saw the backparts⁴⁸⁸ of God, what a grace and favour is it, to

⁴⁷⁴*Ioh.* 3. 16.

⁴⁷⁵& 17. 6.

⁴⁷⁶*Act.* 20. 28.

⁴⁷⁷*Ose.* 2. 19, 20.

⁴⁷⁸*Eph.* 4. 8.

⁴⁷⁹*Paranymphi.*

⁴⁸⁰*Ioh.* 3. 29.

⁴⁸¹2 *Cor.* 5. 20.

⁴⁸²& 11. 2.

⁴⁸³*Eph.* 5. 24.

⁴⁸⁴Use.

⁴⁸⁵Incoragement against death.

⁴⁸⁶*Totum tibi sit Deus: quia horum quae diligis, totum tibi est. Aug. in Ioh. 3. tract. 13. Reu. 21, 22, 23. Ioh 17. 20, 21.*

⁴⁸⁷1 *King.* 10. 8.

⁴⁸⁸*Exo.* 33. 23.

behold Christ⁴⁸⁹ face to face? For *when he doth appear, we shall see him as he is.*⁴⁹⁰ Though now we be absent from the Lord, yet let us uphold our selves with the expectation and assurance of this, that we shall be presented before Christ.

§. 50. *Of the Glory of the Church in heaven.*

*The quality of the Church in heaven is as excellent as may be,*⁴⁹¹ and therefore here said to be *glorious*: all beauty, all comeliness, all grace, whatsoever may make the Church amiable, lovely, or any way to be desired, or admired, is comprised under this word *glorious*. In this respect the Saints are said to *shine*, and that *as*⁴⁹² *precious stones*, yea as the⁴⁹³ *firmament*, as the *stars*, and as the⁴⁹⁴ *sun*: and to be⁴⁹⁵ *like Christ* himself: and to⁴⁹⁶ *appear with him in glory*.

This glory of the Saints extendeth both to soul and body, and whole person.

In regard of their souls they shall be all⁴⁹⁷ *glorious within*: for they are⁴⁹⁸ *Spirits of just men, made perfect*:⁴⁹⁹ perfect knowledge, wisdom, and all manner of purity shall be in them.

In regard of their bodies, they shall be⁵⁰⁰ *fashioned like to Christs glorious body*: and that in incorruption, immortality,⁵⁰¹ beauty, brightness, grace, favour, agility, strength, and the like. It is therefore truly said, that the Church in the end of the world expecteth that which is before demonstrated in Christs body.

⁴⁸⁹1 Cor. 13. 12.

⁴⁹⁰1 Joh. 3 2.

⁴⁹¹Doctr.

⁴⁹²Reu. 21. 11.

⁴⁹³Dan. 12. 3.

⁴⁹⁴Mat. 13. 43.

⁴⁹⁵1 Ioh. 3, 2.

⁴⁹⁶Col. 3 4.

⁴⁹⁷Psal. 45. 13.

⁴⁹⁸Heb. 12. 23.

⁴⁹⁹1 Cor. 13. 12.

⁵⁰⁰Phil. 3. 21.

⁵⁰¹*Ecclesia in fine seculi expectat quo l in Christi corpore praemonstratum est, etc.*
Aug. Epist. 119.

In regard of their person, as a wife is advanced to the honour and dignity of her husband, so shall they to the honour and dignity of Christ, so far as they are capable of it: for they shall be⁵⁰² next unto Christ, yea⁵⁰³ one with him, and so⁵⁰⁴ above the most glorious Angels.

Much more might be spoken of the glory of the Church: but never can enough be spoken thereof, no not by the tongue of men or Angels: for⁵⁰⁵ *eye hath not seen, nor ear heard, neither have entered into the heart of man the things which God hath prepared for them which love him.* When Paul was rapt up into the third heaven, and saw but a glimpse of this glory,⁵⁰⁶ *he heard unspeakable words, which are not possible for man to utter.* Wherefore⁵⁰⁷ when he speaketh of it, he useth such a transcendent kind of phrase, as cannot in any tongue be fully expressed: we thus as well as we can by one degree of comparison upon another translate it, *a far more exceeding* and eternal weight of glory.

Is not this sufficient to uphold us against all the reproach and disgrace which the world layeth upon us, because we are⁵⁰⁸ of the Church of Christ? The world hath⁵⁰⁹ of old counted her, to whom Christ saith, *Hephzibah* (that is, *my delight in her*) and *Beulah* (that is, *married*) forsaken and desolate, yea⁵¹⁰ *as the filth of the world, and the off-scowring of all things.* Among Heathen, none so vildly esteemed of as Christians; and amongst Papists, none so as Protestants; & amongst carnal Gospellers, none so as they who endeavour⁵¹¹ to *purify themselves as Christ is pure*, and to avoid the common sins of the world. When for Christs sake we are basely accounted of, let us think of this.

§. 51. Of the Churches freedom from all deformity in heaven. Not having spot, or wrinkle, or any such thing.

⁵⁰² Luk. 22. 30.

⁵⁰³ Joh. 17. 21

⁵⁰⁴ Heb. 1. 14.

⁵⁰⁵ 1 Cor. 2. 9.

⁵⁰⁶ 2 Cor. 12 4..

⁵⁰⁷ 2 Cor. 4. 17.

⁵⁰⁸ Use.

⁵⁰⁹ Isa. 62. 4.

⁵¹⁰ 1 Cor. 4. 13..

⁵¹¹ 1 Joh. 3. 3.

The first point noted by the Apostle in his exemplification of the fore-named glory, is a removing of all deformity. The word translated *spot*, is taken for a stain on a garment, and a foul speck on a mans face, or other part of the body: or a scar, or other blemish in his flesh by a sore, wound, blow, or the like. The other word (*wrinkl-*) is taken for a *creast* in the face through old age, for it signifieth a *gathering together of the skin by old age*: by it is meant any manner of breaking (as we speak) by age, sickness, trouble, paine, or the like. Because there may be also deformities other ways, the Apostle addeth this clause (*or any such thing.*) These things applied to the Church, show that

*No manner of deformity shall cleave to the Church in heaven.*⁵¹² There shall be in her no stain or contagion of sin received from others, no scar of any evil humour arising from it self, no wrinkle, no defect of spiritual moisture, no sign of the old man, nor any thing that may any way make it seem deformed, or uncomely in the sight of Christ. Not only great, heinous, capital sins, (which are as botches and boils, and as open, wide sores, gashes and wounds) but all spots and specks, all wrinkles and defects, all manner of blemishes whatsoever within, or without, shall be clean taken away. Sin shall not only be subdued in us, but utterly rooted out of us: no relique, no sign thereof shall be left remaining. In this respect it is said, that *God shall wipe away all tears*, that is, shall take away all⁵¹³ matter of mourning, sorrow, and grief. Now there is nothing that ministreth matter of more sorrow to the Saints then sin. That remnant of sin which was in the Apostle even after his regeneration, made him thus cry out, *O wretched man that I am.*⁵¹⁴

Though this be but a privative good, yet it addeth much to the heavenly happiness of the Saints. If it were possible that we should enjoy the rest and glory prepared for the Saints in heaven, and withal there should remain on us the spots and wrinkles of sin, these spots and wrinkles would be as the hand-writing which appeared to *Belshazzar* in the midst of⁵¹⁵ his jollity: they would be as gall mixed with wine: they would turn all our joy into heaviness, and take away the sweet relish of all our happiness.

⁵¹² Doctr.

⁵¹³ *Reu.* 7. 17. & 21. 4.

⁵¹⁴ *Rom.* 7. 24.

⁵¹⁵ *Dan* 5. 5.

The consideration therefore of this privative benefit cannot but breed in the hearts of all such as are members of this Church a longing desire after this perfect purging of them from all deformity.

§. 52. *Of the perfect purity of the Church in heaven.*

But that it should be holy and without blemish.

The last branch whereby the celestial glory of the Church is set forth, is the perfect purity thereof: the adversative particle (BUT) sheweth that the holiness here spoken of is no imperfect holiness, such as the sanctification of the Saints is in this world, but an absolute perfect holiness in all the parts and degrees thereof: such as is without *spot* or *wrinkle*: without relique, or sign of sin: and therefore by way of explanation is added, *without blemish*, or *blameless*: such as man, Angell, nor God himself can find fault withal.⁵¹⁶ This attribute is oft applied to the person and blood of Jesus Christ, and therefore⁵¹⁷ it must needs set forth perfect purity. Whence we may observe that

The Sanctification of the Saints shall be perfect in heaven. They shall not only be justified by having their sins covered to them, nor only have their sanctification truly begun in them, but also in every part, point, and degree thereof absolutely perfected: in which respect they are said to be *just men made*⁵¹⁸ *perfect*. *Adam* in his innocency was not more pure then the Saints shall be in heaven: yea they shall far surpass *Adam* as in the measure, so in the stabilitie and perpetuity thereof.

In our endeavour after holiness let us have an eye to this⁵¹⁹ perfection: and not faint, if we attain not to that measure which we desire. Perfection is reserved for the world to come. Yet know we, that the more holy and blameless we are, the nearer we come to that heavenly estate: the more spots and blemishes of sin we have, the more unlike we are unto it, and the less hope we have of enjoying that heavenly happiness.

⁵¹⁶ *Heb.* 9. 14.

⁵¹⁷ *1 Pet.* 1. 19.

⁵¹⁸ *Heb.* 12. 23.

⁵¹⁹ Use.

All the forenamed several points of the glorious estate of⁵²⁰ the Church in heaven should ravish our spirits, and even break our hearts with an holy admiration of Christs good-ness, and fill our mouths with praises for the same, and make us sigh, and long after the same, and with all good conscience and diligence use all the means we can to attain thereunto: no labour will be lost herein. Surely, this is either not known, or not believed, or not remembered, or not duly and seriously considered by such as make light account thereof. Let that which hath been but briefly touched be further meditated upon, and let us pray that *the eyes of our understanding may be enlightned*,⁵²¹ *that we may know what is the riches of the glorious inheritance of the Saints*. Were it not for this hope, the Saints were⁵²² of all the most miserable; whereas now they are the most happy.

⁵²⁰ General uses of the glorious estate of the Church in heaven.

⁵²¹ *Ephes.* 1. 18.

⁵²² *1 Eor.* 15. 19.

Marital Love and Self-Love

§. 53. *Of the application of the things which Christ hath done for the Church, unto husbands.*

EPHES. 5. 28.

So ought men to love their wives, *etc.*

THE first clause of this verse serveth both for an *application* of the former argument, and also for a *transition* to another argument.

The particle of relation (So) sheweth that that which hath before been delivered of Christs love to his Church, ought to be referred and applied to husbands. For as Christ loved his Church, So ought husbands to love their wives.

Quest. Why are these transcendent evidences of Christs surpassing love to his Church set before husbands? Can any such things be expected from husbands to their wives?

Answ. No,⁵²³ not for measure, but for likeness. For in this large declaration of Christs love, there are two general points to be noted.

1. That the Church in her self was no way worthy of love.
2. That Christ so carried himself towards her that he made her worthy of much love.

This ought to be the mind of husbands to their wives.

1. Though they be no way worthy of love, yet they must love them.
2. They must endeavour with all the wit and wisdom they have, to make them worthy of love. I say *endeavour* because it is not simply in the husbands power to do the deed. Yet his faithful endeavour shall on his part be accepted for the deed.

Of these points I shall hereafter more fully speak.

⁵²³See §. 27.

§. 54. *Of the application of the love which a man beareth to himself, unto an husband.*

EPHES. 5. 28.

So ought men to love their wives as their own bodies.

The forenamed particle (So) hath also relation to another pattern, namely, of a mans self to his body: and so it is a transition from one argument to another.

There is some more Emphasis here used in setting down an husbands duty, then was before, vers. 25.

There it was laid down by way of exhortation, *husbands love your wives.*

Here it is laid down with a straiter charge: *husbands ought to love their wives.* So as this duty is not a matter arbitrary, left to the husbands will to do it, or leave it undone: there is a necessity laid upon him: he must love his wife. Woe therefore unto him if he do it not.

In setting down this argument taken from a mans self, the Apostle resembleth a mans wife unto his *body*: wherein he hath relation to vers. 23. Where he said, *the husband is the head of the wife.* Whereby he sheweth, that as an husbands place is a motive to his wife, for her to perform her duty: so to himself,⁵²⁴ for him to perform his duty.

He is her head, therefore she must be subject to him.

She is his body, therefore he must love her.

This example of a mans self is both a *reason*, the more to move husbands to love their wives, and also a *rule* to teach them how to love them.

The *reason* is implied under that near union that is betwixt⁵²⁵ a man and his wife: she is as near to him as his own body: therefore she ought to be as deere to him. The body never dissenteth from it self, nor the soul against it self. So neither should man and wife.

The *rule* is noted under the manner of a mans loving his own body: as entirely as he loveth his body, so entirely he ought to love his wife.

Of the manner of a mans loving himself, see Treat. 4. §. 74. 76.

⁵²⁴See Treat. 4. §. 74 76. Why the pattern of a mans self is added to the pattern of Christ.

⁵²⁵*Sicut corpus nunquam à se dissidet, neque anima aduersus seipsum, ita virum & mulierem non conuenit dissidere. Chrys. in Gen. hom. 45.*

The more to enforce this comparison, the Apostle addeth, *He that loveth his wife, loveth himself*.⁵²⁶

By this clause two things are implied.

1. That a wife is not only as a mans body, namely, his outward flesh, but as his person, his body and soul. She is as *his body*, because she was taken out of his body: and because⁵²⁷ she is set under him, as his body under his head. She is as *himself*, by reason of the bond of marriage, which maketh *one* of two. In which respect a wife is commonly called a mans⁵²⁸ *second self*.
2. That an husband in loving his wife loveth himself: so as the benefit of loving his wife will redound to himself, as well as to his wife.

§. 55. *Of the amplification of a mans love of himself.*

EPHES. 5. 29.

For no man ever yet hated his own flesh: but nourisheth and cherisheth it, even as the Lord the Church.

The former pattern of a mans self is here further amplified. For first the Apostle proveth, that a man loveth himself: and then he sheweth how he loveth himself.

Two arguments are used to prove the point.

One is taken from the contrary: *No man ever yet hated his own flesh. Therefore he loveth it.*

The other is taken from the effects of love: *To nourish and cherish ones flesh is a fruit of love: But every man nourisheth and cherisheth his flesh. Therefore he loveth it.*

This latter argument sheweth the manner of a mans loving himself: and therein a mans love of himself is a rule to teach him how to love his wife.

This indefinite particle (*no man*) is to be restrained to such as have the understanding and affection of a man in them: as if he had said, *no man in his right wits*: for furious, frantic, mad, desperate persons will cut their arms, legs, and other parts, mangle their flesh, hang, drown, smother, choake, and stab themselves. Even so they are as men out of their wits,

⁵²⁶ Ephes. 5. 28.

⁵²⁷ Gen. 2. 23.

⁵²⁸ Matth. 19. 5, 6.

who⁵²⁹ hate, or any way hurt their wives: yea, it is the part of a mad man to doubt of loving, and doing good to himself.

These two words (to *nourish* and *cherish*) comprize under them a careful providing of all things needful for a mans body.

To *nourish*, is properly to feed.

To *cherish*, is to keep warm.

The former is done by *food*: the latter by *apparel*. Under⁵³⁰ food, and apparel the Apostle comprizeth all things needful for this life, where he saith, *Having food and raiment, let us therewith be content.*⁵³¹

This applied to an husband, sheweth that he ought to have a provident care for the good of his wife in all things needful for her.

That he may yet further press this point, he returneth again to the example of Christ (*even as the Lord the Church*) The Apostle thought that this nail of love had need be fast beaten into the heads and hearts of husbands, and therefore addeth blow to blow to knock it up deep, even to the head: before he confirmed Christs example with the example of our selves: here he confirmeth the example of our selves with the example of Christ again. This he doth for two especial reasons.

1. The more forcibly to urge the point: for two examples add weight one to another: especially this latter which is so far more excellent as we heard out of *vers.* 25, 26, 27.
2. To give husbands a better direction for their providence towards their wives, whom they must nourish and cherish, not only as their bodies, but as Christ nourisheth and cherisheth his Church, not only with things temporal, but also with things spiritual and eternal.

§. 56. *Of mans natural affection to himself.*

EPHES. 5. 28, 29.

So ought men to love their wives as their own bodies: he that loveth his wife loveth himself. For no man ever yet hated his own flesh: but nourisheth, and cherisheth it, even as the Lord the Church.

⁵²⁹ *Quia se diligit, & prodesse sibi velit, dubitare dementis est. Aug. de doct. Christ. lib. 1. cap. 25.*

⁵³⁰ *Proprie dicitur de galina fouente oua, quum illis incubat.*

⁵³¹ *1 Tim 6. 8.*

Having briefly showed the general scope of the 28 and 29 verses, I will proceed to a more distinct handling of them.

They setforth *The natural affection of a man to himself*.⁵³²

Two points are here to be noted.

1. The general proposition, *that a man is well affected to himself*.
2. The particular amplification, and manifestation of that affection.

This is manifested two ways.

1. Negatively, *No man hateth his own flesh*.
 2. Affirmatively, and that in two branches
 3. *Nourisheth*
 4. *Cherisheth*
- it.

Both these are justified by the like affection of Christ to the Church which is his body (*Even as the Lord the Church*) In that the Apostle propoundeth the natural affection of a mans self to his body as a motive and pattern to Christians, to love their wives, and also justifieth the same by a like affection of Christ to his Church, I observe that

Natural affection is a thing lawful and commendable: it is⁵³³ an affection which may stand with a good conscience: which Gods word is so far from taking away, as it doth establish it. For such as are *without natural affection* are directly condemned: and we are⁵³⁴ commanded to be so kindly affectioned⁵³⁵ one to another as we are to our selves. Yea the law in⁵³⁶ the strict rigour thereof laieth down that natural affection which is in a man to himself as a rule for the love of his neighbour (⁵³⁷*thou shalt love thy neighbour as thy self*.) Hence is it that the⁵³⁸ Prophets, ⁵³⁹Apostles, and Christ himself do oft call upon us to have an eye to that affection which we bear to our selves. Of this pattern Christ saith,⁵⁴⁰ *This is the Law, and the Prophets*, this is the brief sum of them, this is it which they do much urge and press.

⁵³²Sum 28. & 2

⁵³³Doctr.

⁵³⁴Rom. 12. 10

⁵³⁵Rom. 1. 30.

⁵³⁶2 Tim. 3. 3.

⁵³⁷Mat. 22. 39.

⁵³⁸Leu. 19. 18. Isa. 58. 7.

⁵³⁹1 Cor. 12. 26. Jam. 2. 8.

⁵⁴⁰Mat. 7. 12.

1. Natural affection was at first created of God, by him⁵⁴¹ planted in man, so that as soul, body, the powers, and parts of them, are in their substance good things, this affection also in it self is good.
2. There are the same reasons to love our selves, as our brethren. For we our selves are made after Gods image, redeemed by Christs blood, members of the same mystical body, keepers of our selves, to give an account of the good or hurt we do to our selves, with the like. In the Law, under this word *neighbour*, our selves are comprised: and every commandment of the second table is to be applied to our selves.

§. 57. *Of natural self-love.*

Object. Lovers of themselves are condemned in Gods word, as 2 Tim. 3. 2. Phil. 2. 21. 1 Cor. 10. 24. Rom. 15. 1.

Ans. There is a double loving of a mans self.⁵⁴²

One good and commendable:

The other evil, and damnable.

Good and commendable loving of a mans self is

1. Natural.
2. Spiritual.

That which is natural is in all by the very instinct of nature: and it was at first created, and still is by Gods providence preserved in our nature, and that for the preservation of nature. Were there not such a natural love of himself in every one, man would be as careless of himself, as of others, and as loth to take pains for himself, as for others. Wherefore that every one might have care at least of one, even of himself, and so the world be better preserved, God hath reserved in man this natural affection, notwithstanding his corruption by sin. Yea further because every one is not able to look to himself, at least when he is young, sick, old, or any other way impotent, God by his wise providence hath extended this natural affection towards otheralso as they are nearly linked unto us by the bonds of nature. The next to a mans self are (by blood and bond of nature) children. Admirably much is that which parents do for their children, which they would never do, if there were not a natural affection in them to their children. From children

⁵⁴¹Reasons.

⁵⁴²The several kinds of self-love.

again this affection ariseth towards their parents, that when parents grow old, impotent, or any way unable to help themselves, they might have succour from their children. And because parents and children are not always together, or not able to help one another, or unnatural, God hath yet further extended this natural affection to brethren, cousins, and other kindred. And for a further extent thereof hath instituted marriage betwixt such as are not of the same blood, and by virtue of that bond raised a natural affection not only in husband and wife one to another, but also in all the alliance that is made thereby. Moreover this affection is wrought in neighbours, friends, fellows, and other by like bonds knit together, that the bow of Gods providence might have many strings, and if one break, another might hold. In all these kinds, the nearer a man cometh to himself, the more doth this affection show it self, according to the proverb, *Near is my coat, but nearer is my skin*. God having wrought this natural affection in the several kinds thereof, and there being good ends and uses thereof, it is not to be condemned.

§. 58. *Of spiritual self-love.*

Spiritual self-love is that which is supernaturally wrought in man by Gods Spirit: whereby he is both inlightned to discern what is most excellent, and best for him, and also moved to choose the same: so as this serueth to rectify the former. Hence it cometh to pass that their chieftest care is for their souls, and for the eternal salvation thereof: for the furthering whereof they can be content as need requireth, to⁵⁴³ beat down their body, to⁵⁴⁴ deny them sometimes their ordinary refreshing by food, rest, and other like means, yea and to⁵⁴⁵ suffer them to be imprisoned, racked, and otherwaies tortured, and life it self to be taken from them. This men do,⁵⁴⁶ and suffer, not for want of natural affection, but by reason of spiritual affection which perswades them that it is good for them it should be so, A man is not therefore to be said not to love the health and safety of

⁵⁴³ 1 Cor. 9. 27.

⁵⁴⁴ 2 Cor. 11. 27.

⁵⁴⁵ Heb. 11. 36, 37.

⁵⁴⁶ *Non propterea quisquam dicendus est non diligere salutem, atque incolumitatem corporis sui, quia amplius aliquid diligit: nam auarus etc. Aug. de doct. Chr. lib. 1. cap. 25.*

his body because he loveth something more. For a covetous man though he love his money, yet he can be content to part with it for bread to nourish his body: so a spiritual man though he love his life, yet he can be content to lose it for his souls salvation. For he loveth himself sufficiently, who doth his best to enjoy the chiefest and truest good. This spiritual affection extendeth it self as⁵⁴⁷ far as, natural affection, namely to wives, husbands, children, parents, brethren, cosins, friends, etc. Much is this urged and pressed in the Scriptures, as *Isa.* 55. 1, 2, 3. *Mat.* 6. 19, 20, 33. *Ioh.* 6. 27. 1 *Tim.* 6. 11, 19.

§. 59. *Of evil self-love.*

The self-love which is evil swerueth in the

1. *Object.*

2. *Measure.*

1. In the *Object*, when it is cast upon our corruptions, our lusts, our evil humors: when we affect and love them, and for them pursue whatsoever may satisfy them: as the ambitious, lustful, riotous, gluttonous, and other like persons. This is expressly forbidden, *Make not provision for the flesh to fulfill*⁵⁴⁸ *the lusts thereof.*
2. In the *Measure*, when our love is wholly and only cast upon our selves, so seeking our own good, as we regard no mans good but our own: nor care what damage another receiveth, so we may get advantage thereby. This is also forbidden:⁵⁴⁹ for it is contrary to the property of true love, *which seeketh not her own*, namely to the prejudice of another. This hath the title of *Self-love* appropriated to it. It sprang from the corruption of nature, and is daily increased by the instigation of Satan for the destruction of mankind. It manifesteth it self by the many tricks of deceit which most men use in their dealings with others: by making advantage of others necessities as in the case of usury, of raising corn, and other commodities in time of scarcity, with the like: by mens backwardness to help such as stand in need of their succour:

⁵⁴⁷ *Ille so satis diligit qui sedulo agit vt summo & vero perfruatur bono. Aug. de mor. eccl. l. 1. c. 26.*

⁵⁴⁸ *Rom.* 13. 14.

⁵⁴⁹ *Phil.* 2. 21. 1 *Cor.* 13. 5. & 10. 24.

by want of compassion in other mens miseries: and by many other like unkindness: all which verify the proverb, *Every man for himself*. But by distinguishing the forenamed points we may see that notwithstanding *evil self-love* be a most detestable vice, yet it is both lawful and commendable to love ones self aright.

§. 60. *Of the error of Stoics in condemning all passion.*

The doatage of Stoics who would have all natural affection⁵⁵⁰ rooted out of man, is contrary to this pattern, and unworthy to find any entertainment among Christians: for what do they aim at, but to root that out of man, which God hath planted in him, and to take away the means which God hath used for the better preservation of man? That wise man whom they frame to themselves is worse then a brute beast: he is a very stock and block. Not only the best and wisestmen that ever were in the world, but also Christ himself had those passions and affections in him, which they account unbeseeming a wise man. Their doatage hath long since been hissed out of the schools of Philosophers, should it then find place in Christs Church?

§. 61. *Of well using natural affection.*

Let us labour to cherish this natural affection in us, and to⁵⁵¹ turn it to the best things, even to such as are not only apparently, but indeed good: and among good things to such as are most excellent, and the most necessary: such as concern our souls, and eternal life. For this end we must pray to have our understandings inlightned (that we may *discern*⁵⁵² *things that differ*, and *approve that which is excellent*) and to have our wills and affections sanctified, that we embrace, pursue, and delight in that which we know to be the best. Thus shall our *natural* affection be turned into a *spiritual* affection.

Here we see how we may make nature a schoolmaster unto us: for as Christ sendeth us to the fowles of the air, and lillies⁵⁵³ of the field to learn

⁵⁵⁰ 1. *Use*.

⁵⁵¹ 2. *Use*.

⁵⁵² *Phil.* 1. 10.

⁵⁵³ *Mat.* 6. 26, 28.

of them, so the Apostle here sendeth us to our own natural instinct. We cannot complain that we have no schoolmaster near us (as many in the country whose children for want of one are rudely brought up) our selves are schoolmasters to our selves. Wherefore as the Apostle hereby teacheth husbands to love their wives, so let us all more generally learn to love one another: for⁵⁵⁴ we are all mutual members of one and the same body: and our brother or neighbour is⁵⁵⁵ *Our flesh*.

§. 62. *Of Mans forbearing to wrong himself.*

EPHES. 5. 29.

For no man ever yet hated his own flesh: but nourisheth and cherisheth it.

The first particle (*for*) showeth that in this verse an evidence and manifestation of a mans love of himself is given. The first part thereof, which is set down negatively, showeth that

It is against the common instinct of nature for a man to hate⁵⁵⁶ himself. It is noted as an evidence that devils were in the Gadarene, in that *he cut himself with stones*: had not the devils⁵⁵⁷ forced him, he would never have done it.

Hatred is contrary to love: it being therefore before proved⁵⁵⁸ that every man by nature loveth himself, by necessary consequence it followeth, that no man hateth his flesh: for two contrary effects proceed not from the same cause: *no fountain can yield both salt water and fresh.*⁵⁵⁹

Object. Many do macerate their bodies with fastings, watchings, labours, travels, and the like: others tear and gash their flesh with whips, knives, swords, yea and with their teeth also: others lay such violent hands upon themselves, as they take away their own lives.

Answ. 1. None of these things are done by the instinct of nature which God hath set in man, but through the corruption of nature which the devil

⁵⁵⁴1 *Cor.* 12. 12.

⁵⁵⁵*Isa.* 58. 7.

⁵⁵⁶Doctr.

⁵⁵⁷*Mar.* 5. 5.

⁵⁵⁸Reason.

⁵⁵⁹*Iam.* 3. 12.

hath caused. Now nature and corruption of nature are two contrary causes: no marvell then that contrary effects come from them.

2. They think they do these things in love to themselves; as superstitious persons to merit salvation, by macerating their body: others to free themselves from ignominy, penury, slavery, torment, or such like evils: so as there is an apparent good that maketh them so to do, and not simply hatred of themselves. They that so do, are either possessed with a Devil, or blinded in their mind, or bereaved of their wits, or overwhelmed with some passion, so as they know not what they do: they do it not therefore in hatred.
2. *Object.* Holy and wise men deliberately, and on good advice, have *beaten down their bodies*, and yielded their lives⁵⁶⁰ to be taken away, *not accepting deliverance*.

Answ. That was far from hatred, and in great love to themselves, as was showed⁵⁶¹ before.

§. 63. *Of unnatural practises against ones self.*

The forenamed doctrine discovereth many practises used⁵⁶² by sundry men to be against nature, and in that respect most horrible and detestable.

1. *The practise of the idolatrous Baalites*, who to move their I doll to hear them, *cut themselves with knives and lancers, till⁵⁶³ the blood gushed out upon them.* Not much unlike to whom are Popish Eremites, Anchorites, Monks flagellants, Grandimontenses, sundry sorts of Franciscans, and other Friers, whereof⁵⁶⁴ some wear shirts of hair-cloth, some shirts of mail next their body, some go bare-foot, some daily whip themselves till blood follow, and some waste their bodies with lying hard, watching, fasting, going on pilgrimage, etc.
2. *The practise of Gluttons, Drunkards, unchaste and voluptuous persons*, who to satisfy their corrupt humours, impair their health, pull diseases upon them, and shorten their days.

⁵⁶⁰ 1 Cor. 9. 27. Heb. 11. 35. etc.

⁵⁶¹ §. 56.

⁵⁶² 1 Use.

⁵⁶³ 1 King. 18. 28. Cassian. Collat. 19.

⁵⁶⁴ D. Willet Synops. Papism. Contr. 6. quaest. 6.

3. *The practise of Swaggerers*, who by quarrels cause their flesh to be wounded, and their lives taken away. Among these may be reckoned such as bring themselves to great straits, distresses, and dangers for lucre sake: and they who by felony, treason, and the like evil deeds, cast themselves upon the sword of the Magistrate.
4. *The practise of them that give the reins to grief, fear, wrath*, and other like violent passions, so as thereby they weaken their bodies, and shorten their days.
5. *The practise of self-murderers*: who herein break the rule of love (*as thy self*) and end their days in a most horrible⁵⁶⁵ sin, depriving themselves of the time, place, and means of repentance: so as, whatsoever fond pretence they make for their sin, little better can be thought of them, then that they thrust their souls headlong into hell, unless the Lord betwixt the act done, and the expiration of their breath, extraordinarily touch their hearts. Religion, nature, sense, and all abhor this fearful fact: so as not only those who have been enlightned⁵⁶⁶ by Gods word, but also the Heathen, who had no other then the light of nature, have adjudged it to be a most desperate sin.

§. 64. *Of haters of others.*

2. By that affection which nature moveth men to bear to their flesh, we may see how nature more prevails with men, then conscience and obedience to Gods word, yea then the⁵⁶⁷ Spirit: for where nature keepeth all men from hating their own flesh, nothing can keep many husbands from hating their wives, and wives their husbands; nor brothers, cosens, & neighbours (yet these are *our own flesh*) no nor many of those⁵⁶⁸ who profess themselves to be of the mystical body of Christ, from hating one another. What shall we say of these? Is nature of greater power, and more mighty in operation then the Spirit? Surely, such either deceive themselves and others, in pretending to be members of the body of Christ: or else the Spirit is very weak in them, and the

⁵⁶⁵Matth. 22. 39.

⁵⁶⁶—*Quam vellent aethere in alto, Nunc & pauperiem, & duos perferre labores.*
Uirg. Aen. 6.

⁵⁶⁷2. Use.

⁵⁶⁸Isa. 58. 7.

flesh beareth a great sway. Let haters of their brethren think of this and be ashamed.

§. 65. *Of mans care in providing and using things needful for his body.*

The second evidence of that love which a man beareth to himself, is noted in two such branches (*nourisheth* and *cherisheth*) as comprize⁵⁶⁹ all needful things under them, so as the Apostle implieth thereby, that

*Nature teacheth all men to provide such things as are needful for*⁵⁷⁰ *them: needful for life, as food: and needful for health, as apparel. Nature is here propounded as a Schoolmaster to Christians: this therefore which nature teacheth is a bounden duty. It is much insisted upon by Solomon, who in this respect*⁵⁷¹ *saith, It is good and comely for one to eat and drink, and enjoy the good of all his labour.*

If he be worse then an Infidel that provideth not for his⁵⁷² own, what is he that provideth not for himself? Even worse then a beast: for nature hath taught the bruit beasts to nourish and cherish themselves. If any think that it more befiteth beasts, or natural men then Saints, let them tell me which of the Saints at any time guided by Gods Spirit, hath wholly neglected himself. To omit all others, it is expressly noted of Christ, that as there was occasion, he⁵⁷³ slept, he⁵⁷⁴ eat, he⁵⁷⁵ rested, and otherwise refreshed himself.

***Object.* Though he were⁵⁷⁶ hungry, and meat prepared for him, yet he refused to eat.**

Answ. 1. Forbearing one meal, is no great hindrance of⁵⁷⁷ cherishing the body.

⁵⁶⁹See §. 55.

⁵⁷⁰Doctr.

⁵⁷¹*Eccl.* 2. 24. & 3. 13. & 5. 18. & 8. 15.

⁵⁷²1 *Tim.* 5. 8. *Inconcussa naturae lege diligimus nos ipsos, quae in bestias etiam promulgata est. Aug. de Doct. Chr. li. 1. ca. 26.*

⁵⁷³*Mat.* 8. 24.

⁵⁷⁴*Luke* 14. 1.

⁵⁷⁵*John* 4. 6.

⁵⁷⁶*Ioh.* 4. 31. *etc.*

⁵⁷⁷Lawful fasts no hindrance to the cherishing of the body.

2. Extraordinary and weighty occasions may lawfully make a man a little neglect himself: that so he may show he prefereth Gods glory, and his brothers salvation, before the outward nourishing of his body: to which purpose Christ saith, *My meat is to do the will of him that sent me*: that is, I⁵⁷⁸ prefer it before my meat. And Saint *Paul* saith, *I will very*⁵⁷⁹ *gladly be spent for your souls*. We must here therefore take heed of the extremes on both hands.
1. Of undue, and overmuch neglecting our bodies, so as the strength of them be wasted, and the health impaired.
2. Of too much caring for it, so as upon no occasion we will lose a meals meat, or a nights rest. Fasting and watching as occasion requireth, are bounden duties.

But to return to the point of nourishing and cherishing our flesh.

1. For this end hath God provided food, apparel, and all⁵⁸⁰ things needful for our weak bodies, that they should be nourished and cherished thereby: not to use them therefore, is to refuse Gods providence.
2. By well nourishing and cherishing our bodies, they are the better enabled to do that work and service which God appointeth to be done: but by neglecting them, they are disabled thereto. As this is a motive, so ought it to be an end whereat we aim in nourishing and cherishing our bodies.

§. 66. *Of them that neglect to cherish their bodies.*

Against this good instinct of nature do many offend.⁵⁸¹

1. *Covetous misers*, who so dote upon their wealth, and so⁵⁸² delight in abundance of goods treasured up, as they afford not themselves things needful to nourish and cherish their bodies. *Solomon* doth much tax such: of them he saith, that *riches are*⁵⁸³ *kept for the owners thereof to their hurt*. Daily experience giveth evidence to the truth thereof: for, beside that such men make their riches⁵⁸⁴ to be snares, and⁵⁸⁵

⁵⁷⁸ *John* 4. 34.

⁵⁷⁹ *2 Cor.* 12. 15.

⁵⁸⁰ 1. *Reason*.

⁵⁸¹ *Use*.

⁵⁸² 1. *Covetous misers*.

⁵⁸³ *Eccl.* 2. 23. & 5. 11, 12, 13, 14.

hinderances, to keep them from eternal life; they make this present life to be very irksome,⁵⁸⁶ filling their heads full of much carking care, and keeping them from quiet rest. Many in this case are so besotted,⁵⁸⁷ as, though they have abundance, yet they will not in health afford themselves a good meals meat, nor seemly apparel: nor in sickness, needful physic, no nor fire, and such like common things. Their case is worse then theirs who want: for others will pity and succour such as want, but who will pity and succour such?

2. Such as are *too intente* upon their businesses, even the affairs⁵⁸⁸ of their lawful callings (for in good things there may be excess) herein many Students, Preachers, Lawyers, Tradesmen, Farmers, Labourers, and others offend, when they afford not seasonable times of refreshing and resting to their bodies, but fast, watch, and toile too much in their calling. They who by such means disable themselves, do make themselves guilty of the neglect of so much good as they might have done, if they had nourished and cherished their bodies. Some are so eager on their business, that they think all the time mispent, which is spent in nourishing and cherishing their bodies; and thereupon wish, that their bodies needed no food, sleep, or other like means of refreshing. These thoughts and⁵⁸⁹ desires are foolish and sinful in many respects, as
 1. In manifesting a secret discontent and grudging against Gods providence, who hath thus disposed our estate for the clearer manifestation of mans weakness, & Gods care over him.
 2. In taking away occasions of calling upon God, and giving praise unto him. For if we stood not in such need of Gods providence, should we so oft pray unto him for his blessing: if by the good means which he affordeth unto us we felt not the sweetness and comfort of his providence, should we be so thankful to him?
 3. In taking away the means of mutual love: for if by reason of our weakness we stood not in need of succour and help one from another, what trial would there be of our love?

⁵⁸⁴1 *Tim.* 6. 9.

⁵⁸⁵*Mark.* 10. 23, *etc.*

⁵⁸⁶*Eccl.* 2. 23.

⁵⁸⁷*Semper eget liquidis, semper abundat aquis. Ouid. in Jbin.*

⁵⁸⁸2. They who are too intente on their calling.

⁵⁸⁹Unlawful to desire that our bodies needed no refreshing.

3. Such as sever these two duties of nature (*nourishing* and⁵⁹⁰ *cherishing*) and make them an hindrance one to another: some so *nourish* their bodies, as they cannot *cherish* them; that is, they spend so much in eating and drinking, as they have nothing to cloath themselves withal. Others so *cherish* them, as they cannot nourish them; that is, they so pranke up themselves with brave apparel above their ability, as they have not competent food for themselves. These fall into two contrary extremes: into the *excess* in one thing; and into the *defect* in another.

§. 67. *Of contentment in that which is sufficient.*

As the Apostle by naming these two (*nourish*, *cherish*) showeth that both of them are needful, so by naming them only, and no more but them, he showeth that they two are sufficient: whence we learn, that

*Having food and raiment, we must be therewith content.*⁵⁹¹

The Apostle in these very words laieth down this doctrine in⁵⁹² another place. The⁵⁹³ prayer of *Agur*, and the tenour of the⁵⁹⁴ fourth Petition prove as much.

Quest. Is a man then strictly bound to care for no more then food to nourish, and apparel to cherish him?

Answ. So this nourishing and cherishing be extended to that estate wherein God hath set us, to the charge which God hath given us, and to the calling which he hath appointed unto us, we ought to care for no more.

Let us therefore take heed of that excess which ariseth from the corruption of nature, and content our selves with that competency which nature requireth.

⁵⁹⁰ 3. They who make excess in one needful thing, an hindrance to another.

⁵⁹¹ Doct.

⁵⁹² 1 *Tim.* 6. 8.

⁵⁹³ *Prou.* 30. 8.

⁵⁹⁴ *Matth.* 6. 11.

Christ's Union with His Beloved Body

§. 68. *Of Christs forbearing to hate the Church.*

EPHES. 6. 29.

Even as the Lord the Church.

This confirmation of the pattern of a mans self by a like pattern of the Lord, hath relation to both the parts of the manifestation of a mans love to himself: both to the negative, and so it sheweth, that

The Lord hateth not his Church.

And to the affirmative, and so it sheweth, that

The Lord nourisheth and cherisheth his Church.

That difference which is made betwixt *Esau* a type of the world (*Esau have I hated*) and *Jacob* a type of the Church⁵⁹⁵ (*Jacob have I loved*) sheweth that the Lord is far from hating his Church. The world, not the Church, is the object of Gods hatred.

Object.

The⁵⁹⁶ Church her self, and the⁵⁹⁷ enemies thereof oft conceive by Christs dealing with her, that he hateth her.

Answ. It is the flesh abiding in them that are of the Church which maketh them so to conceive, not the spirit: and in the enemies of the Church the flesh altogether reigneth. But the things of God, and his mind

⁵⁹⁵*Mal.* 1. 2, 3.

⁵⁹⁶*Deut.* 1. 27.

⁵⁹⁷& 9. 28.

and affection, nor can, nor may be judged by carnal eyes, eyes of flesh. The⁵⁹⁸ Spirit of God accounteth such things evidences of Gods Jove, which flesh judgeth to be tokens of hatred; namely, corrections.

It is not, because there is no matter of hatred in the Church,⁵⁹⁹ that Christ hateth it not: for *by nature* all are of one and the same cursed stock,⁶⁰⁰ *children of wrath*: and after our sanctification is begun, the flesh abiding in us, we daily give much occasion of hatred if Christ should take that advantage against us which he might: but it is that near union which Christ hath made betwixt himself and the Church that keepeth him from hating her: he hath made her his Spouse, and he will not hate his Spouse: all the occasion of hatred that she giveth, he will either wipe away or cover.

Admirable is the comfort which every true member of the⁶⁰¹ Catholic Church may reap from hence: for so long as the wrath and hatred of the Lord is turned from us, nothing can make us miserable: we may in this respect rejoice not only in prosperity, but also in all manner of affliction. No calamity can move Christ to hate his Church, but rather the more to pitty it, as we do our bodies. Nay, though by sin he be provoked, and see it needful to correct his Church, yet in love, not in hatred, in mercy, not in wrath will he correct it.

What now if all the world have us? Seeing Christ hateth⁶⁰² us not, we need not fear nor care. The subject which is sure of his Kings favour, little regardeth the hatred of others. This therefore is to be thought of, both to comfort us under the cross, and to encourage us against the hatred of the world. That none may pervert this comfortable doctrine, let me add two caveats.

1. That men deceive not themselves with a naked name, thinking themselves to be *of* the Church, when they are only *in* it,⁶⁰³ such may Christ hate.
2. That being of the Church they wax not insolent, and too much provoke Christ to anger: for though he hate not such, yet in wisdom he may so

⁵⁹⁸ *Heb.* 12. 6.

⁵⁹⁹ Reason.

⁶⁰⁰ *Ephes.* 2. 3.

⁶⁰¹ 1. *Use.* Comfort.

⁶⁰² 2. *Use.* In couragement.

⁶⁰³ *Ier.* 12. 8.

severely correct them as if he hated them: and make them repent their folly and insolency again and again.

§. 69. *Of Christs nourishing and cherishing his Church.*

2. That *The Lord nourisheth and cherisheth his Church*, is evident by his continual providence over her in all ages. When first he created man, he⁶⁰⁴ provided before hand all things needful to nourish and cherish him. When he was moved to destroy the earth and all living things thereon, he had care of his Church, and provided an Ark to keep her out of⁶⁰⁵ the waters, and stored up in the Ark all things needful for her. When he purposed to bring a famine on the world, he sent a man before hand to lay up provision for his Church. When⁶⁰⁶ his Church was in a barren and dry wilderness, he gave them bread from heaven, water out of the rock, and kept their raiment from waxing old, and their feet from swelling. After this⁶⁰⁷ he brought his Church into a land flowing with milk and hony: and so long as it remained faithful he preserved it in that pleasant and plentiful land. Thus he dealt with the Church in her non-age: and thus also hath he dealt with her in her riper age under the Gospel, as experience of all ages may witness. Neither hath he only nourished and cherished her with temporal blessings, but also with all needful spiritual blessings: his word and Sacraments, his Spirit and the graces thereof hath he in all ages given her for that purpose: yea with his own flesh and blood hath he fed her, and with⁶⁰⁸ his own righteousness hath he clothed her.⁶⁰⁹

Learn we of whom we receive all needful things, both⁶¹⁰ spiritual and temporal, for soul and body, that accordingly⁶¹¹ we may give him the praise of all. And let us not be like the ungrateful Israelites who⁶¹² regarded

⁶⁰⁴ *Gen.* 1. 28, 29.

⁶⁰⁵ *Gen.* 6. 14. 21.

⁶⁰⁶ *Gen.* 45. 7. *Exo.* 16. 15. and 17. 6.

⁶⁰⁷ *Deut.* 8. 4.

⁶⁰⁸ *Ioh.* 6. 55.

⁶⁰⁹ *Isa.* 61. 10.

⁶¹⁰ 1. *Use.*

⁶¹¹ Ascribe all to Christ.

⁶¹² *Ezek.* 20. 11, 12.

not the means of spiritual⁶¹³ nourishment, and⁶¹⁴ ascribed the means of their temporal nourishing and cherishing to their Idols. In this respect the Prophet maketh them⁶¹⁵ worse then the ox, and the ass, two of the most brutish beasts that be. Oh take we heed that the like be not upbraided to us. The Lord hath not sparingly, but most liberally and bountifully nourished and cherished us in this land, and that both with temporal and spiritual blessings, so as he may justly say, *what could have been done*⁶¹⁶ *more in my vineyard, that I have not done in it?*

Learn we also to depend on Christ for all things that we⁶¹⁷ want: we need not fear penury: though we have not that⁶¹⁸ plenty which we could wish, yet we shall have sufficiency. Christ will not suffer his Church to famish for want of food, nor starve for want of cloathing, whether temporal for body, or spiritual for soul. He that can and will perform it hath said, *I will never leave thee nor forsake thee. Lazarus* was not⁶¹⁹ forsaken; witness the Angels that carried his soul into *Abraham's*⁶²⁰ bosom. If any of Christs Church do perish for want of outward means, it is because Christ by that means will advance them to that place where they shall stand in need of nothing: so as he doth not forsake them.

§. 70. *Of the union betwixt Christ and the Saints.*

EPHES. 5. 30.

For we are members of his body, of his flesh, and of his bones.

The reason of the forenamed love of Christ, and fruits⁶²¹ thereof to his Church, is here laid down, as both the causal particle (FOR) and the *inference* of this verse upon the former do show. This reason is that near union which is betwixt Christ and his Church, set forth by a metaphor of

⁶¹³Ose. 8. 12.

⁶¹⁴Ier. 44. 17. Ose. 2. 5, 8.

⁶¹⁵Isa. 1. 3.

⁶¹⁶Isa. 5. 4.

⁶¹⁷2 Use.

⁶¹⁸Depend on Christ for all things.

⁶¹⁹Heb. 13. 5.

⁶²⁰Luk. 16. 22.

⁶²¹Inference.

the members of our body. Whereby he implieth, that though there were no other reason to move an husband to love his wife then the near union which is betwixt them (they being⁶²² one body,⁶²³ one flesh,⁶²⁴ one self) that were enough, for thereby only is Christ moved to love his Church.

The mystery of our spiritual union with Christ is here laid down, and that as fully, and distinctly (though very succinctly)⁶²⁵ as in any place of Scripture. I will endeavour to open it as plainly as I can.

We are] The Apostle here changeth both person and number:⁶²⁶ for before he spake of the Church as of another in the third person, and of one in the singular number: but here he speaketh of the same in the first person including himself, and in the plural number, including all others like himself (*elect of God, and Saints by calling*) whereby he giveth us to understand what he meaneth by the *Church*, namely *the company of Saints*, to which, though he were a Preacher of the Gospel, an extraordinary Preacher, an Apostle, he associateth and joyneth himself: noting thereby that he was made partaker of the same grace, and saved by the same means that others were. Well might he in this privilege not think much to rank himself, because *it is the highest degree of honour that can be*⁶²⁷ *to be a member of the body of Christ*: much more then to be a Preacher, a Prophet, an Apostle, or of any other eminent calling.

The metaphor here used (*members of his body*) setteth⁶²⁸ forth the near union which is betwixt Christ and the Saints. Many other metaphors are used in Scripture for the same purpose, as⁶²⁹ *foundation* and *edifice*,⁶³⁰ *vine* and *branches*,⁶³¹ *husband* and *wife*, with the like, which are all of them very fit, but none more proper and pertinent to the point then this of a *body*, the *Head* and *members* thereof. What nearer union can there be then betwixt the head and members of the same body?

⁶²² *Vers.* 23.

⁶²³ *Vers.* 31.

⁶²⁴ *Vers.* 28.

⁶²⁵ *Sum*,

⁶²⁶ *Paul* ranketh himself among the members of Christ.

⁶²⁷ *Obser.*

⁶²⁸ Metaphors which set forth our union with Christ.

⁶²⁹ *1 Pet.* 2. 4, 5, 6.

⁶³⁰ *Ioh.* 15. 5.

⁶³¹ *2 Cor.* 11. 2.

If the Apostle had here staid, we might have thought that he had here meant no other thing then he meant⁶³² before, where he styled *Christ an head*, and the *Church a body*: but in that he addeth (*Of his flesh and of his bones*) he declareth yet a further mystery.

In the general there is a difference betwixt this phrase (*OF his body*) and these (*OF his flesh*; and *OF his bones*) the former is a note of the⁶³³ genitive case, the two latter are a⁶³⁴ praeposition: for distinction sake the two latter might have been translated, *out of his flesh*, *out of his bones*, or *from his flesh*, *from his bones* (for so a like phrase is translated⁶³⁵ before, *From whom*) but seeing these particles *out of*, or *from* are ambiguous, the former translation may stand as the best, so as a difference be made in the sense though there be none in the words.

The former (*members of his body*) declareth the union it self.

The latter (*of his flesh and of his bones*) declareth the *means*⁶³⁶ of making that union. This latter hath relation to that which *Adam* said of *Eve*, *This is now bone of my bones, and flesh of my flesh*, (Gen. 2. 23.) which is manifest by the next verse which the Apostle taketh out of the same place. It implieth then, that as *Eve* was made a woman out of *Adam's* flesh and bones, so the Church is made a Church out of Christs flesh and bones.

1. *Quest.* Was the very substance of the Saints, their flesh and bones taken out of Christ, as the substance of *Eve* was taken out of *Adam*?

Ans. Not so, if the words be literally taken. For so may Christ rather be said to be *of our flesh*, and *of our bones*, because he took our nature, and that from a daughter of *Adam*: in which respect he is said to be⁶³⁷ *of the seed of David*, and⁶³⁸ *of the Jews, as concerning the flesh*. Besides, the Apostle expressly saith (vers. 32.) that *This is a great mystery*. The mystery therefore must be searched out. For this end Christ must be considered as another *Adam* (and so the holy Ghost styleth him⁶³⁹ *The last Adam*,

⁶³²*Eph.* 1. 23. and 4. 16. and 5. 23.

⁶³³*Corporis*.

⁶³⁴*Ex.*

⁶³⁵*Eph.* 4. 16..

⁶³⁶How we are of Christs flesh.

⁶³⁷2 *Tim.* 2. 8..

⁶³⁸*Rom.* 9. 5..

⁶³⁹1 *Cor.* 15. 45, 47.

The second man) that is, a *stock*, a *root* that giveth a *being* to branches sprouting out of him.

2. Quest. What *being* is that which we receive from Christ?⁶⁴⁰

Answ. Not our *natural being* (that we have of the parents of our flesh) but a *supernatural*, and *spiritual being*, which the Scripture termeth⁶⁴¹ a *new birth*,⁶⁴² a *new man*,⁶⁴³ a *new creature*. This *spiritual being* is not in regard of the substance of our soul, or body, or of any of the powers or parts, faculties or members of them (for all these we have by lineal descent from *Adam*, and all these have all sorts of men, as well they who are not of the Church, as they who are of it) but in regard of the integrity, goodness, and divine qualities which are in them⁶⁴⁴ even that holiness and righteousness wherewith the Church is endued and adorned. As we are *natural* men we are *of Adam*, as we are *spiritual* men we are *of Christ*.

3. Quest. Why is mention made of *flesh* and *bones* in this⁶⁴⁵ ***spiritual being*?**

Answ. 1. In allusion to the creation of *Eve*, that by comparing this with that, *this* might be the better conceived.

2. In regard of the Lords Supper, where the *flesh* of Christ is mystically set before us to be spiritual food unto us. That as before (vers. 26.) he showed the mystery of one Sacrament, *Baptism*; here he might show the mystery of the other Sacrament, *The Lords Supper*.

3. In relation to Christs humane nature, by virtue whereof we come to be united unto Christ. For the divine nature of Christ is infinite, incomprehensible, incommunicable, and⁶⁴⁶ there is no manner of proportion betwixt it and us, so as we could not be united to it immediately. But Christ by taking his humane nature into the unity of his divine nature, made himself one with us, and us one with him: so as by his partaking of our mortality, we are made partakers of his immortality.

4. Quest. Are we then united only to his humane nature?

⁶⁴⁰What *being* we receive from Christ.

⁶⁴¹*Tit.* 3. 5.

⁶⁴²*Ephes.* 4. 24.

⁶⁴³2 *Cor.* 5. 17.

⁶⁴⁴2 *Pet.* 1. 4. *Ephes.* 4. 24.

⁶⁴⁵Why we are said to be of Christs flesh. *Gen.* 2. 23.

⁶⁴⁶*Diuinitas vnigeniti facta est particeps mortalitatis nostrae, vt & nos participes eius immortalitatis essemus. Aug. Epist.* 57.

Answ. No: we are united to his person, God-man. For as⁶⁴⁷ the divine nature, in and by it self, is incommunicable; so the humane nature singly considered, in and by it self, is unprofitable. The Deity is the fountain of all life and grace: the flesh quickneth not: but that spiritual life which originally and primarily floweth from the Deity, as from a fountain, is by the humanity of Christ, as by a conduit-pipe, conveyed into us.

5. Quest. How can we who are on earth, be united to his⁶⁴⁸ humane nature, which is contained in the highest heaven?

Answ. This union being supernatural and spiritual, there needeth no local presence for the making of it. That eternal Spirit which is in Christ is conveyed into every of the Saints (as the soul of a man is into every member and part of his body) by virtue whereof they are all made one with Christ, and with one another: *by one Spirit we are all baptized into one body*,⁶⁴⁹ which body is *Christ*.

This is to be noted against these two errors. The first is⁶⁵⁰ this, *We are united first to the divine nature of Christ which is every where, and by virtue thereof to his humane nature*.

Answ. 1. The Deity (as we showed) is immediately incommunicable: so as this cannot be.

2. Our union with Christ is spiritual, not physical or natural, so as this local presence needeth not.

The second error is this,

The humane nature of Christ hath all the divine properties in it,⁶⁵¹ so as it is every where present, and by reason thereof we are united unto Christ.

Answ. This also is impossible and needless. The properties of a true body cannot possibly admit the incommunicable properties of the Deity: that implieth direct contradiction, which is, that finite should be infinite. Needless also this is, because the union we speak of, is (as we said) spiritual.

6. Quest. What kind of union is this spiritual union?⁶⁵²

⁶⁴⁷We are united to Christs person.

⁶⁴⁸How Saints on earth are united to Christ in heaven.

⁶⁴⁹1 Cor. 12. 12, 13.

⁶⁵⁰I. Error.

⁶⁵¹II. Error.

⁶⁵²Our union with Christ a true and real union.

Answ. A true, real union of our persons (bodies and souls) with the person of Christ (God and man.) For as the holy Ghost did unite in the virgins womb the divine and humane natures of Christ, and made them one person, by reason whereof Christ is *of our flesh & of our bones*: so the spirit uniteth that person of Christ with our persons, by reason whereof we are *of his flesh, and of his bones*. A great difference there is betwixt the kinds of these unions: for the union of Christs two natures is hypostaticall and essential, they make one person: but the union of Christs person, and ours, is spiritual and mystical: they make one mystical body: yet is there no difference in the reality and truth of these unions: our union with Christ is never a whit the less real and true because it is mystical and spiritual: they who have the same spirit are as truly one, as those parts which have the same soul. The effects which proceed from this union do show the truth thereof: for that spirit which sanctified Christ in his mothers womb sanctifieth us also, that which quickened him quickeneth⁶⁵³ us, that which raised him from death, raiseth us, that which exalted him exalteth us. The many resemblances which the Scripture useth to set forth this union, do show the truth thereof: but most lively is it set forth by that resemblance which Christ maketh betwixt it and his union with his father. *I pray* (saith he of all his Saints) *That they may all*⁶⁵⁴ *be one, as thou father art in me, and I in thee, that they also may be one in us: that they may be one, as we are one*. This note of comparison (*as*) is not to be taken of the *kind*, but of the *truth* of these unions, our union with Christ is as true as Christs union with his father.

So true is this union, as not only Jesus himself, but all the⁶⁵⁵ Saints which are members of this body together with Jesus the head thereof are called CHRIST, 1 *Cor.* 12. 12. *Gal.* 3. 16.

This is to be noted against their conceit, who imagine this union to be only in imagination and conceit: or else only in consent of spirit, heart, and will: or at the most, in participation of spiritual graces.

7. Quest. What is the bond whereby this union is made:⁶⁵⁶ namely whereby Christ and the Saints are made one?

⁶⁵³*Rom.* 8. 11. *Eph.* 2. 6.

⁶⁵⁴*Ioh.* 17. 21, 22.

⁶⁵⁵*Unusquisque Christianus non incongruè sustinet personam Christi. Aug. de Gen. l. 2. c. 24. vide eundem quaest. 69.*

⁶⁵⁶With what bonds we are united to Christ. 1 *Joh.* 4. 13.

Answ. There is a double bond, one on Christs part, even the spirit of Christ (for *hereby know we that we dwell in him, and he in us, because he hath given us of his spirit*) another on the Saints part, even faith (*for Christ dwelleth in our hearts by faith*)⁶⁵⁷ The spirit is conveyed into us when we are dead in sins, wholly flesh, but being in us, it breedeth this blessed instrument of faith whereby we lay hold on Christ, and grow into him as the science into the stock. Thus Christ laying hold on us by his spirit, and we on him by faith, we come to be incorporated into him, and made one body, as the science and stock one tree.

8. Quest. To what end hath Christ thus truly and nearly⁶⁵⁸ united us unto himself?

Answ. Not for any benefit unto himself: but merely for the honour and good of the Church. By this union the honour of Christ is communicated to the Church, as the honour of an husband to his wife, and of an head to the body. Great also is the benefit which the Church reapeth thereby: for by this means is Christ made more fit to do good to the Church, as an head to the body, and the Church is made more capable of receiving good from Christ, as a body from the head, being knit to it by the soul, and by veins, sinews, nerves, arteries, and other like ligaments.

Thus having as plainly as I can by questions and answers laid open this great mystery, I will further note out some of those excellent privileges which by virtue thereof appertain to the Saints, and also some of the principal duties which in regard thereof the Saints are bound unto.

§. 71. Of the privileges appertaining to the Saints even in this life by reason of their union with Christ.

The privileges of the Saints which arise from their union with Christ respect this life, the time of death, and the life to come.

In this life these,

1. *A most glorious condition*, which is to be a part of Christ, a⁶⁵⁹ member of his body. All the glory of *Adam* in Paradise, or of the Angels in heaven is not comparable to this. In this respect the Saints are said to be

⁶⁵⁷*Eph.* 3. 17.

⁶⁵⁸Why Christ made the Saints one with himself.

⁶⁵⁹1. Saints are members of a glorious body.

crowned with glory and honour, and to have all things put under their feet. Compare *Psal.* 8. 4, 5. *etc.* with *Heb.* 2. 6, 7. *etc.* and ye shall find the Apostle apply that to Christ, which the Prophet spake indefinitely of man. Now those two places cannot be better reconciled, then by⁶⁶⁰ this union of Christ and Saints: for seeing both make one body, which is *Christ*, that which is spoken of the body may be applied to the head, and that which is spoken of the head may be applied to the body: for the same honour appertaineth to both. In which respect the Church is more honourable then Heaven, Angels, and every other creature.

2. *The attendance of good Angels, who are sent forth to minister*⁶⁶¹ *for them who shall be heirs of salvation*, because those heirs are of the body of Christ, who is their Lord. These are those *horses, and charrets of fire which were round about Elisha*.⁶⁶² which are also round about every of Gods Saints in all their distresses, though we see them no more then the servant of the man of God saw them, till the Lord opened his eyes. That *charge* which is given to the Angels over the son of God *to keep him in all his ways, and to bear him in their hands lest*⁶⁶³ *he dash his foot against a stone*, hath relation to this body which is *Christ*.
3. *An honour to make Christ himself perfect*: for as the several⁶⁶⁴ members make a natural body perfect, so the several Saints, this body which is *Christ*. In this respect the Church is said to be *the fulness of him that filleth all in all*.⁶⁶⁵ Christ filleth all things, and yet the Church maketh him full: which is to be understood of that voluntary condition whereunto Christ subjected himself, to be the head of a body: so as without the parts of the body he is imperfect, as a natural body is maimed and imperfect if it want but the least member thereof. How can we now think but that he will preserve and keep safe all his Saints? Will he restore to us all the parts of our natural body at the general resurrection, and will he lose any of the parts of his own mystical body?

⁶⁶⁰ *Coelo, & Angelis, & omni creatura honorabilior est ecclesia. Chrys. de Pentecost. serm. 26.*

⁶⁶¹ 2. Saints attended by Angels.

⁶⁶² *Heb.* 1. 14. 2 *King.* 6. 17.

⁶⁶³ *Psal.* 91. 11, 12.

⁶⁶⁴ 3. Saints make Christ perfect.

⁶⁶⁵ *Eph.* 1. 23.

4. *A kind of possession of heaven* while we are on earth: for⁶⁶⁶ that which the head hath a possession of, the body and several members have also a possession of. In this respect it is said, *he hath raised us up together, and made us sit together in*⁶⁶⁷ *heavenly places*. And, *he that believeth on him hath everlasting*⁶⁶⁸ *life: is passed from death unto life*. And, *he that hath the son,*⁶⁶⁹ *hath life*. This is somewhat more than hope: and serueth exceedingly to strengthen our hope, and give us assurance of that heavenly inheritance.

They know not the power of God, nor the virtue of this union, who deny that the Saints have assurance of salvation. For (to follow this metaphor a little) suppose a man were cast into a river, and his head able to lift and keep it self above water, would we not say, that man is safe enough, he is above water. This is the case of this mystical body: it being cast into the sea of this world, Christ the head thereof hath lift, and keeps himself aloft even in heaven. Is there now any fear, any possibility of the drowning of this body, or of any member thereof? If any should be drowned, then either Christ must be drowned, or else that member pulled from Christ; both which are impossible. Thus then by virtue of this union we see how on Christs safety, ours dependeth: if he be safe, so are we: if we perish, so must he.

In this respect *ye may be secure O flesh and blood: ye have*⁶⁷⁰ *got heaven in Christ: they who deny heaven to you, may also deny Christ to be in heaven*.

Learn here how to conceive of the resurrection, ascension and safety of Christ, even as of the resurrection, ascension and safety of an head, in and with whom his body and all his members are raised, exalted, and preserved.

5. *A most happy kind of regiment* under which the Saints are: even such an one as the members of an head are under. An head ruleth the body not as a cruel lord and tyrant, rigorously,⁶⁷¹ in humanely, basely, and

⁶⁶⁶4. Saints assured of salvation: and how.

⁶⁶⁷*Eph.* 2. 6.

⁶⁶⁸*Ioh.* 5. 24.

⁶⁶⁹1 *Ioh.* 5. 12.

⁶⁷⁰*Securi estote caro & sanguis: vsurpastis coelum in Christo: negent & in coelo Christum qui vobis coelum negant.* Tertul. de Resur.

⁶⁷¹5. Difference betwixt

slavishly, but meekely, gently,⁶⁷² with great compassion, and fellow-feeling. Even so doth Christ, his Church, binding up that which is broken, healing that which is maimed, directing that which wandreth, and quickening that which is dull; which privilege is so much the greater because it is proper to the Church. Though he have a golden scepter of grace and favour to hold out to his Church (as *Ahash-verosh* held out his to *Esther*) yet he hath also⁶⁷³ a *rod of iron to break* the men of this world, and to *dash them*⁶⁷⁴ in *peeeces like a potters vessel*. Though he be gone to prepare a place for his Saints, that where he is they may be also, yet will⁶⁷⁵ he *make his enemies his footstool*.⁶⁷⁶

6. *An assurance of sufficient supply of all needful things* which⁶⁷⁷ the Saints want, and of safe protection from all things hurtful. For by reason of this union, Christ our head hath a sense of our want and of our smart. On this ground he said to them which fed and visited his members, *Ye fed me, ye visited me*: and again,⁶⁷⁸ to *Saul* that persecuted his members, *Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me?*

Object. How is it then, that the Saints want many things,⁶⁷⁹ and oft suffer much smart, and hurt?

Answ. Christ in his wisdom seeth it behoveful that they should want, and feel smart (and that we are to be persuaded of) or else he would not suffer them to want or feel that which they do. Wherefore in all need, in every distress and danger, let us lift up our head to this *our head*.

7. *A right to all that Adam lost.* For Christ is the *heir of all*, (*the*⁶⁸⁰ *earth is the Lords, and the fulness thereof*) yea as mediator and head of the Church is he heir of all: his body therefore hath a right to all. On this ground the Apostle saith, *All things are*⁶⁸¹ *yours*. So as the Saints & only the Saints can with good conscience⁶⁸² use the things of this

⁶⁷² Christ governing the Saints and the world.

⁶⁷³ *Est.* 5. 2.

⁶⁷⁴ *Psal.* 2. 9.

⁶⁷⁵ *Ioh.* 14 3.

⁶⁷⁶ *Psal.* 110. 1.

⁶⁷⁷ 6. Assurance of all needful supply.

⁶⁷⁸ *Mat.* 25. 35. *Act.* 9. 4.

⁶⁷⁹ Why Christ suffereth the Saints to want, and suffer.

⁶⁸⁰ 7. Saints have a right to what *Adam* lost.

⁶⁸¹ *Heb.* 1. 2.

⁶⁸² *Psal.* 24 1.

world. They who are not of this⁶⁸³ body (what right and title soever they have before men) are but usurpers of the things they enjoy and use. They are like to bankrupts, who being not worth one penny, deceitfully borrow of others, and therewith keep a great table, deck and furnish their houses very sumptuously, put themselves, wives and children, into brave apparel, are frolic and riotous: what is like to be the end of such?

8. *A right to more than Adam ever had:* namely, to Christ⁶⁸⁴ himself, and to all that appertaineth unto him: as to the purity of his nature, to the perfection of his obedience, the merit of his blood, the power of his death, the virtue of his resurrection, the efficacy of his ascension, all is ours: even as the understanding, wit, judgment, sight, hearing, and all that is in the head, is the bodies: if the Church it self were of it self as pure in nature, as perfect in righteousness, as powerful over death, and devil, and grave, and hell, as able to rise from death, and to ascend into heaven, as Christ, it could receive no greater benefit thereby, then it doth by them in the person of Christ: so truly and properly is Christ himself, and all things appertaining to him, the Churches. What can more be said? What can more be desired? O blessed union! Blessed are they that have a part therein!

Quest. How is it then that the Church is so basely and miserably⁶⁸⁵ respected in the world?

Ans. The world knoweth us not, because it knoweth not Christ. It knoweth not Christ the head of this body: it knoweth not the body which is Christ. Let not us who know both head and body, the near union which is betwixt them, and the privileges which follow thereupon, be danted, neither with the scoffs or scorns of the world, nor with our own outward weaknesses, wants, and calamities. What would he that hath Christ, have more?

§. 72. Of the privilege of our union with Christ in the time of death.

⁶⁸³ 1 Cor. 3. 21.

⁶⁸⁴8. Saints have a right to Christ. See §. 28

⁶⁸⁵ Why the Church basely accounted of. 1 Ioh. 3. 1.

The privilege which the Saints receive by their union with Christ in the time of death (even all that time that passeth from the departure of the Saints out of this world unto the general Resurrection) is admirable: for when body and soul are severed one from another, neither soul nor body are separated from Christ, but both remain united to him: even as, when Christs body and soul were by death severed one from another, neither his soul, nor his body were separated from the Deity, but both remained united thereunto. This inviolable bond that holdeth the Saints, (yea, even their very bodies as well as their souls) united to Christ in death, is the benefit of a spiritual union. If our union with Christ were corporeal, it could not be so.

Ob. Is it possible that the body which is dead should remain⁶⁸⁶ united to Christ, when as it receiveth no virtue from him?

Ans. 1. If a member of a natural body may do so, why not a member of the mystical body? That a member of a natural body may do so, is evident by those who have an hand, arm, foot, leg, or any other member taken, with a dead palsy: they are sometimes so taken, as those parts receive no manner of sense, or any vigor, or life from head or heart at all: and yet remain true members of that body.

2. The very dead bodies consumed with worms or otherwise, do receive a great present benefit from their union with Christ: for by virtue thereof there is a substance preserved, and they are kept from destruction: there is nothing destroyed in the Saints by death, but that which if it were not destroyed, would make them most miserable, namely sin: that is utterly, totally, finally destroyed in them, and all the concomitances thereof, which are all manner of infirmities: but the rotting of the body, is but as the rotting of corn in the earth,⁶⁸⁷ that it may arise a more glorious body. The metaphor of *sleep*,⁶⁸⁸ attributed to the Saints when they die, sheweth that their bodies are not utterly destroyed.

Object. The bodies of all men, even of those that are not⁶⁸⁹ of this union, are preserved from utter destruction. This therefore is no benefit of our union with Christ.

⁶⁸⁶Corruption of the body no hindrance to our union with Christ.

⁶⁸⁷1 Cor. 15. 36.

⁶⁸⁸1 Thes 4. 13.

⁶⁸⁹Difference betwixt the preservation of the Saints bodies and others in the grave.

Answ. Though in the general thing it self, which is a preservation of the substance of the body, the same thing befalleth the Saints and the wicked: yet the means whereby both are preserved, and the end why they are preserved is far different.

1. The Saints are preserved by a secret influence proceeding⁶⁹⁰ from Christ, as an head: in which respect they are said to *sleep in Jesus*, and to be *dead in Christ*. But the wicked are reserved by an Almighty power of Christ, as a terrible Lord and severe Judge.
2. The bodies of the Saints are preserved to enjoy eternal glory together with their souls: but the bodies of the wicked are reserved to be tormented in hell.

In regard of these differences, the grave is as a bed to the Saints,⁶⁹¹ for them quietly to sleep therein free from all disturbance till the day of resurrection: but it is a prison to the wicked to hold them fast against the great Day of Assise, that at Dooms day they may be brought to appear at the barre of Gods judgment seat, and there receive the sentence of condemnation.

§. 73. *Of the privilege of our union with Christ after death.*

The privilege which the Saints by virtue of their union with Christ receive after death, far surpasseth all before. It may be drawn to two heads.

- 1. Their Resurrection.
- 2. Their glory in heaven.

That which was before said of the difference betwixt the preservation of the bodies of the Saints and wicked in death, may be applied to the difference of their Resurrection.

Resurrection simply in it self is not the privilege of the Saints, but *Resurrection of life*: to the wicked appertaineth the⁶⁹² *Resurrection of condemnation*. The benefit of Resurrection ariseth from the glory which followeth thereupon in heaven. That glory hath the Apostle excellently set

⁶⁹⁰ 1 *Thes.* 4. 14, 16.

⁶⁹¹ *Isa.* 57. 2.

⁶⁹² *Ioh.* 5. 29.

forth⁶⁹³ before vers. 27.

§. 74. *Of the duties which are required of the Saints by virtue of their union with Christ.*

The mystery of our union with Christ, as it is a matter of great comfort, and encouragement (which ariseth from the forenamed privileges) so also is it a matter of direction and instigation unto us for the performing of sundry duties, whereof they who desire assurance of the forenamed privileges, and comfort by them, must be careful and conscionable. Some of the most principal of those duties are these.

1. *Confidence* in Christ. Christ being our head, so mighty,⁶⁹⁴ so wise, so tender, every way so sufficient an head as he is, we should highly dishonour him, if we should not wholly and only repose our selves upon him for every good thing, and against every evil.
2. *Subjection* answerable to his manner of governing us.⁶⁹⁵ The world is subject to Christ perforce, as he is an absolute and Almighty Lord: but he governing us as an head, we must be subject unto him as members, willingly, and readily. What member will rise up, and rebel against the head? Yea, what member is not as ready to obey, as the head to command?⁶⁹⁶
3. *A cleansing* of our selves from all filthiness of flesh and⁶⁹⁷ spirit. *Shall we defile the members of Christ?* The sins of the⁶⁹⁸ Saints are in this respect the more heinous because that body, even *Christ*, whereof they are members, is defiled thereby. Wherefore in regard of Christ the head, of other Saints their fellow members, and of themselves, must all that profess themselves to be of this body be watchful over themselves, and cleanse themselves from all filthiness. Otherwise they give just occasion to think that they are no members of this body. If a Lions foot, or Bears paw were held out, and said to be the member of a man,

⁶⁹³ §. 49, 50. etc.

⁶⁹⁴ Heb. 3. 6.

⁶⁹⁵ Mat. 6. 10. *Christus habet sanctos voluntate, peccatores verò necessitate sibi subiectos.*

⁶⁹⁶ Hier. in Eph. 1.

⁶⁹⁷ 2 Cor. 7. 1.

⁶⁹⁸ 1 Cor. 6. 15.

would any believe it? Can we then think that worldlings, drunkards, profane, riotous, unclean persons, and such like limbs of the Devil, are members of Christ?

4. A *conformity* unto the image of Christ in true holiness⁶⁹⁹ and righteousness. It is not therefore sufficient for the members of Christ to abstain from polluting themselves, for they are *created in Christ Jesus unto good works. He that abideth in*⁷⁰⁰ *me* (saith Christ) *and I in him, the same bringeth forth much fruit.*⁷⁰¹
5. *Heavenly affections. If ye be risen with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ sitteth on the right hand of*⁷⁰² *God. Set your affections on things above, and not on things on the earth.* Where our head is, there also ought our heart to be. Earthly affections come not from that head which is in heaven: nor from that Spirit which proceedeth from him. *They*⁷⁰³ *who are after the spirit mind the things of the spirit.*
6. *Courage against death:* seeing that in death we are Christs, what cause have we to fear death? *Be not afraid of*⁷⁰⁴ *them that kill the body, and after that, have no more that they can do.* The ancient worthies would not accept deliverance, *that*⁷⁰⁵ *they might obtain a better resurrection.* Hitherto of the union it self. The means of effecting it, remain to be handled.

§ 75. *Of their regeneration who are members of Christ.*

EPHES. 5. 30.

—*Of his flesh, and of his bones.*

This clause declareth the means whereby we come to be members of Christ, namely by receiving a new *being* from Christ, which is to be, not of the flesh, and of the bones of *Adam*, but of the flesh and of the bones of

⁶⁹⁹*Ephes.* 4. 24.

⁷⁰⁰*Ephes.* 210.

⁷⁰¹*Ioh.* 15. 5.

⁷⁰²*Col.* 3. 1, 2.

⁷⁰³*Rom.* 8. 5.

⁷⁰⁴*Luke* 12. 4.

⁷⁰⁵*Heb.* 11. 35.

Christ, which being spiritually taken, as hath been expounded⁷⁰⁶ before, sheweth that

*They who are true members of Christ body, are truly regenerate.*⁷⁰⁷ *If any be in Christ he is a new creature:* these words are so⁷⁰⁸ laid down by the Apostle, as they serve both for a demonstration, and an exhortation (*he is*, or *let him be a new creature*) neither is expressed, but either, or both may be understood. *As many of you as have been baptized into Christ* (that is, made⁷⁰⁹ members of this body) *have put on Christ*, (that is, have been borne again) the first branch noteth out our incorporation into Christ, the latter our regeneration.

This second man, and last *Adam* Christ Jesus is a quickening⁷¹⁰ spirit: he diffuseth life and grace into all his members: if his⁷¹¹ spirit be in us, it will quicken our mortal bodies. If the head of our natural bodies conueigh sense into all our members: if the root of a tree diffuse sap into all the branches: shall not Christ much more give life to all his members?

This then is a matter of trial, whereby we may prove whether⁷¹² indeed we are of this body or no, and so have a true right⁷¹³ to the forenamed privileges. Many boast of this honour that they are members of Christs body, and yet are not *of his flesh and of his bones*: they have no other being, then what they received from their parents. These vain professors are like wooden legs, or arms on a man, which may be covered over with hose and sleeves for a time, but shall not be raised at the resurrection with the other parts of the mans body: so neither shall those professors be raised to glory with Christ, though they may be covered over with the hose and sleeves of profession, and thereby seem to be members.

§. 76. Of the author of our regeneration Christ.

This relative particle (HIS) twice repeated (*of HIS flesh, and of HIS bones*) sheweth that

⁷⁰⁶ §. 70.

⁷⁰⁷ Doct.

⁷⁰⁸ 2 Cor. 5. 17..

⁷⁰⁹ Gal. 3. 27.

⁷¹⁰ Reason.

⁷¹¹ 1 Cor. 15. 45. Rom. 8. 11.

⁷¹² Use.

⁷¹³ Trial whether we be members of Christ.

*Regeneration is of Christ.*⁷¹⁴ *The son quickneth whom he will.*⁷¹⁵

Object. This work is attributed in Scripture to the⁷¹⁶ father, to the⁷¹⁷ Spirit, to the⁷¹⁸ word, and to the⁷¹⁹ Ministers of the word.

Answ. Christ may very well stand with all these. The three persons in Trinity are all one: One in nature and essence:⁷²⁰ One in will and consent: One in virtue and power: what the one doth the other doth also. Yet because there is a difference in their manner of working, this work (as other works) is distinctly attributed to each of them.

The father is (as I may so speak) the beginner of this work. His will it was that his son should be the head of a body, and that there should members be made fit for that head, and have a new being (*of his own will begat he us*) for⁷²¹ this end he sent his son into the world to be made flesh. The son put in execution the will of his father: he took flesh upon him, that we might be *of his flesh*. Thus saith Christ of himself, *I came down from heaven to do the will of him that*⁷²² *sent me; And this is the fathers will which hath sent me, that of all which he hath given me I should lose nothing, but should raise it up again at the last day.* The Spirit applieth unto us the virtue and efficacy of the flesh of Christ, and so finisheth this blessed work. *It is the Spirit that quickneth: the flesh profiteth nothing,*⁷²³ namely, of it self without the Spirit.

Thus we see that the applying of this work of regeneration unto Christ, excludeth not the work of the father, or of the Holy Ghost therein, but excludeth the work of man: so as it is not of our selves, nor of our parents, nor of any other man: for we are borne *not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God:* in which respect our new birth⁷²⁴ is said to be *from above*.

⁷¹⁴ *Ioh.* 5. 21.

⁷¹⁵ *Doctr.*

⁷¹⁶ *1 Pet.* 1. 3.

⁷¹⁷ *Ioh.* 3. 5.

⁷¹⁸ *Iam.* 1. 18.

⁷¹⁹ *1 Cor.* 4. 15.

⁷²⁰ *Philem.* vers. 10. The work of the three persons in our regeneration.

⁷²¹ *Iam.* 1. 18.

⁷²² *Joh.* 6. 38, 39.

⁷²³ *Ioh.* 6. 63.

⁷²⁴ *Ioh.* 1. 13.

Object. How is it then attributed to the word, and to the⁷²⁵ ministry of man?⁷²⁶

Answ. As unto instruments which the Lord is pleased to use: Of the word it is said, *God hath begotten us with the word: of himself a Minister thus saith the Apostle, In Christ Jesus I have begotten you: so as God and Christ are joined*⁷²⁷ with these instruments, or else they are no whit powerful and⁷²⁸ effectual for so great a work: for *neither is he that planteth any*⁷²⁹ *thing, nor he that watreth: but God that giveth the increase.*

The work of regeneration is a new creation, a divine⁷³⁰ work, above humane strain. It must therefore be wrought by the Lord, or it cannot be wrought at all.

This is to be noted both of those that have not yet assurance⁷³¹ of this blessed work wrought in them: and also of those who have assurance thereof.

The *former* may here learn whither to have recourse for it: namely, to him who came down from heaven for that purpose, and who saith, *Him that cometh unto me I will in no wise*⁷³² *cast out.* In all the means that we use, let us look up unto him, and seek a blessing of him.

The *latter* must with the tenth leper return back unto⁷³³ Christ, and glorify God. Whatsoever the means were, or whosoever the Minister was, the praise and glory of all must be given to him.

§. 77. Of the matter of our regeneration, Christ.

The preposition (OF) twice set down (OF *his flesh, and OF his bones*) being a proper note of the material cause, sheweth that

Christ is not only the author, but the matter also of our new birth. The new spiritual being which the Saints have, cometh out of him.⁷³⁴ *From*

⁷²⁵ *Ioh. 3. 3.*

⁷²⁶ How regeneration is attributed to the word, and to Ministers thereof.

⁷²⁷ *Iam. 1. 18.*

⁷²⁸ *1 Cor. 4. 15.*

⁷²⁹ *1 Cor. 3. 7.*

⁷³⁰ Reason.

⁷³¹ Use.

⁷³² *Ioh. 6. 37.*

⁷³³ *Luke 17. 16.*

⁷³⁴ *Col. 2. 19..*

him all the body having nourishment increaseth with the increase of God. In this respect we are said to be⁷³⁵ blessed with all spiritual blessings in Christ. The metaphor of a⁷³⁶ vine, which Christ taketh unto himself, proveth also as much: so do these phrases,⁷³⁷ *My flesh is meat indeed, my blood is drink indeed.*

This Christ cometh to be by his incarnation. God in himself is as a bottomless and a closed fountain: from him⁷³⁸ immediately we can receive nothing. But Christ made flesh is⁷³⁹ a fountain opened:⁷⁴⁰ *In him all fulness dwelleth.*⁷⁴¹ *And of him have all we received, even grace for grace.*

Behold here the benefit of Christs incarnation: by his taking⁷⁴² part of our mortal flesh, are we made partakers of his spiritual flesh, namely, of that spiritual life and grace which cometh from him, who was made flesh, to convey the same into us. To strengthen our faith the more firmly herein, the Lord hath instituted the holy Communion of his body and blood. With what conscience, reverence, and confidence, ought this blessed Sacrament to be celebrated?

By this Doctrine we may further learn how to seek every⁷⁴³ thing at Gods hands which we desire to obtain, and how to offer that sacrifice of praise unto God, which we would have⁷⁴⁴ to be accepted; namely in and through Jesus Christ, by whom⁷⁴⁵ only we have all that communion which we have with God.⁷⁴⁶ Well therefore doth the Church conclude all her forms of Prayers and Praises with this, or such a like clause, *through Jesus Christ our Lord.*

§. 78. Of the excellency of Regeneration.

⁷³⁵ *Ephes. 1. 3.*

⁷³⁶ *Joh 15. 5.*

⁷³⁷ *Ioh. 6. 55.*

⁷³⁸ Reason.

⁷³⁹ *Zach. 13. 1.*

⁷⁴⁰ *Col. 1. 19.*

⁷⁴¹ *Ioh. 1. 16.*

⁷⁴² 1 Use:

⁷⁴³ 2. Use.

⁷⁴⁴ *Ioh. 16. 23.*

⁷⁴⁵ *Heb. 13. 15.*

⁷⁴⁶ *Col. 3. 17.*

The particular matter of our regeneration (the *flesh* and *bones* of Christ) here expressed, showeth that

Regeneration is a most excellent work. The excellency hereof⁷⁴⁷ will the better appear, if we compare it with the great and glorious work of our creation, and show how far it surpasseth it: wherein I will hold close to this metaphor, and touch⁷⁴⁸ no other differences then it doth point out unto us.

1. In our creation Christ was only a *worker*: but he is the very *matter* of our Regeneration, we are *of his flesh*.

2. The relation that then was betwixt Christ and man, was

1. *Creator*

2. *Creature*

but here

1. *Head*

2. *Body*

We are members of his body.

The bond is now much nearer.

3. The *being* which then we had, was from *Adam*: But the *being* which now we have is from Christ, *of HIS flesh*.

4. That being was but *natural*. This is *spiritual*: for *that*⁷⁴⁹ which is borne *of the Spirit, is Spirit*.

5. Then our being was different from Christs: but now it is the very same with Christs, *Of his flesh*.

6. Then might man clean fall from that estate wherein he was created (as he did) and yet Christ remain as he was. Now it cannot be so. For if any of the Saints now fall away, either Christ must fall with them, or they must be pulled from Christ, and so Christ remain a maimed body. Behold the riches of Gods mercy. One might think it⁷⁵⁰ sufficient, and more then man could ever have been thankful enough for, that God at first created man after his own image in a most happy estate. From which when we wittingly and wilfully fell, God might justly have left us, as he

⁷⁴⁷Doctr.

⁷⁴⁸Difference betwixt regeneration and creation.

⁷⁴⁹*Ioh.* 3. 6.

⁷⁵⁰The riches of Gods mercy.

did the evil Angels. But he hath not only restored us again to that former estate, but advanced us to a far more excellent and glorious estate: wherein his goodness appeareth to be as his greatness, infinite, incomprehensible. Who can sufficiently set it forth? *For as the heaven is high above the earth, so great⁷⁵¹ is his mercy toward them that fear him.*

⁷⁵¹*Psal.* 103. 11.

The Ancient Law and Unique Bond of Marriage

§. 79. *Of the ancient Law of marriage.*

EPHES. 5. 31.

For this cause shall a man leave his father and mother, and shall be joined unto his wife: and they two shall be one flesh.

The same points which were before laid down, concerning the near union of man and wife, and of Christ and the Church, are here further confirmed by the ancient law of marriage: which the Apostle doth the rather mention, because it followeth upon that text, whereunto he alluded in the former verse. For when *Moses* had alleged these words of *Adam* concerning *Eve*, *This is bone of my bones, and flesh of my flesh*, he⁷⁵² addeth this law, *Therefore shall a man leave his father*, etc. In this place these words have both a *literal* and a *mystical* sense. A *literal* of man and wife. A *mystical* of Christ and the Church. The main thing which the Apostle aimeth at, is to⁷⁵³ show how nearly man and wife are linked together: that thereby they may the rather be moved to perform those mutual and several duties which they owe each to other. But because he propounded to husbands and wives the examples of Christ and the Church, as patterns and motives to them, to do their duty, he applieth that which was first spoken of man and wife, unto Christ and his Church, to show that there being so fit a resemblance betwixt these two couples, the pattern propounded is the more pertinent to the purpose, and the reason enforced from thence the more forcible.

Because the opening of the literal sense will give great light to the mystery, I will first handle this text according to the meaning of the letter.

⁷⁵²Gen. 2. 23, 24.

⁷⁵³Inference.

The first clause (*for this cause*) implieth a necessary connection with that which went before. The near union of man and wife, as well as of Christ and his Church, was before noted. A wife was said to be as the⁷⁵⁴ *body* of a man, yea as⁷⁵⁵ *himself*. Adam called her his *flesh and bones*. Hereupon both *Moses* and *Paul* infer, *Therefore*, or, *For this cause shall a man leave father*. Because man and wife are so near by Gods institution, they must also be most dear each to other in their mutual affection.

The *man* (meaning an husband) is here in particular mentioned,⁷⁵⁶ because at the first making of this Law the woman was brought to him to see how he would like her: and having cast his affection on her, he was to be bound hereby to continue that good liking towards her: as also because of the prehemineny which man hath above his wife. Yet is not the man only tied hereby, but the wife also: the nature and rule of relation requireth as much: if a man must inseparably cleave to his wife, the wife must answerably cleave to her husband.

These words (*shall leave father and mother*) are neither *generally* to be taken of all duties, as if no duty were to be performed to parents by children after they are married: nor *simply*, as if indeed parents were utterly to be forsaken: but they are meant,

1. Of that *daily service* which children under their parents government perform unto them, seeking to please them in all things. When children are married, then their daily attendance must be upon their wives, or husbands, taking care how⁷⁵⁷ to please them.
2. Of *erecting a new family*: for which end their parents house must be left, and the husband and wife must dwell each with other.
3. Of the *difference to be put betwixt parents, and wife or husband*. So as if by any inevitable occasion it should so fall out, that a man must leave his parent, or his wife (as in case parent and wife were both giving up the Ghost, and in places so far remote, as the husband could not possibly be with both, yet both instantly desired his company) by this Law he must leave his parent, and cleave to his wife.

⁷⁵⁴Vers. 28. *Gen.* 2. 23.

⁷⁵⁵Vers. 28. *Gen.* 2. 23.

⁷⁵⁶Meaning of the words.

⁷⁵⁷1 *Cor.* 7. 33, 34.

Hereby then the bond of marriage is declared to be the most inviolable bond that can be. For all men know, that the bond betwixt parent and child is a firm and inviolable bond: but the bond betwixt husband and wife is more firm and inviolable.

To set forth the firmness of the marriage bond he addeth this Emphacical phrase, *shall be joined*, (or as the word properly, cording to the natural notation thereof signifieth, *shall be glued*)⁷⁵⁸ to his wife. Things well glued together are as fast, firm, and close as if they were one entire peece. Yea we observe by experience that a table will oft times cleave in the whole wood, before it will part asunder where it is glued: so as an husband ought to be as firm to his wife as to himself: and she to him.

Fitly doth this agree with that which followeth (*they two shall be one flesh*) Our English cannot well express the Greek in good sense word for word (which is thus, *they two shall be into*, or *in one flesh*) the meaning is, They which were two before marriage, by the bond of marriage are brought into one flesh, to be even as one flesh: as nearly united, as the parts of the same body, and the same flesh. This unity is not in regard of carnal copulation (for if they be married they are *one flesh*,⁷⁵⁹ though they never know one another) nor in regard of procreation, because one child cometh from them both (for though they never have child, yet are they one flesh) but in regard of Gods institution, who hath set it down for a law, and as another nature, that man and wife should be so near one to another. Their consent in marriage (by virtue of Gods institution) maketh them to be *one flesh*.

Well doth our English note the emphasis of the original in this particle THEY (*they two*) which sheweth that the bond of marriage kniteth only two together: one man, and one woman, and no more.

This Law setteth forth the *Union betwixt man and wife*.⁷⁶⁰

Therein three things are noted concerning the state of marriage.

1. The praeeminency of it (*a man shall leave father and mother.*)
2. The firmness of it (*and be joined to his wife.*)
3. The nearness of it (*they two shall be one flesh.*)

⁷⁵⁸Glue.

⁷⁵⁹*Matrimonium non facit coitus, sed voluntas. Chrysost. in Mat. hom. 32.*

⁷⁶⁰Sum.

§. 80. *Of preferring husband or wife before parents.*

The first point sheweth, that

A wife, or an husband must be preferred before parents. The⁷⁶¹ examples of⁷⁶² *Leah* and *Rachel*, yea and of⁷⁶³ *Micol*, are commendable in this respect.

1. The bond of marriage is more ancient, more firm, more⁷⁶⁴ near. There was husband and wife before there was parent and child: and there is a time when parents & children may depart one from another, and that while both live: but no time, wherein man and wife may part asunder till death part them. And children though they come from the flesh of their parents, yet are made two (so as *of one are two*) but husbands and wives though they were two before, yet are made one (so as *of two is one*.)

What wrong then do such parents unto their children, as⁷⁶⁵ keep them, even after they are married, so strait under subjection,⁷⁶⁶ as they cannot freely perform such duty as they ought to their husband, or their wife? This is more then a parents authority reacheth unto. Yet many think that their children owe as much service to them after they are married as before: which is directly against this law.

Greater is the wrong, and more sinful is the practise of⁷⁶⁷ such as keep their children from their husbands, or from their wives. The match (say they) falleth out much worse then we looked for. But this should have been looked to more carefully before hand. After marriage it is too late to seek such a redress.

On the other side, there be many children who so respect⁷⁶⁸ their parents, as they neglect their husband or their wife. Some husbands will

⁷⁶¹Doct.

⁷⁶²*Gen.* 31. 14.

⁷⁶³1 *Sam.* 19. 11

⁷⁶⁴Reason.

⁷⁶⁵Use.

⁷⁶⁶Parents may not keep their children being married too straight.

⁷⁶⁷Nor keep them from husband or wife.

⁷⁶⁸Children may not prefer their parents before husband or wife. *Apud Romanos sponsa oblecta flammeo capite quum extulisset pedem è paternis aedibus, vertebatur in gyrum, itaque ducebatur in domum sponsi, nesciret redeundi viam ad aedes parentum.* *Erasm.*

bestow what they can on their parents, and keep their wives very bare, suffering them to want necessities; not caring how they vex and grieve them so they please their parents. Some wives also will privily purloin from their husbands to bestow on their parents.

Others can never tarry out of their parents houses, but as oft as they can, go thither. The ancient Romans, to show how unmeet this was, had a custom to cover the brides face with a yellow veil, and so soon as she was out of her fathers house to turn her about and about, and so to carry her to the house of her husband, that she might not know the way to her fathers house again. All those pretenses of love to parents are more preposterous then pious: and natural affection beareth more sway in such, then true religion. Their pretence of piety to parents is no rust excuse for that injury they do to husband and wife.

§. 81. *Of the firmness of the matrimonial bond.*

The second point concerning the firmness of the marriage knot in these words (*shall be joined to his wife*) affordeth two doctrines.

1. *Man and wife must associate themselves together by continual⁷⁶⁹ cohabitation:* for this end they leave their parents family, and erect a new family.
2. *Man and wife are joined together by an inviolable bond.* It⁷⁷⁰ must never be cut asunder till death cut it. Body and soul must be severed one from another before husband and wife.

Be careful therefore to preserve this indissoluble knot: and so live together, as with comfort you may live together, because you may not part.

§. 82. *Of two only to be joined together in marriage.*

The third point concerning the nearness of man and wife, in these words (*they two shall be one flesh*) affordeth two other doctrines.

1. *Marriage can be but betwixt two*, one man, and one woman: for it is impossible that more then two should so nearly, and firmly be joined together, as man and wife are. Every word almost in this law proveth

⁷⁶⁹See *Treat. 2. part. 2. §. 14.*

⁷⁷⁰See *Treat. 2. part. 2 §. 2.*

this doctrine. For it saith *a man*, not men: to *a wife*, not to wives: to *his* wife, not to anothers wife: *two*, not more then two: *they* two, not any two: *one flesh*, not many fleshes.

Object. This particle (*two*) is not in the law as *Moses* recordeth⁷⁷¹ it.

Answ. It is there necessarily implied, for at that time there were but two in the world: God then speaking of them, meaneth but two. The same spirit that guided *Moses*, guided also the⁷⁷² Evangelists, and the⁷⁷³ Apostles: so as by their inserting of this particle (*two*) it is certain that it was intended by *Moses*: as the particle (*only*) which Christ putteth into this text,⁷⁷⁴ *him only shalt thou serve*.

Quest. Why did God at first make but one man, and one woman?

Answ. The⁷⁷⁵ Prophet answereth, *that he might seek a godly seed*.

If therefore there be more then two, it is an adulterous seed which proceedeth from thence.

§. 83. Of Polygamy and Bigamy.

Can Polygamy (the having of many wives) or Bigamy (the having of two wives at once) have any good warrant against such an express law? Are not both of them against the first institution of marriage, so as we may say,⁷⁷⁶ *from the beginning it was not so*? Yea also and against⁷⁷⁷ other particular lawes?⁷⁷⁸ *Lamech* one of *Cains* cursed stock was the first that we read of to have presumed against that ancient law.

Object. Afterwards many Patriarkes, and other Saints took that liberty unto themselves.

Answ. It was their sin, and a great blemish in them. The common error of the time, & their unsatiabie desire of increase made them fall into it. Many inconveniences followed thereupon: neither can it be thought but

⁷⁷¹ *Gen.* 2. 24.

⁷⁷² *Mat.* 19. 5.

⁷⁷³ *1 Cor.* 6. 16.

⁷⁷⁴ *Deut.* 6. 13. *Mat.* 4. 10.

⁷⁷⁵ *Mal.* 2. 15.

⁷⁷⁶ *Mat.* 19. 8.

⁷⁷⁷ *Deut.* 17. 17. *Leu.* 18. 18.

⁷⁷⁸ *Gen.* 4. 19. *Magis pertinere ad nuptiarum bonum, non vnum & multas, sed vnum & vnam, satis indicat ipsa prima diuinitus facta coniugum copula, etc. Aug. de Nupt. & concup. l. 1. c. 9. Gen.* 2. 18. *Gen.* 16. 5. & 21. 11.

that much mischief must needs follow upon having more wives then one: for whereas God at first made a wife to be as an help unto man, two, or more wives cannot but be a great grief and vexation unto him by reason of that emulation that is betwixt them. Through *Hagars* means was *Sarah* stirred against *Abraham*, and *Abraham* grieved at *Sarahs* words. Though *Leah* and *Rachel* were sisters, yet great were their emulations: the like whereof is noted of *Peninnah* and many others.

Considering the hainousness of this sin, our lawes⁷⁷⁹ have justly made it felony for a man to have more wives then one, or a woman more husbands.

§. 84. *Of the near conjunction of man and wife together.*

2. *The nearest of all other are husband and wife one to another.*⁷⁸⁰ Every clause in the forenamed law proveth as much.
1. *Parents* must be *left* for wife: who nearer then parent and child? If man and wife be nearer then the nearest, then they are the nearest of all.
2. A man is *glued* to his wife. This metaphor setteth forth the *neerness* of a thing as well as the *firminess* of it: for things glued together are as one entire thing.
3. Man and wife are *one flesh*: many of one are made two, but no *two* so nearly and truly made *one* as man and wife.

As God hath limited a propinquity, and unity of things, so⁷⁸¹ are they to be accounted: but God hath thus nearly knit man and wife together, and made them one flesh. *Those whom*⁷⁸² GOD hath joined together, saith Christ of man and wife: in which respect matrimonial conjunction is called *the covenant*⁷⁸³ of God: so as this covenant cannot be released by any, no not by the mutual consent of man and wife (*Those whom GOD hath joined together, let no man put asunder*) yet may many other covenants made betwixt party and party, be released and disannulled by mutual consent of both parties.

⁷⁷⁹Stat. 1. *Jacob*. 11.

⁷⁸⁰Doctr.

⁷⁸¹Reason.

⁷⁸²Mat. 19. 6.

⁷⁸³Pro. 2. 17.

1. This showeth that the transgressions of man and wife⁷⁸⁴ one against another are of all the most heinous, more then of⁷⁸⁵ friend, fellow, brother, child, parent or any other. Who would not cry *fie upon* that child that hates his parent, or *fie upon* that parent that hates his child? The heathen & savages would not think them worthy of humane society. What then may be thought of the man that hateth his wife, or the wife that hateth her husband? Apply this to all other transgressions: and well note how *the Lord is a witness* thereof.⁷⁸⁶
2. This also showeth how monstrous a thing it is to sow⁷⁸⁷ any seeds of discord, and stir debate betwixt man and wife. The devils instruments they are therein, and a diabolical spirit is in them. For Satan most laboureth to unloose those knots which the Lord kniteth most firmly. Children of several venters, and several friends of each party, are much faulty herein. *Cursed be they all before the Lord.*
3. ⁷⁸⁸ This near conjunction betwixt man and wife is a great⁷⁸⁹ motive to stir them both up, cheerfully to perform all the duties which God requireth of either of them. For thereby they do duty, and show kindness to their own flesh. No man may *hide himself from his own flesh* at large: that is, no man may neglect any duty of mercy, or justice to his neighbour who is of the same stock that he is: shall then an husband or wife hide themselves from one another who in the nearest respect that possibly can be are *one flesh*? not because they come *from* one flesh, but because they come *into* one flesh.

Hitherto of the literal sense of this verse.

The mystical followeth.

§. 85. *Of the matrimonial conjunction of Christ and the Church.*

⁷⁸⁴Uses.

⁷⁸⁵1. Mutual transgressions of man and wife most heinous.

⁷⁸⁶*Mal.* 2. 14.

⁷⁸⁷2. Monstrous to make debate betwixt man and wife.

⁷⁸⁸1 *Sam.* 26. 19.

⁷⁸⁹3. All duties betwixt man and wife to be cheerfully performed. *Isa.* 58. 7.

The forenamed ancient marriage law is here applied mystically⁷⁹⁰ to Christ and the Church, as is evident by the next verse, where the Apostle having reference to this verse saith, *This is a great mystery*. There is then a mystery contained in it. But of what, or of whom is that mystery? The Apostle himself maketh answer, in these words: *I speak concerning Christ and the Church*.

The mystery in general is this,

Christ and the Church are to one another as husband and wife.

The particulars of this mystery are these.

The matrimonial conjunction betwixt Christ & the Church is a most

1. Preheminent
 2. Firm
 3. Near
- conjunction.

First of the general.

The many espousal, and matrimonial titles, which in Scripture are given to Christ and the Church in mutual relation of one to another, evidently show that they are joined together by the honourable, inseparable and inviolable bond of marriage: He is styled a⁷⁹¹ *bridegroom*, she a *bride*: he⁷⁹² *Welbeloved*, she *love*: he an⁷⁹³ *husband*, she a *wife*: he an⁷⁹⁴ *Head*, she the *Body*: both⁷⁹⁵ *one flesh*.

2. All things requisite to join man and wife together, do fitly concur betwixt Christ and the Church.
1. They are persons fit to be joined. Though Christ be⁷⁹⁶ God, yet for⁷⁹⁷ this end he became man: and though the Church were impure, yet for this end is she cleansed and sanctified.

⁷⁹⁰ *Quod per historiam impletum est in Adam, per prophetiam significat Christum qui reliquit patrem, etc. Aug. de Gen. lib. 2. c. 24.*

⁷⁹¹ *Ioh. 3. 29.*

⁷⁹² *Cant. 1. 13, 15.*

⁷⁹³ *2 Cor. 11. 2.*

⁷⁹⁴ *Eph. 5. 23.*

⁷⁹⁵ *& vers. 31.*

⁷⁹⁶ the things which make Christ and the Church fit to be husband and wife.

⁷⁹⁷ *Ioh. 17. 19.*

⁷⁹⁸ *Ioh. 20. 17.*

2. They have their parents consent: for God is the⁷⁹⁸ common father of both. And God hath given⁷⁹⁹ Christ to the Church, and the⁸⁰⁰ Church to Christ.
3. They have given their⁸⁰¹ mutual consent each to other.
4. He⁸⁰² beareth an husband like affection to her, and she is willing to yield a wife-like subjection to him.
5. He hath⁸⁰³ given her many favours and gifts as pledges of his love: and she in testimony of her faithfulness was under the Law circumcised, and is under the Gospel baptized: and doth bind her self with all the sacred bonds and covenants which God to that purpose hath sanctified.
6. He hath prepared⁸⁰⁴ places of habitation for them both together, and⁸⁰⁵ she earnestly desireth to be with him.

Behold another evidence of Christs admirable love to the⁸⁰⁶ Church, and of the near union betwixt Christ and her. The⁸⁰⁷ former was that she was his *body*. This, that she is his *wife*: well might the Church say as *Abigail* did, *Behold, let thine handmaid be a servant to wash the feet of the servants of my*⁸⁰⁸ *Lord*: and as the prodigal child, *Make me as one of thine hired*⁸⁰⁹ *servants*: or as the Baptist, *I am not worthy to stoop down to*⁸¹⁰ *unloose thy shoe-latchets*. What a favour then is it to be made his spouse, his wife, his Queen. Great was the favour which *Ahash-verosh* showed to *Esther*, when he made her his wife: he was a great Monarch, reigning *from India to Ethiopia over 127 provinces*: but *Esther* was a poor orphan and captive: yet was not this favour comparable to Christs: for there was no such disparity and inequality betwixt *Ahash-verosh* and *Esther*, as betwixt Christ and the Church: neither is *Esthers* advancement to be compared with the Churches: and yet there was some cause in *Esther* to move *Ahash-*

⁷⁹⁹*Rom.* 8. 32.

⁸⁰⁰*Ioh.* 6. 39.

⁸⁰¹*Cant.* 2. 16.

⁸⁰²*Eph.* 5. 23, 24.

⁸⁰³*Eph.* 4 8.

⁸⁰⁴*Ioh.* 14. 3.

⁸⁰⁵*Reu.* 22. 17, 20.

⁸⁰⁶1. *Use.*

⁸⁰⁷An high favour to be the spouse to Christ.

⁸⁰⁸1 *Sam.* 25. 41.

⁸⁰⁹*Luk.* 15. 19.

⁸¹⁰*Mar.* 1. 7.

verosh to do what he did, for she was very beautiful, and lovely, and worthy to be loved: but⁸¹¹ in the Church when Christ first cast his love on her, there was no such thing. No pattern of love can be given any way comparable to this.

Let the Church therefore, and all that profess themselves⁸¹² to be of the Church, take such notice hereof, as they may endeavour⁸¹³ to carry themselves worthy of this honour and advancement: not to wax proud and insolent thereupon, but to despise all vain and worldly toys: to answer love with love, as the Church is set forth in *Solomon's* song; to be subject to her husband, to reverence and obey him, and to perform all duties appertaining to such a wife: seeking by all good means to maintain the honour of her place. The Church is made a pattern of duty to all wives: if she should fail, greater inconvenience would follow from thence, then from *Vashties*⁸¹⁴ disobedience.

This is the rather to be regarded because it is not only a⁸¹⁵ matter of instruction but of trial also, showing both what they⁸¹⁶ which are of the Church ought to do, and also⁸¹⁷ what indeed they will do. Wherefore no profane person that lightly esteemeth the Lord Jesus, no Idolater that casteth his love on other husbands, no swearer or blasphemer that dishonoreth the great Name of Jesus, none that any way are rebellious against him, none that hate, scorn, scoff, or hurt any of his members, can have any comfort in this advancement of the Church, because they have no part therein, nor right thereunto.

But great is that comfort which the true Saints may receive⁸¹⁸ therein. For by virtue of this matrimonial bond,⁸¹⁹

1. Christ is made a yokefellow with his Church, and her companion.

Under all the burdens which are laid upon her, he putteth his shoulder to make it the more easy: yea, the great burdens of Gods wrath, the curse of the law, and sin the cause thereof, hath he so taken on him,

⁸¹¹ §. 33, 34.

⁸¹² 2. *Use.*

⁸¹³ *Direction.* How Christs spouse must cary her self.

⁸¹⁴ *Est.* 1. 16. *etc.*

⁸¹⁵ 3. *Use.*

⁸¹⁶ *Trial.* Who are Christs spouse.

⁸¹⁷ §. 24.

⁸¹⁸ 4. *Use.*

⁸¹⁹ *Consolation.* The privileges of Christs spouse.

as he hath clean freed his Church from them, because they would else have crushed her down to hell.

2. Christ is as her champion to answer all challenges sent unto her, as her advocate to plead and answer all the complaints that shall be made against her, as her surety to discharge all her debts: the Church being covert-baron under Christ, he is as her self, all in all for her, and to her.
3. All his honours, goods, privileges are hers: she hath⁸²⁰ a right to them, and her part in them, she is a coheir with him (*Rom.* 8. 17.) a Queen because he a King (*Psal.* 45. 9.) and all glorious, as was noted, vers. 27.
4. He will assuredly perform all the offices of an husband, as to love her, bear with her, provide for her, with the like. Able he is to do all, for he is omnipotent: willing also he must needs be, because willingly he hath taken upon him this place: he hath made himself a pattern to other husbands: will he not then do that himself which herequireth of others? If ever any wife might receive comfort in a match, the Church may receive comfort in this match.

The benefit of this match will yet more lively appear by a particular consideration of the three forenamed properties of this matrimonial bond, the *preheminency*, *firmness*, and *nearness* thereof.

§. 86. Of Christs leaving his Father and mother for his spouse.

I. The preheminency of the matrimonial bond betwixt Christ and the Church herein appeareth, that

Christ left his father and his mother for his spouse the Church. As Christ is God, God is his father; as man, the Virgin *Mary* was his mother. Now the leaving of his father must be taken only by way of resemblance, in that he came from the place of his fathers habitation, to the place where his Spouse was. The Scripture saith, that he *was in the bosom of his father:*⁸²¹ *by him, as one brought up with him, his daily delight, rejoicing always*⁸²²

⁸²⁰ *Ecclesia omnem sponsi potestatem tenet. Aug. contr. Don. l. 4. c. 1.*

⁸²¹ *Ioh. 1. 18.*

⁸²² *Prou. 8. 30.*

⁸²³ *Ephes. 4. 9.*

*before him: yet descended he into the lowest parts of the earth*⁸²³ *where his spouse was. He came out from the father, and came into*⁸²⁴ *the world.*

But truly and properly did he prefer his Spouse before his mother. For when he was instructing his Spouse, and his mother came to interrupt him, he said to his mother, *who is my*⁸²⁵ *mother?* and to his Spouse, *behold my mother.*

Of the⁸²⁶ same mind must the Church, and all that are of the Church be unto Christ: she must *forget her own people, and fathers*⁸²⁷ *house.* Seeing Christ hath gone before us, and given us so good an example, what an high point of ingratitude would it be for us, to prefer father, mother, or any other before Christ our husband? Note what he saith in this case, *He that loveth*⁸²⁸ *father or mother more then me, is not worthy of me.* And again, *If any come unto me, and hate not his father and mother, he cannot*⁸²⁹ *be mine.* To *hate* here, is to be so far from preferring father & mother before Christ, as rather then not to love Christ, to hate father and mother. Or, so entirely to love Christ above all, as our love of parents in comparison thereof to be an hatted. Thus *Levi said unto his father and mother, I have not seen him:*⁸³⁰ *for they observed the word, and kept the covenant of Christ.*

This then is our duty, that we suffer not any natural affection and dotage on our parents to swallow up that love we owe to Christ, as *Pharaohs ill-favourèd and lean-fleshed kine eat*⁸³¹ *up the seven well-favourèd and fat kine.* How much less should any love of this world, of the profits, promotions, or pleasures of this world, draw away our hearts from Christ; should we not rather say and do as the Apostles did, *Behold, we have for saken*⁸³² *all and followed Christ?*

⁸²⁴ *Ioh.* 16. 28.

⁸²⁵ *Mark.* 3. 33, 34.

⁸²⁶ Use.

⁸²⁷ *Imitation.* All to be forsaken for Christ. *Psal.* 45. 10.

⁸²⁸ *Matth.* 10. 37.

⁸²⁹ *Luke* 14. 26. expounded. How parents to be hated for Christ.

⁸³⁰ *Deut.* 33. 9.

⁸³¹ *Gen.* 41. 4.

⁸³² *Matth.* 19. 27.

§. 87. *Of the indissoluble union betwixt Christ and the Church.*

II. The firmness of that bond whereby Christ and the Church are said to be *glued* together, is greater and more inviolable then that whereby man and wife are joined together: Death parteth man and wife: but death cannot make a diremption betwixt Christ and the Church: so as we may well from this metaphor infer, that *Christ and the Church are inseparably*⁸³³ *knit together. I will betroth thee unto me for ever*, saith Christ unto the Church. The covenant which Christ maketh with his Church, is an *everlasting* covenant. *The mountains shall depart*,⁸³⁴ *and the hills be removed, before his kindness shall depart from the Church.*

The stedfastness and unchangeableness of his will, is the⁸³⁵ only cause thereof. Whom he loveth, *he loveth unto the end.*⁸³⁶ *His gifts and calling are without repentance.* He is not like the⁸³⁷ hard hearted Jews, who upon every slight occasion would put away their wives. *The Lord hateth putting away.* Though⁸³⁸ therefore the Church, through her weakness, do depart from him, and play the harlot, *yet return again to me*, saith the⁸³⁹ Lord.

Learn we by this pattern to cleave close unto the Lord,⁸⁴⁰ which is a duty most due to Christ who cleaveth so close to us, and therefore oft⁸⁴¹ expressed in the Scripture.

Three virtues there are which are of special use to this purpose, Faith, Hope, love.

Faith is the hand whereby we lay fast hold on Christ, and as it were knit him to our selves, as he by his Spirit kniteth us to himself. This maketh us rest and repose our selves on him for all needful things: and not to leave him for any thing.

⁸³³ *Hosea* 2. 19.

⁸³⁴ *Isa.* 61. 8. & 54. 10.

⁸³⁵ Reason.

⁸³⁶ *Ioh.* 13. 1.

⁸³⁷ *Rom.* 11. 29.

⁸³⁸ *Mal.* 2. 16.

⁸³⁹ *Ier.* 3. 1.

⁸⁴⁰ Use. Cleave to Christ.

⁸⁴¹ *Deut.* 10. 20. & 13. 4. *Acts* 11. 23.

Hope is the anchor, which holdeth us fast against all the storms of Satan, so as they can never drive us out of our harbour, which is the Lord Jesus Christ.

Love is the glue and soader which maketh us one with Christ: for it is the property of love to unite those that love one another in one. *Jonathans soul was knit with the soul of*⁸⁴² *David*. For why? *Jonathan loved him as his own soul*. He that loveth is well pleased with him whom he loveth, and seeketh also to please him, that they may mutually delight one in another. Were these three virtues well rooted in us, we would say, *who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Shall tribulation,*⁸⁴³ *or distress, etc.*

§. 88. Of the equal privilege of all the Saints.

III. Concerning the phrase, whereby the nearness of⁸⁴⁴ man and wife is set forth (*they two shall be one flesh*) it may be demanded how this can be applied to Christ and the Saints, who are more then two?

Answ. Christ by one Spirit kniteth us all into one body,⁸⁴⁵ and so maketh all jointly considered together one Spouse. The multitude of Saints doth no more imply many wives, then the multitude of members which the natural body of a wife hath. This point then teacheth us, that

In the mystical marriage betwixt Christ and the Church, all and every of the Saints have an equal privilege. Some are not⁸⁴⁶ Concubines, some wives, nor some more loved, or preferred to another, but all one wife. *All are one in Christ Jesus.*⁸⁴⁷

Neither the father that gave them all, nor the son who⁸⁴⁸ took them all, saw any thing in one more then in another; their mere grace moved them to do what they did. Well may every one apply all the forenamed privileges unto themselves: and not one emulate another.

This affordeth instruction to the more eminent in the⁸⁴⁹ Church, that like proud dames they insult not over others, as if they were their

⁸⁴²1 *Sam.* 18. 1.

⁸⁴³*Rom.* 8. 35. *etc.*

⁸⁴⁴All the Saints made one Spouse.

⁸⁴⁵1 *Cor.* 12. 13.

⁸⁴⁶See §. 22.

⁸⁴⁷*Gal.* 3. 28.

⁸⁴⁸Reason.

⁸⁴⁹Use.

hand-maids: and consolation to the meaner sort, that they may uphold themselves, and possess their souls with patience, and not envy, or grieve at the outward prosperity and privileges of others. In the greatest privilege they are equal to the greatest.

This of the parties coupled to Christ. For these words (*they two*) show that all the Saints are but *one*: Christ is the other of the two. The next words (*are one flesh*) show how near those Saints are to Christ.

§. 89. *Of the near union betwixt Christ and the Church.*

The main point here to be noted is, that

Christ and the Church are most nearly linked together. What⁸⁵⁰ can be nearer, then that two should come *into one flesh*?

This is somewhat more then to be *of Christs flesh*. That shows we are as it were cut out of Christ: this shows that we are again knit to him. That was a preparation unto this: this is as the consummation and perfection of all.⁸⁵¹ Many metaphors are used to set forth the near union betwixt Christ and his Church, but this surpasseth them all. As here we and Christ are said to be *one flesh*, so in another place, *one spirit*. Well therefore might the name and title *Christ* be given to this Spouse of Christ.

⁸⁵² It was noted on a like ground to this, that of all other persons⁸⁵³ the transgression of a wife against an husband is most heinous. What then are the transgressions of the Church against Christ? As we are much more bound unto Christ for the privileges we receive from him as an *Head* and *husband*, and so our Saviour having made with us an everlasting covenant of marriage, then for those we received from him as our Creator, Lord and master: so are the rebellions now committed against him more monstrous. To *Adam* that broke the first covenant whereby like a rebellious child and servant he sinned against his father and master, mercy and pardon was given: but to such as now break the bond of this everlasting covenant, and make a total and final desertion, utterly renouncing this husband, or by

⁸⁵⁰ *Christus nihil aliud deputat corpus suum (i.) Ecclesiam, quam seipsum, quia de Christo & ecclesia verius intelligitur, Erunt duo in carne una. Aug. de pec. mer. lib. 1. cap. 31.*

⁸⁵¹ See §. 70.

⁸⁵² §. 84.

⁸⁵³ 1 Cor. 6. 17. & 12. 12.

their adultery cause him to give them a bill of divorce, *there remaineth no more sacrifice*⁸⁵⁴ *for sins; but a certain fearful looking for of judgment, and fiery indignation which shall devour the adversaries.* This is to be noted, to make us the more circumspect over our ways, resisting sin in the beginning, and *looking diligently lest any*⁸⁵⁵ *man fall from the grace of God; and giving no place at all unto*⁸⁵⁶ *the Devil.* Satan will most endeavour to dissolve the nearest bonds that God maketh. This then being the nearest of all, we ought to be the most careful in preserving it.

⁸⁵⁴*Heb.* 10. 27.

⁸⁵⁵*Heb.* 12. 15.

⁸⁵⁶*Eph.* 4. 27.

The Mystery and Practice of Marriage

§. 90. *Of the mystery of the union of Christ and the Church.*

EPHES. 5. 32.

This is a great mystery: but I speak concerning Christ and the Church.

This verse is a conclusion of that excellent digression which the Apostle hath made concerning the near union of Christ and the Church.

In it two points are to be noted.

1. A pathetical exclamation (*This is a great mystery.*)
2. A particular application of the forenamed law (*but I speak concerning Christ and the Church.*)

Here first note that

The union betwixt Christ and the Church is a great mystery.

The Apostle could not have said more of it then to call it *a mystery, a great mystery.*

A mystery is a divine secret.⁸⁵⁷

A Secret it is in two respects.

1. Because it is not known.
2. Because it is unsearchable: the depth of it cannot be fathomed.

It is a *Divine* secret, for two other respects.

1. Because it could not have been opened but by divine revelation.
2. Because when it is opened it cannot be conceived but by the illumination of the Spirit. That Spirit which openeth and revealeth the mystery, must also open the eyes of our understanding to discern aright of it.

⁸⁵⁷Of a mystery see more in the whole armour of God, Treat. 3. §. 168. on Eph. 6. 19.

It is further said to be a *great* mystery.

1. *Simply* in it self, because the matter thereof is deep,⁸⁵⁸ difficult, waighly, and of great moment.
2. *Comparatively* in relation to other mysteries: no mystery revealed in Gods word comparable to it.

Let us not presume to measure it with the line of our own reason. It being a *great mystery*, it is above our capacity: yet because it is revealed we must believe it, as we do the mysteries of the Trinity, of Christs eternal generation, of the personal union of his two natures, of the proceeding of the holy Ghost, with the like; because the word hath revealed them, though we cannot fully see the reason of them. Herein lieth a main difference betwixt our estate in this world and in the world to come: here we must believe what we know but in part: there we shall perfectly know whatsoever is to be believed. Preachers can but in part make known this mystery, and hearers can but in part conceive it, let us therefore wait for perfect understanding of it, till all things be perfected in Christ: but in the mean time believe without doubting or wavering, that which is revealed of it.

In our meditation of this mystery, let us conceive no carnal,⁸⁵⁹ no earthly thing of it, because it is a mystery: it is altogether spiritual and heavenly. From the natural union of our head and body, and from the matrimonial union of man and wife, we may and ought to take occasion by way of resemblance, to help our understanding in the union of Christ and his Church: for this end are these resemblances used, and by this means may our understanding be much helped, as by the outward elements and rites which are used in the Sacraments: but if because of these comparisons we draw this which is only and wholly spiritual, to any carnal matter, we shall make that to be a thick mist, and dark cloud, which is given for a light.

The dotage of our adversaries is here plainly discovered. They make our union with Christ merely carnal. For they conceit it to consist in a corporeal commixtion of Christs flesh with ours, by our eating his flesh with the teeth of our bodies, and drinking his blood down our throats,

⁸⁵⁸1. *Use.* The mystery of our union with Christ not to be measured with the last of our reason.

⁸⁵⁹2. *Use.* No carnal thing in our union with Christ. *Ecclesia Christo in occulto vxor est. Occultè quip atque intus in abscondito secreto spiritali anima humana inhaeret verbo Dei, vt sint duo in carne una.* Aug. contr. Faust. Man. lib. 22. cap. 38.

and digesting both⁸⁶⁰ in our stomachs as our bodily food, that so it may turn into our substance. Thus they show themselves like the dull-headed Capernaitans, and like ignorant *Nicodemus*. There is a great deal of gross absurdity, but no great mystery in that conceit.

§. 91. *Of the Popes usurping to be Spouse of the Church.*

The Apostles application of this mystery to Christ and the Church, discovereth two gross errors of the Papists.

One, that they make the Pope a Spouse of the Church. With what face can any apply that to the Pope and the Church, which the Apostle so expressly saith is meant of Christ and the⁸⁶¹ Church? Yea, what arrogant presumption is it, to attribute that to mortal sinful man, which is proper to the eternal and holy son of God? Is not this to confer Christs prerogatives upon himself, and so make himself plain Antichrist? Who gave the Church to the Pope, or the Pope to the Church? When did she give her consent? (I speak of the true Catholic Church of Christ.) What hath he done for her? Or rather what hath he not done against her? The⁸⁶² distinction of *Imperial* and *Ministerial* Spouse, cannot here serve the turn. As the metaphor of an head, so much less the metaphor of a Spouse will admit a ministerial Spouse. As he is an adulterer that taketh upon him to be a ministerial husband, so is she an adulteress that yieldeth her self to such an one. The Apostle saith, *I have espoused you to ONE husband*.⁸⁶³

§. 92. *Of the false Sacrament of Marriage.*

The other error is, that *marriage is a Sacrament*: the main ground whereof they have taken from this text, which ground by the Apostles application of this mystery to Christ and the Church, is as plainly removed, as if the Apostle had purposely ordered his stile, to prevent this erroneous collection: as if he had said, *That none may mistake this mystery, and*

⁸⁶⁰3. Use. Papists make our union with Christ a carnal matter. *Joh* 6. 52. *Ioh*. 3. 4.

⁸⁶¹*Multos adulteros video qui sponsam tanto pretio emptam possidere volunt, & id agunt vt pro sponso amentur. Aug. in Ioh. Tract. 12. Vide Bern. ep. 237. ad Eugen.*

⁸⁶²See §. 17.

⁸⁶³2 *Cor.* 11 2.

apply it to a matrimonial conjunction of man and woman together, know that I mean no such thing: the mystery which I speak of, is concerning Christ and the Church. I marvell how they dare misapply that which is so plainly expressed. Though the Apostle had not so clearly showed his mind and meaning, yet the very thing it self would lead us so to judge of it. For, *that which in Christ*⁸⁶⁴ *and the Church is a great mystery, in man and wife is but a small matter.* The vulgar Latin translation first led them into this error, for it translateth the word *mystery, a Sacrament.* But a translation is no sufficient ground to prove a doctrine. Besides the word *Sacrament* used by that Translator, hath as large an extent as a *mystery*: if they should make every thing which he translateth *Sacrament*, a proper Sacrament of the Church, there would be many more Sacraments then the Papists themselves do make.

1. As for this supposed Sacrament, no Papist could ever show when or where God ordained it to be a Sacrament. Nay, they agree not among themselves about the time, how long it hath been a Sacrament.⁸⁶⁵ Some of them hold, that ever since the first institution of marriage in Paradise, it hath been a Sacrament. But the greater number of Papists hold it to be a Sacrament⁸⁶⁶ of the new Testament under the Gospel, because their Tridentine Council hath so decreed it. Where we may note how the greater number of them, when two absurdities are questioned, are ready to fall into the worst. Under the Law the nonage of the Church needed, and had more Sacraments then under the Gospel: yet that which was in use as much under the Law as under the Gospel, and had then as much to make it a Sacrament as now, was then none, yet now is one.
2. As they cannot show where it was ordained for a Sacrament, so neither can they show what is the Sacramental sign thereof. Some make carnal copulation to be it. But there may be a true marriage, though the parties married never know each other.

Others make the *parents giving* to be the sign. But they hold that that is a true marriage, which is done without parents consent.

⁸⁶⁴*Quod est in Christo & in Ecclesia magnum, hoc in singulis quibusque viris & uxoribus minimum. Aug. de nupt. & concup. lib. 1. cap. 21.*

⁸⁶⁵*Alphons. à Castro contr. haer. lib. 3.*

⁸⁶⁶*Petrus à Soto de Matr. lect. 2. Concil. Trident. Sess. 24. Can. 1.*

Others the *Priests blessing*. Yet they hold the marriage of Infidels and Heretics who have no Priests, to be a true marriage.

Others, the *consent of the parties themselves*. Thus shall a party administer a Sacrament to himself.

Others, other things. Thus they wanting the light of Gods word, one strayeth in one by-path, another in another, and none of them hit upon the right.

3. A like difference there is about the form of this Sacrament.

4. If other positions delivered by them concerning matrimony be noted, a man would think that they should be far from making it a Sacrament. They prefer virginity before it. Yea, they account it a kind of pollution. They hold it unlawful for Priests, Monks, Nuns, and such like holy orders (as they esteem them) to marry: so as there is a Sacrament, whereof their holy ones may not partake. The order of Priesthood is a Sacrament (in their account) yet that order keepeth from marriage, so as one Sacrament fighteth against another. Yea, Infidels may be partakers of a Sacrament, and so their holy and precious things shall be denied to their holy ones, and cast unto swine. Thus we see a rotten building erected upon a sandy foundation: a false Sacrament established upon a false application of this text. Can it then stand?

§. 93. Of the Sum of husbands and wives duties.

EPHES. 5. 33.

Nevertheless, let every one of you in particular so love his wife, even as himself: and the wife see that she reverence her husband.

The Apostle having made a large digression about the mutual relation betwixt Christ and the Church, whom he propounded as patterns to husbands and wives, he now returneth to the main point intended, namely to the duties of husbands and wives: and so much doth the first particle imply (*Nevertheless*) as if he had thus said, *Though I have a little digressed into the mystery of the union of Christ and the Church, yet nevertheless do ye, ô husbands and wives, call to mind that which I principally aimed at, even your duties.*

This verse then containeth a conclusion of the Apostles discourse, concerning the duties of husbands and wives.

Two points are especially noted therein.

- 1. A declaration of their several and distinct duties.
- 2. A direction to apply their own proper duties each of them to themselves.

Their distinct duties are noted in two words

1. Love.
2. Fear.

These two, as they are distinct duties in themselves, so are they also common conditions which must be annexed to all other duties. *love* as sugar to sweeten the duties of authority, which appertain to an husband. *Fear* as salt to season all the duties of subjection which appertain to a wife. The Apostle therefore hath set them down as two marks for husbands and wives to aim at in every thing wherein they have to deal one with the other.

Of these I will more distinctly speak in the treatises of the particular duties of husbands and wives.

§. 94. *Of applying the word to our selves.*

The direction for a particular application of their own proper duties to either of them is here especially to be noted. In this direction two things are to be observed.

1. That every particular person apply to himself that which by a Minister is indefinitely delivered to all. *Every one of you in particular*, saith the Apostle: which is as much as if he had thus more largely expressed his mind, *I have laid down such general duties as all husbands and wives without exception of any of what rank or degree soever they be are bound unto; which though by name I have not severally delivered to every one, one by one, but generally to you all, yet do every one of you apply those things to your selves in particular.*
2. That every one apply his own peculiar duty unto himself. Love being peculiar to an husband, to him he saith, *Let him love his wife*: and reverence being peculiar to a wife, to her he saith, *let the wife see that she reverence her husband.*

The direction in every of those several Epistles which were sent to the seven Churches of Asia, (in these words, *He that*⁸⁶⁷ *hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith to the Churches*) doth teach every member in any of those Churches to apply to himself that which was delivered to the whole Church: so doth a like⁸⁶⁸ exhortation which Christ with an exclamation made to the people whom he taught in parables: and this declaration of the extent of Christs counsel, *what I say to*⁸⁶⁹ *you, I say to all*. To this purpose many precepts given to whole Churches, and to all sorts of people are set down in the singular number as given to one, as, *Awake THOU that*⁸⁷⁰ *sleepest. THOU standest by faith: be not thou high minded etc.*⁸⁷¹

The life and power of Gods word consisteth in this particular⁸⁷² application thereof unto our selves. This is to mix *faith with hearing*: faith, I say, whereby we do not only believe the truth of Gods word in general, but also believe it to be a truth concerning our selves in particular: and thus will every precept thereof be a good instruction and direction on to us to guide us in the way of righteousness: every promise therein will be a great encouragement, and consolation to us to uphold us, and to make us hold on: and every judgment threatened therein will be a curb, and bridle to hold us in, and to keep us from those sins against which the judgments are threatened. But otherwise, if we bring not the word home to our own souls, it will be as a word *spoken into the air*,⁸⁷³ vanishing away without any profit to us. Nothing maketh the word less profitable, then the putting of it off from our selves to others, thinking that it concerns others more then our selves.

That we may make the better use of this doctrine, let us observe both what are general duties belonging to all Christians, and apply them as particular to our selves: and also what duties appertain to such persons as are of our place, calling, and condition, and more especially apply them to our selves: let all manner of husbands, and all manner of wives

⁸⁶⁷ *Reu.* 2. 7.

⁸⁶⁸ *Luk.* 8. 8.

⁸⁶⁹ *Mar.* 13. 37.

⁸⁷⁰ *Eph.* 5. 14.

⁸⁷¹ *Rom.* 11. 20.

⁸⁷² *Reason.* The life of Gods word in application.

⁸⁷³ *1 Cor.* 14 9.

of what rank or degree soever they be that shall read the duties hereafter following, know that they are spoken to them in particular. Let Kings and Queens, Lords and Ladies, Ministers and their wives, Rich men and their wives, Poor men and their wives, Old men and their wives, Young men and their wives, all of all sorts take them as spoken to them in particular. It is not honour, wealth, learning, or any other excellency, nor means of place, poverty, want of learning, or any other like thing that can exempt an husband from loving his wife, or a wife from reverencing her husband. He that saith *every one*, excepteth not *any one*. Therefore *every one in particular* do ye so. The like application may be made to all parents and children, masters and servants, concerning their duties.

§. 95. *Of every ones looking to his own duty especially.*

In the forenamed application an eye must be had rather to the duty which we owe, and ought to be performed by us to others, then to that which is due to us, and others ought to perform to us: for the Apostle saith not to the husband, see that thy wife reverence thee, but see that thou love her: so to the wife.

For this purpose the holy Ghost presseth particular duties upon those particular persons who ought to perform them: as *subjection on wives: love on husbands:* and so in others. This therefore is especially to be considered of thee, how thou⁸⁷⁴ maist show thy self blameless. I deny not but that one ought to provoke another, and one to help another in what they can to perform their duty, especially superiors who have charge over others, but the most principal care of every one ought to be for himself, and greatest conscience to be made of performing his own duty.

1. It is more acceptable before God, and more commendable⁸⁷⁵ before men to do duty, then to exact duty. As in matters of free charity, so also of bounden duty, *It is more blessed to*⁸⁷⁶ *give, then to receive*. In particular it is better for an husband to be a good husband, then to have a good wife: so for a wife. To have others fail in duty to us may be an heavy cross, for us to fail in our duty to others is a fearful curse.

⁸⁷⁴*Vnum duntaxat tibi considerandum est, quo pacto te praestes innoxium. Chrys. hom. 26. in 1 Cor. 11.*

⁸⁷⁵Reasons.

⁸⁷⁶*Act. 20. 35.*

2. Every one is to give an account of his own particular⁸⁷⁷ duty. That which the Prophet speaketh of father and son, may be applied to husband and wife, and to all other sorts of people, *If a father do that which is lawful and right, he is just, he⁸⁷⁸ shall surely live: if he beget a son that doth not so, he shall surely die, his blood shall be upon him.* Again, *if a father do that which is not good, he shall die in his iniquity: but if his son do that which is lawful and right he shall surely live. The righteousness of the righteous shall be upon himself: and the wickedness of the wicked shall be upon himself.* That this shall be so betwixt husband and wife, may be gathered out of these words, *Two shall⁸⁷⁹ be in one bed, the one shall be taken, the other left.*

Let this be noted against the common vain apologies which are made for neglect of duty, which is this, *duty is not performed to me, why shall I do duty?* when my husband doth his duty, I will do mine, saith the wife. And I mine, saith the husband, when my wife doth hers. What if he never do his duty, and so be damned, wilt thou never do thine? This looking for of duty at others hands, makes us the more careless of our own.

Do you therefore O husbands look especially to your⁸⁸⁰ own duties, do you love your wives: and you ô wives look⁸⁸¹ you to yours especially, do you reverence your husbands. For this end, let husbands read those duties most diligently which concern husbands, and wives those, which concern wives. Let not the husband say of the wives duties, there are goodlessons for my wife, and neglect his own: nor the wife say the like of husbands duties, and not regard her own. This is it that maketh the subjection of many wives very harsh and irkesome to them, because their husbands that urge and press them thereto show little, or no love to them at all: and this is it that maketh many husbands very backwards in showing love, because their wives which expect much love, show little or no reverence to their husbands. Wherefore *Let every one of you in particular so love his wife, even as himself: and the wife see that she reverence her husband.*

⁸⁷⁷Rom. 14. 12.

⁸⁷⁸Ezec. 18. 5. etc.

⁸⁷⁹Luk. 17. 34.

⁸⁸⁰Use.

⁸⁸¹Non quae alijs data sunt praecepta quaerimus quando alicuius criminis ac. cusamur. Chrys. loc. citat.

The Child's Duties to His Parents

§. 96. *Of the meaning of the first verse of the sixth Chapter.*

From those particular duties which concern *husbands* and *wives* the Apostle proceedeth to lay down such as concern children and parents. As before he laid down wives duties before husbands, so here he beginneth with childrens (who are inferior to their parents) and that for the same reasons which were rendered⁸⁸² before.

Besides children are the fruits of matrimonial conjunction, therefore fitly placed next unto *man* and *wife*.

That which concerneth children is laid down in the sixth Chapter of *Eph.* vers. 1, 2, 3. The meaning whereof we will distinctly open.

EPHES. 6. 1. Children obey your parents in the Lord: for this is right.

The first word (*children*) is in the original as proper a word as could be used, for according to the notation of it, it signifieth such as are begotten and borne. Answerable is the other word (*parents*) which signifieth such as beget and bring forth⁸⁸³ children. Yet are they not so strictly to be taken as if none but such as begat and brought forth, or such as are begotten and brought forth of them were meant: for under the title *parents*, he includeth all such as are in the place of natural parents, as *Grandfathers* and *Grandmothers*, *fathers in law*, and *mothers in law*, *Foster-fathers* and *Foster-mothers*, *Guardians*, *Tutors*, and such like governors: and under the title *children* he compriseth *Grand-children*, *sons and daughters in law*, *Wards*, *Pupils*, and such like. For there is an honour and a subjection due by all who are in place of children, to all such as are in place of parents,

⁸⁸² §. 10.

⁸⁸³ Who are to be accounted children, who parents.

though in a different kind, as we shall⁸⁸⁴ after show. This word *children* which in the original is of the *neuter gender*, doth further include both sexes, *males* and *females*, *sons* and *daughters*: so as either of them are as carefully to apply the duties here set forth to themselves as if in particular both kinds had been expressed.

He expresseth *parents* in the plural number, to show that he meaneth here also both sexes *father* and *mother*, as the law expresseth both: and addeth this relative particle *your*, as by way of *restraint*, to show that every child is not bound to every parent, so by way of *extent* to show that whatsoever the estate of parents be honourable or mean, rich or poor, learned or unlearned, etc. Their own children must not be ashamed of them, but yield all bounden duty to them: if they be parents to children, they must be honoured by children.

The word (*Obey*) under which all duties of children are comprised, according to the Greek notation, signifieth *with an humble submission to hearken*, that is, to attend and give heed to the commandments, reproofs, directions, and exhortations which are given to them, and that with such a reverend respect of the parties who deliver them, as they make themselves conformable thereto.

A duty proper to inferiors, and implieth both *reverence* and *obedience*: the verb noteth out *obedience*; the preposition, *reverence*.

Under this word (*Obey*) the Apostle comprehendeth all⁸⁸⁵ those duties which throughout the Scripture are required of children: as is manifest by his own exemplification thereof in the second verse by the word *honour* which the law useth: so as this word (*obey*) is to be taken in as large an extent as that word (*honour*.)

Quest. Why is *obedience* put for all the rest?

Answ. 1. Because it is the hardest of all the rest, and that which children are loathest to perform they who willingly yield to this, will stick at no duty.

2. Because it is the surest evidence of that *honour* which a child oweth to his parent: and so of performing the fifth commandment.

⁸⁸⁴*Treat.* 5. §. 56, 57, etc..

⁸⁸⁵All duties of children comprised under *obedience*.

3. Because children are bound to their parents: the duties which they perform are not of courtesy, but necessity. Their parents have power to command, and exact them.

The clause added (*in the Lord*) is in effect the same which was used⁸⁸⁶ before (*as unto the Lord*) and it noteth forth a *limitation*, *direction*, and *instigation*: a *limitation* showing that childrens obedience to their parents is to be restrained to the obedience which they owe to Christ, and may not go beyond the limits thereof: a *direction* showing that in obeying their parents, they must have an eye to Christ, and so obey them as Christ may approve thereof: an *instigation* showing that parents bear the image of Christ, and in that respect children must the rather obey their parents.

The last clause of this verse (*for this is right*) is an express reason to enforce the forenamed point of obedience: and it is drawn from equity: and showeth that it is a point agreeable to all law: yea that in way of *recompense* it is due: and if children be not obedient to parents they do that which is most unjust, they defraud their parents of their right.

The former phrase (*in the Lord*) implying one reason, this plainly noteth out another, as the first particle (*for*) declareth.

§. 97. *Of the meaning of the second verse.*

EPHES. 6. 2.

Honour thy father and mother (which is the first commandment with promise.)

The very words of the *fifth commandment* are here alleged⁸⁸⁷ by the Apostle as a confirmation of the forenamed reason, that, *it is just and right to obey parents*, because God in the moral law enioyneth as much. The law is more general then the Apostles precept: for the law compriseth under it all those duties which all kind of inferiors owe to their superiors, whether they be in family, church, or common wealth: but the Apostles precept is given only to one kind of inferiors in the family: yet the argument is very sound and good from a general to a particular, thus, *All inferiors must*⁸⁸⁸ *honour their superiors, therefore children their parents.*

⁸⁸⁶ Chap. 5. vers. 22.

⁸⁸⁷ Why the moral law is alleged.

⁸⁸⁸ A genere ad speciem.

By adding the express words of the law the Apostle sheweth that the subjection which he required of children is no yoke which he of his own head put on their necks: but that which the moral law hath put on them: so as this may be noted as a third reason, namely Gods express charge in his moral law.

If I should handle this law according to the full extent thereof, I should wander too far from the Apostles scope. I will therefore open it no further then it may concern the point in hand, viz. the duty of children.

Honour compriseth here all those duties which children in⁸⁸⁹ any respect owe to their parents. It implieth both *an inward reverend estimation*, and also *an outward dutiful submission*. Yea it implieth also *recompense*, and *maintenance*.

Honour in relation to parents, is used for two reasons especially.

1. To show that parents bear Gods image: for *honour* is properly due to God alone: to the creature it is due, only as it standeth in Gods room, and carrieth his image.
2. To show, that it is an honour to parents to have dutiful children: even as it is a dishonour to them to have disobedient children.

Both *father* and *mother* are expressly mentioned, to take away⁸⁹⁰ all pretence from children of neglecting either of them: for through the corruption of nature we are prone to seek after many shifts to exempt us from our bounden duty; and if not in whole, yet in as great a part as we can. Some might think if they honour their father, who is their mothers head, they have done what the law requireth: others may think they have done as much, if they honour their mother who is the weaker vessel: but the law expressing *father and mother*, condemneth him that neglecteth either of them. Yet to show that if opposition should arise betwixt them, and by reason thereof both could not be obeyed together, the father commanding what the mother forbiddeth, the father is to be preferred, (especially if it be not against the Lord) the *father* is set in the first place.

These words following (*which is the first commandment*⁸⁹¹ *with promise*) are fitly included in a *parenthesis*, because they are not the words

⁸⁸⁹Honour compriseth all childrens duties.

⁸⁹⁰Why both father and mother expressed.

⁸⁹¹How the fifth commandment is the first with promise.

of the law, but inserted by the Apostle as a reason to enforce the law, and so make a *fourth reason*.

Quest. In what respect is this commandment called *the first with promise*?

Ans. 1. The * word here used by the Apostle properly signifieth an affirmative precept, as our English word (*commandment*) doth. Now then of the affirmative precepts it is *the first with promise*.

2. The Scripture oft appropriateth the law to the second table, as where he saith *he that loveth another hath fulfilled the*⁸⁹² *law*, and so in other places.

Now this is the first commandment of the second table.

3. It is generally true of all the commandments: for among the ten it is the *first with promise*.

Object. The second commandment hath a promise annexed⁸⁹³ **to it.**

Ans. 1. That which is annexed to the second Commandment, is not expressly a promise, but rather a declaration of Gods Justice, in taking vengeance of transgressors, and of his mercy in rewarding observers of the Law: yet I deny not but that a promise by consequence is implied: but here it is expressed.

2. The promise there implied is only a general promise made to observers of the whole Law, and therefore he useth the plural number, *Commandments*: but here is a particular promise made to them that keep this Commandment in particular.

2. Quest. Why is it then said the *first*, when no other Commandments with promise follow?⁸⁹⁴

Ans. This particle (*first*) hath not always reference to some other following, but is oft simply taken, to show that none was before it: so is the word *first-borne* used in the Law:⁸⁹⁵ and so Christ is called the *first-borne* son of *Mary*.

The word *promise* sheweth, that this fourth reason includeth some benefit redounding to those children themselves that honour their parents:

⁸⁹² *Rom. 13 8.*

⁸⁹³ Difference betwixt the promise in the second, and first commandment.

⁸⁹⁴ *First* simply taken.

⁸⁹⁵ *Exod. 13. 2. Matth. 1. 25.*

the benefit is expressly mentioned in the next verse, which we will afterwards distinctly consider.

§. 98. *Of aiming at our own, in seeking the good of others.*

Here in general we may note, that

It is not unlawful to aim at our own good and benefit in doing the duties which God requireth at our hands to others: for that which God himself propoundeth and setteth before us, we may seek and aim at. Many like promises there be in Scripture, and many approved prayers grounded on those promises whereby the truth of the doctrine is confirmed unto us. *Hezekiah*⁸⁹⁶ maketh the good service he had done to God and his Church, a ground to obtain longer life: so others.

For God layeth no duty on any man, but therein he aimeth at the good of him who performeth the duty as well as of him to whom the duty is performed. Whereby he would show that his Commandments are no strait yokes and heavy burthens, but means of procuring their good who fulfill them.

How highly doth this commend the good respect that⁸⁹⁷ God beareth to all the sons of men: seeking their good in every place wherein he setteth them, either of authority, or subjection?

How ought this to stir us up willingly and cheerfully to⁸⁹⁸ observe the Lawes which God commandeth us, and perform the services he requireth of us, seeing thereby we procure our own good?

How fully may this satisfy, and even stop the mouths of⁸⁹⁹ all such as are discontent with their places, and mutter against that subjection which God enioyneth to them?

What a good direction and resolution may this be to many,⁹⁰⁰ who being moved in conscience to seek the good of others, doubt whether therein they may aim at their own good or no? To make this case clear by an instance, which may serve in stead of many. A Minister faithful in his

⁸⁹⁶*Isa.* 38. 2, 3.

⁸⁹⁷1. *Use.*

⁸⁹⁸2. *Use.*

⁸⁹⁹3. *Use.*

⁹⁰⁰4. *Use.*

place, and very painful, and in that respect of a good conscience, but withal of a tender and weak conscience, doubteth whether thereby he may seek maintenance to himself, fearing that so he seeketh himself, and not simply the edification of Gods Church. But by the forenamed doctrine we see that both may be aimed at: for God commandeth the one, and promiseth the other. As we have one eye on Gods Commandment for direction, so we may have another on his promise for encouragement.

Yet because through the corruption of our nature, we are too⁹⁰¹ prone to seek our selves, some cautions are in this point carefully to be observed.

1. That we seek not our own good by any *transgression*, for it is promised unto *obedience*.
2. That we do not so wholly seek our selves and our own good, as we neglect others: for God having joined both together, no man may put them asunder.
3. That we aim at our own good, as a reward following upon the duty which God commandeth, and so be as willing to do the duty, as desirous of the reward.
4. That our own benefit be not the *only*, no nor the *chiefest* thing we aim at in doing our duty, but rather come as a motive to add an edge, and to sharpen other motives of greater moment. And thus much the order which the Apostle obserueth in setting down his reasons, noteth unto us: for the three former have respect to God, and to that good conscience which children ought to carry towards him: the *first* pointeth at *Gods image* which parents cary (*in the Lord*:) the *second* setteth forth that *right* which God hath prescribed to children: the *third* declareth *Gods charge*: this *fourth* only, which is the last, hath respect to the *profit* and benefit of children themselves.

§. 99. Of preferring honesty before commodity.

From the forenamed order we may further gather, that *Equity and good conscience ought more to move us to do our duty then our own profit, and the benefit that thereby redoundeth to us*. If there should come such an opposition betwixt these that they could not both stand togethet, but that for doing that which is right, and which God hath commanded, our

⁹⁰¹ Cautions in seeking our own good.

prosperity must be hindred and life shortened, we should so stand to that which is right and commanded of God, as prosperity, life and all be let go. To this purpose tend all the exhortations in Scripture, to forsake goods, lands, life, and every thing else for righteousness sake. So clear is this point,⁹⁰² that the Heathen discerned it by the glimpse of that light of nature which they had: for they could say, that that which is honest and right, is to be preferred before that which is commodious and profitable.

There is no comparison betwixt honesty and commodity, *right* and *profit*. The one is absolutely necessary for attaining to eternal salvation, the other giveth but a little quiet and contentment in this world: nay, if *profit* be without right, it can give no true contentment or quiet at all.

Unworthy therefore they are of the name of Christians, who⁹⁰³ so wholly and only aim at their outward profit and prosperity, as they regard not what is right, and what God hath commanded. If by obeying God, and doing that which is right they may reap some benefit to themselves they can be content⁹⁰⁴ to yield thereunto: but if not, farewell all *right*, farewell all Gods commandments. Though they think every thing that is profitable, be it right or wrong, to be good, yet Gods word accounteth nothing good but that which is honest: such therefore can look for no blessing from the Lord.

§. 100. *Of the meaning of the third verse.*

EPHES. 6. 3.

That it may be well with thee, and thou maist live long on the
earth.

The promise mentioned before in general, is here particularly set down. The first words (*that it may be well with thee*) are not in the Hebrew text⁹⁰⁵ there where the Law is first recorded, and thereupon not set in that usual form of the ten Commandments, which is in use among us: but yet in⁹⁰⁶ another place where the Law is repeated, they are set down: and the Greek

⁹⁰²*Cic. lib. 2. de Offic. & Paradox. 1.*

⁹⁰³Use.

⁹⁰⁴*Nihil bonum Scriptura nisi quod honestum asserit. Ambr. Offic. lib. 2. cap. 3.*

⁹⁰⁵*Exod. 20. 12.*

⁹⁰⁶*Deut. 5. 16.*

translation, commonly called the *Septuagint* (which (as is probable) the Church in the Apostles time used) hath expressly noted it in both places. Now this part of the promise (*that it may be well with thee*) is prefixed as an amplification of the other part concerning *long life*, which is the most principal thing intended, as appeareth in that it only is mentioned where the Law is first recorded. It sheweth that the *long life*⁹⁰⁷ which God promiseth, shall not be a life of woe and misery, (for then were it no blessing, but the longer life lasted, the worse it would be) but a life full of comfort and happiness: therefore *Moses* setteth this former clause in the latter place after long life thus (*that thy days may be prolonged, and that it*⁹⁰⁸ *may go well with thee*) to show that the *well being* here spoken of, is an amplification of the benefit of *long life*.

Whereas the Apostle setteth down the place where the benefit of this promise is to be enjoyed in a most large phrase, thus (*on earth*) the Law bringeth it to a more narrow compass thus (*in the land which the Lord thy God giveth thee*) meaning the land of Canaan which was given of God as a peculiar inheritance to the Jews: so that the promise (as the Law setteth it down in peculiar to the Jews) implieth *long life*, and *prosperity* in their own inheritance: for *long life* to the Jews was counted *no life* out of their own Country. But the Apostle writing to all nations, leaveth out that description of Canaan, and retaineth only the general substance in this word (*on earth*) which he setteth down to show that even outward prosperity, and a *long life* in this world is here promised.

§. 101. Of prosperity: how far forth it may be a blessing.

For further clearing of this text, and for better application thereof, I will resolve sundry questions arising out of it, and gather such profitable instructions as it affordeth.

The promise consisteth of two branches.

The first branch (*that it may be well with thee*) is very ample and large: all good things, all manner of blessings whatsoever, spiritual and temporal, belonging to soul and body, concerning this life, and the life to come, make to a mans *wellbeing*. Whence may first be demanded;

⁹⁰⁷ Longlife and prosperity joined together.

⁹⁰⁸ Deut. 5. 16.

1. *Qust.* What may be the extent of this phrase in this place?⁹⁰⁹

Answ. It may generally be extended to all manner of good things. For *Godliness hath promise of the life that now is and of that that is to come.* But (as I take it) temporal prosperity is here principally intended: and that for these reasons.

1. It is joined with *long life*, which is a temporal blessing.
2. The last word (*on earth*) may be referred to this branch of *well-being*, as well as to the other of *long life*.
3. In the Law (from whence this clause is taken) it is expressly set down, thus, *that it may go well with thee in the*⁹¹⁰ *land*, etc.
2. ***Quest.* Is then outward temporal prosperity (as honour,⁹¹¹ health, peace, liberty, goods, etc.) a token of Gods love and favour?**

Answ. Yea: in it self it is a blessing, and fruit of Gods love: as appeareth by these reasons.

1. As at first it was made and ordained of God, it is a good thing.
2. It tendeth to mans good, if it be rightly used.
3. It was bestowed on man before he had offended.
4. It is promised of God as a reward to them that fear him⁹¹² and keep his Commandments.
5. The Saints have prayed for it, and have been thankful⁹¹³ for it.
6. The contrary was first inflicted as a punishment of sin,⁹¹⁴ and is oft threatened as a token of Gods wrath, and so hath also been inflicted on transgressors.⁹¹⁵

§. 102. *Of prosperity bestowed on the wicked, how it proves a curse.*

3. ***Quest.*** Why then is it bestowed upon the wicked, even such as are haters of God, and are hated of him? And why are Gods friends, such as are loved of him, and love him again, deprived thereof? This sore

⁹⁰⁹Temporal prosperity promised. 1 *Tim.* 4. 8.

⁹¹⁰*Deut.* 5. 16.

⁹¹¹Prosperity a good thing.

⁹¹²*Levit.* 26. 4. etc. *Deut.* 28. 1. etc.

⁹¹³*Gen.* 28. 20. & 32. 10, 11.

⁹¹⁴*Levit.* 26. 15. etc.

⁹¹⁵*Deut.* 28. 16. etc.

scruple made *David* stumble,⁹¹⁶ and moved other Prophets to complain. But the answer is ready.

Answ. Outward prosperity is of that nature, as it may turn to the good or hurt of him that enjoyeth it. And herein is Gods admirable and unsearchable wisdom seen, in that he is able to turn blessings into curses, and curses into blessings.⁹¹⁷ He can work by contraries.

4. Quest. How is prosperity a curse to the wicked?

Answ. By mere consequence, through their abuse of it. God gives it to them to show the riches of his mercy: and that all may taste thereof, he doth good to the *evil* and the *good*. Besides,⁹¹⁸ he thus trieth if by any means they may be brought to repentance: which gift because they have not, their prosperity proveth to be a means to make them the more inexcusable, and the more to increase their just condemnation. For the more Gods blessings abound towards them, the more they abuse them, adding to all their other sins, that most odious sin of ingratitude, which maketh up the heap of all. And in these respects I may say of the prosperity of the wicked, as the Prophet of their King, *God gives it in his anger, and takes it away*⁹¹⁹ *his wrath*. For by their abuse thereof, it proveth Satans bait to allure them, his snare to catch them, and his hooke to drown⁹²⁰ them in perdition and destruction. In a word therefore, the wicked are fed in a fair pasture like oxen appointed to the slaughter: they are exalted on high, as on a ladder or scaffold, like thieves and traytors, to be brought down with shame and destruction, as *Pharaohs* Baker was lift up.⁹²¹

§. 103. How both having, and wanting prosperity is a blessing to the Saints.

5. Quest. How is the inioying, or wanting of prosperity a blessing to the righteous?

Answ. God in wisdom knowing what is best for them accordingly deals with them, he bestoweth prosperity on them so far as he seeth it will turn

⁹¹⁶*Psal.* 73. 13. *Ier.* 12. 1. *Hab.* 1. 3.

⁹¹⁷How prosperity proves a curse to the wicked.

⁹¹⁸*Matth.* 5. 45. *Rom.* 2. 4.

⁹¹⁹*Ose.* 13. 11.

⁹²⁰*1 Tim.* 6. 9.

⁹²¹*Gen.* 40. 19.

unto their good: and denieth it to them so far as he seeth it will turn to their hurt. Whensoever therefore God bestoweth any temporal blessing on his Saints, it is a token of his favour: and whensoever he denieth any, the very denial is also a fruit of his favour. Herein is it verified that *All things work together for good to them*⁹²² *that love God*, so as, if they *abound*, it shall go well with them: if they *want*, it shall go well with them: if they be in *high place*, it shall go well with them: if in *mean place*, it shall go well with them: if they be at liberty, if in prison: if they be in health, if sick: in what estate soever, it shall go well with them.

6. *Quest.* How is it then that Saints are oft brought to such extremities that they are forced to complain that it is very⁹²³ ill with them?

Ans. There is flesh and blood in them, by reason of the weakness whereof they are forced to complain: but the present apprehension of weak flesh, is not sufficient to impeach the truth of Gods promise: they consider not in their present extremity what is Gods mind, what his manner of dealing with them, how needful it is that so they should be dealt withal, what end and issue the Lord will give: in truth it is better with them then they wot of. Some weighty reasons there be which move God to bring them to that extremity wherein they are, and those respecting his⁹²⁴ *own glory*, or the⁹²⁵ *edification* of others, or their own good, as⁹²⁶ curing some dangerous disease,⁹²⁷ manifesting the grace of God bestowed upon them,⁹²⁸ drawing them nearer to God,⁹²⁹ making them long the more for heaven, with the like.

§. 104. *Of long-life: how far forth it is a blessing.*

Concerning the second branch of Gods promise (*long-life*) other questions are to be resolved.

1. *Quest.* Is long-life a blessing?⁹³⁰

⁹²² *Rom.* 8. 28.

⁹²³ Complaints of Saints impeach not their well being.

⁹²⁴ *Iob.* 9. 3. *2 Cor.* 12. 9.

⁹²⁵ *Epb.* 3. 1.

⁹²⁶ *Psal.* 119. 67

⁹²⁷ *Iob.* 1. 12.

⁹²⁸ *Ose.* 5. 15.

⁹²⁹ *2 Cor.* 5. 2.

⁹³⁰ Long life a blessing.

Answ. Yea, else would not God here and in other places have promised it as a reward, nor have bestowed it on his Saints.

The reasons to prove it to be a blessing may be drawn to three heads. 1. *Gods glory*. 2. *the good of the Church* where they live. 3. *their own good*.

1. Gods glory is much advanced by the long life of the Saints: for the longer they live the more they do themselves observe Gods wonderful works, and the more they do make them known and declare them to others. But in the grave all⁹³¹ is forgotten.
2. Gods Church is greatly edified thereby: in which respect the Apostle saith, *to abide in the flesh is more needful for*⁹³² *you*: In the Saints that is true which *Elihu* saith should be, namely that *days speak, and multitude of years teach wisdom*.⁹³³ The longer the Saints live, the more good they do: but after death they do none: *when the night cometh no man can work*:⁹³⁴⁹³⁵ upon which ground the Apostle exhorteth to *do good while we have time*.
3. The Saints by long living purchase to themselves great honour, and dignity among Gods people, and a strong stedfast confidence in God. Men regard a good old servant: much more will God. Two strong props have old Saints to establish them, and make them bold: one is a remembrance of Gods former favours, whereby their hope of eternal life is made more sure unto them: another is a kind of present expectation of the accomplishment of Gods promises which they have long waited for.

By this it appears that this particular promise is no light matter, of small moment: but a strong motive to stir up children to obedience.

§. 105. Of long life proving a curse to the wicked.

2. Quest.

Why then is long life given to many wicked ones? And why are many Saints cut off?

⁹³¹ *Psal.* 6. 5. *Isa.* 38. 18.

⁹³² *Phil.* 1. 24.

⁹³³ *Iob.* 32. 7.

⁹³⁴ *Iob.* 9. 4.

⁹³⁵ *Gal.* 6. 10.

Answ. Long life is of the same kind that prosperity is: it may be turned to a curse, as well as prove a blessing.

The wicked by living long on earth make their sins grow to the full (as is implied of the Amorite) they make their⁹³⁶ name to stink the more on earth, as a carion the longer it remaineth above ground the more it stinketh: and they cause the greater torment in hell to be inflicted upon them: for as⁹³⁷ sin is increased, so shall that torment be increased.

The righteous have their days shortened for their good, when they are shortened, and that in these, and such like respects

- 1. That they may be⁹³⁸ taken from the evil to come.
- 2. That they might be made an⁹³⁹ example to others.
- 3.⁹⁴⁰ That⁹⁴¹ by a temporal death eternal condemnation might be avoided.
- 4. That their⁹⁴² chiefest and greatest reward might be hastened.

§. 106. *Of limiting the promises of temporal blessings.*

Thus we see there may be just cause to alter, as the former branch of this promise, *prosperity*, so the latter branch of it, *long-life*, and yet no wrong thereby redound to the righteous, nor benefit to the wicked.

3. *Quest.*

Is not the truth of the promise impeached thereby?

Answ. No whit at all. For first all promises of temporal blessings are limited with such a condition as this, *if the performance of it may stand with Gods honour, and the good of the party to whom it is made*. 2. God doth never simply deprive his Saints of that which is promised, but only in stead of it giveth a better: as in taking away *wealth*, he giveth the more store of *grace*: in restraining *liberty of body*, he giveth *freedom of conscience*: with *affliction* he giveth *patience*: by taking away this *temporal life*, he giveth *eternal life*. God herein dealeth, as if one who

⁹³⁶ Gen. 15. 16.

⁹³⁷ Rom. 2. 5.

⁹³⁸ 1 King. 14. 13.

⁹³⁹ 1 King. 13. 14.

⁹⁴⁰ Isa. 17. 1.

⁹⁴¹ 1 Cor. 11. 32.

⁹⁴² Gen. 5. 24. Heb. 11. 5.

having promised so much iron, should in stead thereof give as much silver: or for silver give gold: and so for one pound give the worth of hundreds or thousands.

§. 107. *Of appropriating prosperity and long-life to the obedience which children yield to their parents.*

4. *Quest. Why is long-life and prosperity appropriated to this kind of righteousness?*

Answ. It is not so appropriated to this, as if it appertained to no other: for it is elsewhere in general promised to the⁹⁴³ observers of the whole law, and to other particular branches thereof beside this: yet in these and such like particular respects⁹⁴⁴ is it applied to the obedience of children.

1. Because obedience to parents is one of the surest evidences of our conformity to the whole law: in that thereby we show our respect of Gods image, and lay a good foundation for the performing of all duty to man.
2. Because a childes performing of his duty to his parents is under God an especial means that they do well, and live long (for as rebellious children make their parents with grief to come the sooner to their graves, so dutiful children make them to continue the longer in prosperity) the Lord in recompense promiseth to such a child prosperity and long life.
3. Because parents are an especial means to procure the welfare and long life of their children, partly by their *provident care*, as *Noami* said to *Ruth*, *shall I not seek rest for thee*,⁹⁴⁵ *that it may be well with thee?* and partly by their *instant prayer*: for the faithful prayer of parents is of great force with God for dutiful children: whence hath risen the custom of childrens asking their parents blessing, and of parents blessing their children. In this respect the law thus setteth forth the blessing of the fifth commandment, *they shall prolong thy days*.
4. Because disobedience to parents bringeth much mischief on childrens heads, and oft shorteneth their days, and that many ways.

⁹⁴³ *Deut.* 6. 2.

⁹⁴⁴ *Psal.* 34. 12, 13, 14.

⁹⁴⁵ *Rut.* 3. 1.

1. In that parents are oft provoked by their childrens disobedience⁹⁴⁶ to disinheret them, at least to allow them the less portion, so as hereby it goeth not so well with them: yea some are provoked to bring their rebellious children to the Magistrate, who by Gods law was to cut them off, so as⁹⁴⁷ thereby their life is shortened.
2. In that parents are provoked to complain unto God of their childrens disobedience, and God thereby moved both to lay heavy judgments upon such children in their life time, and also to shorten their days: for parents complaint doth make a loud cry in Gods ears. It is said that God by cutting off *Abimelech* with an untimely death *rendered the*⁹⁴⁸ *wickedness which he did to his father.*
3. In that, when parents are too indulgent over their children, God doth punish the sin both of parent and child, by shortening the childes days. Instance the examples of⁹⁴⁹ *Hophni* and *Phinehas*,⁹⁵⁰ *Absalom*, and⁹⁵¹ *Adonijah.*
4. In that disobedience to parents, is a sin that seldom goeth alone: for an undutiful child is commonly a very lewd person many other ways. Considering the proveness of our nature to all sin, it cannot be avoided but that they who in the beginning shake off the yoke of government, should run headlong into all riot, looseness, and licentiousness: thus then sin being added unto sin, it must needs bring mischief upon mischief, till at length life be cut off.

Wherefore in that these mischiefs are avoided by performing due obedience to parents, it may well be said that *it shall be well with obedient children, and they shall live long.*

§. 108. Of Gods ordering his favours so as they may appear to be true blessings.

⁹⁴⁶How disobedient children hinder their welfare and shorten their days.

⁹⁴⁷*Deut.* 21. 21.

⁹⁴⁸*Judg.* 9. 5 6.

⁹⁴⁹*1 Sam.* 2. 34.

⁹⁵⁰*2 Sam.* 18. 14.

⁹⁵¹*1 King.* 2. 25.

⁹⁵²How fitly prosperity and long life are joined together.

The particular branches of Gods promise having been⁹⁵² distinctly opened, we will consider them jointly together, for they do exceedingly amplify one another: *prosperity* sweetens long life and makes it acceptable: otherwise to live long, namely in misery and wretchedness, is very irksome and grievous. Again, long life added to prosperity maketh it so much the greater blessing. For a good thing the longer it continueth the better it is. If prosperity were but as a flower, soon gone, the very thought of the vanity thereof would much diminish the joy and comfort of it. But both of them joined together, do show that this is no small blessing which is promised.

From the connection of them both together, I observe that

*God so ordereth his favours as they appear to be true blessings,*⁹⁵³ tending indeed to the good of those upon whom he bestoweth them. Thus when God gave *Abraham* a son, he established his covenant with him, that this gift might be a true blessing.

The like I might instance in all the children of promise, as *Sampson*, *Solomon*, *John Baptist*, etc. So in other favours. When God added fifteen years to *Hezekiahs* life, he also promised⁹⁵⁴ him deliverance from his enemies, and peace, and truth all his days: And when God gave *David* a kingdom, he gave him⁹⁵⁵ great victories and long life, and established his kingdom to his posterity: so also dealt he with *Solomon*. But not to insist on any more particulars, excellently is this doctrine confirmed in the 28 *Psalm*.

Thus God will show that in love he bestoweth even the temporal blessings which he giveth to his Saints, that accordingly they may esteem them, and that their hearts may be the more enlarged both to admire his goodness, and to be thankful for the same.

This use we must make of those things which the Lord is⁹⁵⁶ pleased to bestow upon us, as of long life, good health, honour, peace, plenty, liberty, and all prosperity: we must receive and use them as God bestoweth them, namely as tokens of his favour: and thereby be the more stirred up to perform the duties he requireth of us, and not abuse them to his

⁹⁵³ God makes his savours true blessings. *Gen.* 17. 19.

⁹⁵⁴ *Isa.* 38. 5, 6. & 39. 8.

⁹⁵⁵ 2 *Sam.* 7. 9. etc.

⁹⁵⁶ 1. *Use*.

dishonour and our own hurt: but rather so as he may have honour, and we profit thereby.

§. 109. *Of Gods high account of dutiful children.*

More particularly by this promise we may learn what high⁹⁵⁷ esteem, and great account God maketh of dutiful children, and of that obedience which they perform to their parents: which ought so much the more to provoke children to all obedience, if at least they have any care of Gods favour, and of the tokens of his love. Oh consider this all ye that have parents to honour: consider how careful, how earnest God is every way by all means to draw you to obedience: he contents not himself to urge the equity of the point, the place of your parent, the charge that himself hath given, but most presseth your own profit: and that not only in hope for the time to come, but even in present fruition for this life: and that because we through our childishness are most affected with things sensible and present: dealing with us as a tender father who provideth not only a good calling, and a fair inheritance for his child, but giveth him also plums, pears, and such things as for the present he is delighted withal, the more to allure him.

§. 110. *Of childrens doing good to themselves by honouring their parents.*

Children may further learn out of this promise, that in⁹⁵⁸ performing their duty they do good not only to their parents, but also to themselves: they procure their own welfare and long-life. What egregious fools then are disobedient children: they regard neither God, their parents, nor themselves, but deprive themselves of their eternal happiness, hinder their welfare, and shorten their days. Fitly hereupon I may apply to undutiful children these words of the Psalmist, *Mark the obedient child, for the end of him is peace:*⁹⁵⁹ *but the rebellious shall be destroyed: he shall be cut off:* and these of the wise-man, *I know that it shall be well with the dutiful*⁹⁶⁰

⁹⁵⁷2. Use.

⁹⁵⁸3. Use.

⁹⁵⁹*Psal.* 37 37, 38.

⁹⁶⁰*Eccl.* 8. 12, 13.

*child, but it shall not be well with the disobedient, he shall not prolong his days: and these of the Prophet, Say ye to the obedient child, it shall be well with him, he shall eat the fruit of his doings,*⁹⁶¹ *but woe to the transgressor, it shall be ill with him.*

§. 111. *Of parents doing good to their children by keeping them under obedience.*

Out of this promise parents may learn how to do good⁹⁶² for their children, how to provide for their welfare, and long to preserve their life on earth (a thing whereunto most parents are naturally given, and whereof they are much desirous) namely by teaching children their duty, by keeping them under obedience: thus have they Gods promise to assure them, that it shall go well with their children, and that they shall live long. When parents are upon their death-beds they may rest more securely upon this promise then upon great store of treasure laid up for them, and great revenues reserved for them. Many parents neglect themselves: they moil and toile, they cark and care, they pinch and spare, to leave their children store of wealth, thinking thereby to do good to their children, when as withal they too much cocker their children, give the reins unto them, and care not how little duty they perform. Gods curse will lie upon all the store that is laid up for such children, as a fire to consume it all. Doth not daily experience verify the truth hereof? The judgments which are laid on some such children, do evidently manifest Gods just indignation against all. Let not rich men therefore think they have left their children well enough if they leave them a large portion, but rather if they have observed them to be obedient children: and if poor mens children be such, let them not fear but that it shall go well with them.

It is said, that a good trade is better then house and land, but by virtue of this promise we may say that obedience in a child is better then trade and all: this is the *trade of a child*⁹⁶³ way which parents should teach children. Wherefore as parents are desirous of their childrens good, so they ought to be wise in procuring it, which is by teaching them this *trade*

⁹⁶¹ *Isa.* 3. 10, 11.

⁹⁶² 4. *Use.*

⁹⁶³ *Prou.* 22. 6.

of obedience: and so they shall bring much comfort to themselves while they live, and good to their children after them.

§. 112. *Of the perpetuity of the substance of such things as in their circumstances respecting the Jews are vanished.*

In laying down this particular promise, the Apostle in stead of the limitation thereof unto the Jews in these words (*in the land which the Lord thy God shall give thee*) putteth a general word, which extendeth it to all nations, namely this (*in the earth*) whence I gather that

*The substance of these things which in some circumstances were*⁹⁶⁴ *after a peculiar manner restrained to the Jews, remaineth in force to all Christians.* The substance of this promise was, that it should go well with obedient children, while here on earth they lived, and in this welfare they should long live. The circumstance was, that in Canaan they should enjoy that blessing. Though Christians live not in Canaan, which is the circumstance, yet well it shall go with them, and long they shall live, which is the substance. Thus though the circumstance of Gods covenant with Abraham (which was *circumcision*) be abolished, yet the substance (which is, *to be our God, and the God of our seed*) remaineth. This might further be exemplified in many hundred instances: for the substance of all the Jewish sacrifices, and Sacraments, both ordinary, and extraordinary, of their Sabbaths, of their fasts, of their feasts, and the like, remain, though the circumstances, as shadows, be vanished away. Hence is it, that many promises made to them, are applied by the Apostles to Christians, as this, *I will not fail thee,*⁹⁶⁵ *nor forsake thee:* and in general it is said, *The promise to you and to your children, and to all that are afarra off.*

Hereby we may learn what use to make of the old Testament,⁹⁶⁶ even of those promises and privileges which in some particular respects were appropriated to the Jews: namely, by observing the substance, and distinguishing it from the circumstance; thus shall we find that to be true which the Apostle speaketh of all the things which were written afore time,

⁹⁶⁴*Doctr.* Substance of promises made to the Jews still remaineth.

⁹⁶⁵*Heb.* 13. 5. *Act.* 2. 39.

⁹⁶⁶*Use.*

namely, that *they were written for our learning*. In this respect⁹⁶⁷ the same Apostle saith of the things recorded of *Abraham, they were not written for his sake alone*: and again of the⁹⁶⁸ things recorded of the Israelites, *they are written for our admonition*.⁹⁶⁹ By this we may learn how to apply the preface to the ten Commandments, which mentioneth the deliverance of Israel out of the bondage of Egypt.

Pray therefore for the spirit of illumination to discern betwixt *substance* and *circumstance*, in reading the old Testament especially.

§. 113. *Of the determined period of mans life.*

Having declared such orthodoxall points as this text affordeth, I will further note out two heretical positions, which our adversaries thence raise. One is of those, that to the dishonour of him whom God raised up to be a worthy instrument in dispelling the mist of Popery, which had much darkned the light of the Gospel, call themselves *Lutherans*: the other of *Papists*.

The former is this, *God hath not determined the set period of*⁹⁷⁰ *mans days*, but it is in mans power to lengthen or shorten them: for if it were otherwise, say they, this and such like promises of long life were to no purpose, nor yet the contrary threatenings of shortening mans days.

For full answer hereunto, I will first show, that the position it self is directly contrary to the current of Scripture, and then discover the unsoundness of their consequence.

Touching the determined period of mans days, thus speaketh the Scripture: *Is there not an appointed time to man on*⁹⁷¹ *earth? Are not his days also as the days of an hireling?* note with what emphasis the point is set forth; even so, as if it were a point so clear, as none could doubt of it. Note also two metaphors here used, which do much clear the point: one taken from soldiers, the other from hired servants. That of soldiers is implied in the meaning of the original word translated *appointed time*, but properly

⁹⁶⁷Rom. 15. 4.

⁹⁶⁸Rom 4. 23.

⁹⁶⁹1 Cor. 10. 11.

⁹⁷⁰Hinc patescit humanae vitae terminum, non esse decreto simplici & absoluto constitutum, etc. Zach. Muthel. in hunc loc. & N. Heming. alijque.

⁹⁷¹Mans time set. *Iob* 7. 1.

signifieth him that hath his time appointed for warfare, or the time it self so appointed: the other expressed. Now we know that these times are appointed to an hour: so is the time of mans life. In this respect *Iob* saith again, *all the days of my appointed time will I*⁹⁷² *wait, etc.* where he useth the same word that before in the same sense. To this purpose are these, and such like phrases frequently used in Scripture, *determined days, number of days,*⁹⁷³ *hour, etc.* Did not the Prophet expressly declare to *Hezekiah* that he should live just 15 years after his sickness? He could⁹⁷⁴ not have told it, if the Lord had not before set that period. Christ saith, *our hairs are numbered,* are not much more our⁹⁷⁵ days? Again he saith, *who can add one cubit to his stature?*⁹⁷⁶ Can then any add to his days? So evident is this point, that the heathen noted it.

Touching their consequence (*if a mans time be determined all the promises of long life are to no purpose*) I answer, that God who hath set down the just time and period of mans life, hath also set down the means of attaining to that period. Now the time he hath kept secret to himself, the means he hath revealed to us. In regard of us therefore who know not the time appointed of the Lord, it may be said that by using such and such means we prolong our days, or by doing such and such things we shorten them. Now because these means only show them to be long, or short, Gods decree remaineth firm and stable, and is not altered thereby: yet this work of lengthening or shortening is attributed to us, because we do what lieth in us thereto, and that freely without any compulsion. For Gods decree though it cause a necessity in the event, yet it imposeth no constraint on the will of man, but leaveth it as free (in regard of the manner of working) as if there were no decree at all. And herein Gods admirable wisdom is manifested, that notwithstanding his determined purpose of matters, man hath no ground of excuse to say he was forced to this or that.

The knowledge of this determined period of mans life is of great use: for it teacheth us,

⁹⁷²*Iob* 14. 14.

⁹⁷³*Iob* 14. 5. *Eccles.* 2. 3. *Iob.* 7. 30.

⁹⁷⁴*Isa.* 38. 5.

⁹⁷⁵*Mat.* 10. 30. & 6 27.

⁹⁷⁶*Stat sua cuique dies, etc. Virg. Aenied.* 10.

⁹⁷⁷Uses to be made of the determined time of mans life.

1. Wholly to submit our selves to God: and to be prepared⁹⁷⁷ either soon to depart out of this world, or long to live in it, as God shall dispose of our time: nor desiring longer to live then God hath appointed: nor grieving to live so long as he hath appointed.
2. Not to fear the threats of any man, thereby to be drawn⁹⁷⁸ from God.
3. To do Gods work while we have time, etc.⁹⁷⁹

§. 114. *Of reward promised to obedience, that it implieth no merit.*

The other heresy which Papists gather from this text, is⁹⁸⁰ this, *Mans obedience is meritorious.*

Answ. The reward here promised is no matter of wages and due desert, but of mere grace and favour.

Of this error I have⁹⁸¹ elsewhere more largely spoken.

⁹⁷⁸*Dan.* 3. 17, 18.

⁹⁷⁹*Iob.* 9. 4.

⁹⁸⁰Against merit.

⁹⁸¹*Whole armour of God*, Treat. 2. Part. 4. §. 7. on *Ephes.* 6. 14.

The Parents' Duty towards Their Children

§. 115. *Of the connection of Parents duty with Childrens.*

EPHES. 6. 4.

And ye fathers, provoke not your children to wrath: but bring them up in the nurture and admonition of the Lord.

The Apostle having urged children to perform their duties to their parents, he turneth his speech to parents, saying, *AND ye fathers*, etc. That copulative particle *AND*, joining an exhortation to parents, for performing their duties to the forenamed exhortation made to children, giveth us to understand, that

Parents are as well bound to duty as children. Their duties⁹⁸² indeed be different, yet (notwithstanding their superiority and authority over their children) they are bound to duty. All the directions and exhortations throughout the Scripture given unto parents, concerning their duty, and all the threatenings denounced, and judgments executed on parents for neglect of their duty, are pregnant proofs of this point.

Though parents be over their children, and by them cannot be commanded, yet they are under God: and he it is who hath enjoined them their duty: so as they are bound thereunto, as they will answer it to their father in heaven.

The authority which parents have, is not so much for their own advancement, as for the better governing of their children, which being so, their very government is a duty.

Object. In the moral Law the duty of children only is expressed.⁹⁸³

⁹⁸² 1. *Obseru.* Parents bound to duties.

⁹⁸³ How parents duties are implied in the 5. Commandment.

Answ. parents duty (as many others duties) is by just and necessary consequence implied, which is equivalent, and as much bindeth, as if it were expressed. It is thus implied. They who have honour, must carry themselves worthy of honour. Now the way to carry themselves worthy of honour, is to be careful in doing duty to them that honour them. This is so equal, as it needed not to be exprest.

Wherefore let Ministers follow this pattern of the Apostle,⁹⁸⁴ and carry an even hand towards all of all sorts: let them not be partial in laying all the burden of duty on childrens necks, and none on parents: holding in children very straitly, but leaving parents to their own will. Parents are flesh and blood as well as children, and as prone to transgress in their place, as children in theirs. Yea, Ministers ought of the two to be more earnest in urging parents to perform their duty, because they are under no such power and authority as children are. Fear of parents authority keepeth children much in awe. There is no such thing to keep parents in awe. They will be more ready therefore to take the greater liberty, if by fear of God, and by a good conscience, they be not kept in compass.

Now ye (ô parents) as you look for honour, carry yourselves⁹⁸⁵ worthy of honour: as ye look for duty from your children, perform duty to them. Know that another day, even you shall be called to an account before the highest Judge: your authority will then be no pretence to excuse, but an evidence to aggravate your fault. For you being elder in years, and more eminent in place, of more experience, and having a charge over your children, ought to be a light to show them the way, an example to allure them, that they seeing you careful and conscionable in performing your duty, may be the more provoked to perform theirs, or at least made ashamed of their neglect of duty. But if you be careless of your duty, how can ye expect duty at their hands? Nay if by your ill example they have been made negligent, their blood shall be required at your hands.

§. 116. *Of the extent of these words, Fathers, Children.*

Though the word (*fathers*) be here used, which properly setteth forth *natural parents*, and of natural parents the *male kind*, yet (as in many

⁹⁸⁴1. *Use.* Ministers must provoke parents to their duty.

⁹⁸⁵2. *Use.*

other places) it is to be taken in a larger extent: even in as large as this word (*children*) was before, that so there may be a just and equal relation betwixt children⁹⁸⁶ and parents: wherefore both sexes of natural parents are comprised under it, even *mother* as well as *father*, and they also who are in place of parents, whether by *marriage* as all sorts of fathers and mothers in Law, or by *appointment*, as all they who of right have the custody and charge of children, as Guardians, Tutors, and other like Governors: and so it is every way answerable to the word (*parents*) used in the first verse: and the word (*children*) is also here to be taken in the same extent, as it was there.

§. 117. *Of parents provoking children.*

The next phrase (*provoke to wrath*) is the exposition of one Greek word, which being a compound word, cannot by one English word be fully expressed: the best and nearest that I can think of is (exasperate.) The word signifieth an extremity in the use of authority: even too much austerity and severity, whereby children are provoked to wrath: which because it is a fault, it is here expressly forbidden (*provoke not, etc.*) In this word there is a trope: the *effect* is put for the *cause*: The Apostles meaning is, that parents should take such heed of their carriage toward their children, as they give them no occasion to be stirred up to wrath. Under this word then are forbidden⁹⁸⁷ all such things, as may kindle wrath in children, as too much austerity in carriage, sowreness in countenance, threatening and reviling in words, too hard handling, too severe correction, too much restraint of liberty, too small allowance of things needful, with the like. Parents being flesh and blood are subject in this kind to abuse their authority: yea, even they who fall into the other extreme of too much indulgency and cockering of their children, are very prone to fall also into this extreme: as many who for the most part too much suffer their children without due restraint and correction to run into all riot, will sometimes on a sudden, like Lions, fly upon them, and *after their own pleasure correct them*, and so exceedingly provoke⁹⁸⁸ their children. Such as are most

⁹⁸⁶ *Vers.* 1.

⁹⁸⁷ Occasions of provoking children to wrath.

⁹⁸⁸ *Heb.* 12. 10.

cockering, are most prone to provoke to wrath: for, 1. Such least know how to keep a mean: one will sooner leap out of one extreme into another, then go from an extreme to the mean. 2. The children of such are soonest provoked.

Quest. Is it a thing lawful and justifiable in children to be provoked to wrath by their parents?

*Ans.*⁹⁸⁹ No. This prohibition intendeth no such thing: the Apostle hath here to do with parents: and instructeth them how to prevent such mischiefs as their children through their weakness may fall into. So as here only he sheweth what is unlawful for parents, not what is lawful for children. Hence then by the way I observe that

*Parents must be so watchful over their carriage, as thereby they*⁹⁹⁰ *make not their children to sin.*

If they do, they make their own sin the more heinous, and also they pull down upon their own pates a far more heavy vengeance, even the vengeance of their own sin, and the vengeance of their childes sin. For every parent is made a watchman over his child. If a watchman do not⁹⁹¹ what he can to hinder the sin of such as are under his charge, he pulls their blood on his own neck. What do they then that being watchmen, minister occasion of sin to them that are under their charge?

§. 118. Of parents seeking the good of their children.

That parents by avoiding the rock of *provoking*, fall not into the gulf of *cockering*, the Apostle addeth a BUT, which is as a stop unto them, and teacheth them that

*It is not sufficient for parents to prevent such mischiefs as*⁹⁹² *children may fall into, but they must also seek their good.* All the precepts in Scripture charging parents to seek their childrens good, prove the point. Herein lieth a main difference betwixt the affection which parents and strangers ought to bear toward children, and the duty which one and the other owe to them. Mere strangers ought not to provoke them: but parents ought moreover every way to seek their good.

⁹⁸⁹See Treat. 5. §. 31, 41.

⁹⁹⁰2. *Obser.*

⁹⁹¹*Ezec.* 3. 18.

⁹⁹²3. *Obser.*

The main good which parents ought especially to seek after in the behalf of their children, is noted out in these words: *Bring them up in the nurture and admonition of the Lord.*

The word translated (*bring up*) properly signifieth to feed or nourish with all needful things; it is the same that is used before in the 5. Chapter and 29. Verse, and there translated *nourisheth*. Not unfitly might the proper signification of the⁹⁹³ word be here kept, as the best Latin translations, the French, and others have kept.

This word joined with the others that follow, may seem⁹⁹⁴ at first sight to be here placed only to make up the sense, as if he had thus said, *nurture your child in the ways of God.* But if the scope of the Apostle, and signification of the word be well weighed, we shall find that it further implieth a general duty, which nature it self teacheth parents, even this, that

*Parents ought to provide all needful things for their children.*⁹⁹⁵ even such things as tend to the nourishing of their bodies, and preserving of their health and life: for this phrase (to translate it word for word) *nourish them in discipline*, or in instruction, is a concise speech, implying as much as if he had said, *nourish and nurture them, or feed and instruct them.* But the Apostle hath thus nearly and concisely joined them together, to show that *Nurture and instruction is as needful and profitable, as food and apparel.*

§. 119. *Of parents nurturing their children.*⁹⁹⁶

The word translated *nurture*, signifieth as well *correction* as *instruction*: as Heb. 12. 7. *If ye endure chastening*: and 2 Tim. 3. 16. The Scripture is profitable *for instruction in righteousness*. Both senses will here stand, and our English word (as well as the Greek) will bear both: for to *nurture* children, is as well to *correct* them, as to *instruct* them. Very fitly is this advice in this large acceptation inferred upon the former prohibition: for lest parents should thereupon take occasion to lay the reins upon their childrens necks, and let them run whither they list, the Apostle hereby teacheth, that

⁹⁹³ *Enutrite, Beza.*

⁹⁹⁴ *Nourrissez. Fr.*

⁹⁹⁵ 4. *Obseru.* Parents to provide all needful things for children..

⁹⁹⁶ 5. *Obseru..*

*Parents, as they may not be too austere, so neither too remiss.*⁹⁹⁷ They must not provoke their children to wrath, yet they must keep them under discipline. The word translated *nurture*, according to the⁹⁹⁸ Greek notation thereof doth further set forth the mean betwixt the two forenamed extremes: for it noteth out *such a discipline as befiteth a lad, or a young child*: so as the thing it self, *discipline*, by instruction and correction keepeth from one extreme of *remissness*: the kind or *manner* of discipline being such as befiteth a child, keepeth from the other extreme of *rigour* and cruelty. Extremes on either side are dangerous and pernicious, and that to parent and child. For *remissness* will make children careless of all duty to God and parent: *rigour* will make them desperate. But virtue and safety consisteth in the mean betwixt both.

§. 120. *Of parents fixing precepts in their childrens minds.*

This word (*admonition*) according to the⁹⁹⁹ notation thereof, hath a particular relation to the *mind*, and pointeth out an informing and instructing of it. It is taken either for the action of admonishing, (as Tit. 3. 10. *reject an hereticke after the first and second admonition*) or for the¹⁰⁰⁰ thing admonished, in which latter sense most do here take it: yet would I not have the former clean excluded, for according to the full meaning of the word, I take thus much to be intended.

*As parents deliver good precepts and principles to their children,*¹⁰⁰¹ *so they must be careful, by forcible and frequent admonitions, to fix and settle them in the mind of their children.*¹⁰⁰² The Law expresseth as much by another metaphor which it useth, in a direction which it giveth to parents, saying, *thou shalt whet or sharpen Gods Lawes upon thy children*, that is,¹⁰⁰³ *thou shalt teach them diligently unto them.*

⁹⁹⁷6. *Obseru..*

⁹⁹⁸*Instituere vt puerili aetati conuenit.*

⁹⁹⁹*menti indere.*

¹⁰⁰⁰*In monitis.*

¹⁰⁰¹7. *Obseru..*

¹⁰⁰²*Deut. 6. 7.*

¹⁰⁰³*Doctus inter Hebr. vocem continuò loqui exponit, (i.) inculcare, vel identidem repetere. Innuit studium & diligentiam qua pueris praecepta Dei inculcari debent. Uatabl. in Deut. 6. 7. vide Tr. 6. §. 42.*

The more pains is taken in this kind, the less labour will be lost. That which at first is little heeded, by much urging and pressing will for ever be held, as a nail that at one blow scars entreth, with many blows is knocked up to the head.

§ 121. *Of adding information to discipline.*

The addition of this word *admonition* unto *nurture*, is not (as some take it) a mere explication of the same point, but also a declaration of a further duty, which is this:

*As parents by discipline keep their children under, so by information*¹⁰⁰⁴ *they must direct them in the right way. Solomon doth both deliver the point, and also add a good reason to enforce it: for saith he, Train up a child in the way that he should go; there is the duty: and when he is old, he will not depart from it; there*¹⁰⁰⁵ *is the reason. Keeping a child under by good discipline, may make him dutiful while the father is over him: but well informing his understanding and judgment, is a means to uphold him in the right way so long as he liveth.*

§. 122. *Of parents teaching their children the fear of God.*

The last word (*of the Lord*) intimateth the best duty that a parent can do for his child. *Admonition of the Lord*, declareth such principles as a parent hath received from the Lord, and learned out of Gods word: such as may teach a child to fear the Lord, such as tend to true piety and religion: whence further I observe, that

*Parents must especially teach their children their duty to*¹⁰⁰⁶ *God. Come children (saith the Psalmist) hearken unto me, I will teach you the fear of the Lord. Of this particular more largely*¹⁰⁰⁷ *hereafter.*

¹⁰⁰⁴8. *Obser.*

¹⁰⁰⁵*Pro. 22. 6.*

¹⁰⁰⁶9. *Obser.*

¹⁰⁰⁷*Treat. 6. §. 34.*